🎯 2026 PRELIMS & RO/ARO SPECIAL · COMPLETE CHAPTER-WISE PYQS

MEDIEVAL INDIA PYQ MASTER

मध्यकालीन भारत — अध्यायवार संपूर्ण पूर्व परीक्षा प्रश्नोत्तरी

Consolidated Chapter-wise Practice Bank covering all 12 topics.

Exclusive Authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Questions Only • Structured Option Grids • Visible Answers & High-Yield Core Memory Lock Explanations.

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Chapter 01: Early Medieval (प्रारंभिक मध्यकाल) India (Regional Kingdoms) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Match List-I (Ruler) with List-II (Dynasty):

List-I	List-II
A Mahendravarman I	1 Rashtrakuta
B Kadungon	2 Pallava
C Amoghavarsha I	3 Chola
D Rajaraja I	4 Pandya

Row order in the table is not the answer code.

A 4 2 3 1

B 2 4 1 3

C 2 4 3 1

D 4 2 1 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (2–4–1–3 / A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Mahendravarman I → 2. Pallava:** Early 7th-century Pallava king of Kanchi; author of the Sanskrit farce *Mattavilasa Prahasana*; fought against Badami Chalukya king Pulakeshin II. - **B. Kadungon → 4. Pandya:** Late 6th-century Pandya ruler who ended the Kalabhra interregnum, liberated Madurai, and revived the First Pandyan Empire. - **C. Amoghavarsha I → 1. Rashtrakuta:** Famous 9th-century Rashtrakuta monarch of Manyakheta; patron of Jainism and author of *Kavirajamarga*, the earliest canonical Kannada work. - **D. Rajaraja I → 3. Chola:** Imperial Chola ruler (985–1014 CE); conquered northern Sri Lanka, built the Brihadishwara Temple at Thanjavur, and pioneered naval administration. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Kadungon revived the **Pandyas** (Madurai), while Simhavishnu simultaneously revived the **Pallavas** (Kanchi) around 575–590 CE. - Amoghavarsha I ruled for 64 years at **Manyakheta** (Rashtrakuta), completely separate from the Chola line.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Arrange the following Sen rulers of Bengal in ascending chronological order:

1. Ballal Sen
2. Lakshman Sen
3. Hemant Sen
4. Vijaya Sen

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

A 4, 3, 2, 1
B 2, 1, 4, 3
C 1, 2, 3, 4
D 3, 4, 1, 2

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (3–4–1–2 / Hemant Sen → Vijaya Sen → Ballal Sen → Lakshman Sen) **Detailed Explanation:** The chronological sequence of the Sena kings of Bengal is: 1. **3. Hemant Sen (late 11th c.):** Established an independent principality in Bengal following the decline of Pala power. 2. **4. Vijaya Sen (c. 1095–1158 CE):** Consolidated Sena rule across Bengal and parts of Bihar; defeated the Pala king Madanapala. 3. **1. Ballal Sen (c. 1158–1179 CE):** Instituted *Kulinism* and authored the renowned socio-legal texts *Danasagara* and *Adbhutisagara*. 4. **2. Lakshman Sen (c. 1179–1206 CE):** Established the *Lakshmana Samvat* era; patronized Jayadeva (*Gita Govinda*); fled Nadia during Bakhtiyar Khalji's surprise raid in 1204 CE. **Mnemonic / Exam Trap:** - Use the mnemonic **H–V–B–L** (Hemant → Vijaya → Ballal → Lakshman). - Never place Ballal Sen before Vijaya Sen or reverse the Ballal–Lakshman order.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R):

****Assertion (A):** We have much more information about Cholas than their predecessors.**

****Reason (R):** The Chola rulers adopted the practice of having inscriptions written on the walls of temples giving a historical narrative of their victories.**

Select the correct answer from the codes given below.

A Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
B Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
C (A) is true but (R) is false
D (A) is false but (R) is true

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** Modern historians possess significantly greater and more reliable historical data regarding the Imperial Cholas than for any preceding South Indian dynasty. - **Reason (R) is correct:** Starting with Rajaraja I (985–1014 CE), the Cholas established the custom of prefacing their stone inscriptions with a formal historical narrative (*Meikeerthi*) recounting their lineage and military victories, carved directly upon the stone walls of magnificent temples like Thanjavur. - **Why (R) explains (A):** The deliberate engraving of detailed historical accounts on permanent stone temple walls preserved a massive epigraphic archive, which directly accounts for the wealth of historical information available about the Cholas. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - The *Meikeerthi* tradition was an epigraphic innovation of the Imperial Cholas, initiated by Rajaraja I.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Match List-I (Ruling Dynasties) with List-II (Capitals):

List-I	List-II
A Pallava	1 Warangal
B Pandya	2 Kanchi
C Yadava	3 Madura
D Kakatiya	4 Devagiri

Row order in the table is not the answer code.

A 2 1 4 3

B 2 3 4 1

C 1 2 3 4

D 2 4 3 1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (2–3–4–1 / A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Pallava → 2. Kanchi:** Capital at Kanchipuram (Tamil Nadu), celebrated for silk and religious learning. - **B. Pandya → 3. Madura:** Capital at Madurai on the Vaigai river (Tamil Nadu), heartland of Tamil Sangam literature. - **C. Yadava → 4. Devagiri:** Capital at Devagiri (modern Daulatabad, Maharashtra) in the northern Deccan. - **D. Kakatiya → 1. Warangal:** Capital at Warangal (Orugallu, Telangana), famous for its rock fort and Thousand Pillar temple. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Do not invert Devagiri (Yadava) and Warangal (Kakatiya).

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Arrange the following temples in a chronological order and select the correct answer from the codes given below:

I. Brihdishwar temple
II. Gangaikonda cholapuram temple
III. Shore temple of Mahabalipuram
IV. Sapt pagoda

Options:

A I, II, IV, III

B II, I, III, IV

C III, II, I, IV

D IV, III, I, II

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (IV, III, I, II) **Detailed Explanation:** Chronological sequence of temple construction: 1. **IV. Sapt Pagoda (Pancha Rathas, Mahabalipuram):** Monolithic rock-cut shrines constructed under Pallava king **Narasimhavarman I 'Mahamalla'** (c. **630–668 CE**). 2. **III. Shore Temple of Mahabalipuram:** Built by Pallava monarch **Narasimhavarman II 'Rajasimha'** (c. **700–728 CE**). 3. **I. Brihadishwara Temple at Thanjavur:** Grand granite structural temple completed by Imperial Chola king **Rajaraja I** in **1010 CE**. 4. **II. Gangaikondacholapuram Temple:** Built by his son **Rajendra I** around **1035 CE** to commemorate his victorious expedition to the Ganga. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Rock-cut architecture (Sapt Pagoda) preceded structural masonry (Shore Temple). - Thanjavur (Rajaraja I, 1010) preceded Gangaikondacholapuram (Rajendra I, ~1035).

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Which of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

State — Ruler

A Devgiri — Shankar Dev

B Warangal — Ramchandra Dev

C Hoysal — Veer Ballal

D Madura — Veer Pandya

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (Warangal — Ramchandra Dev is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Devgiri — Shankar Dev (Correct):** Shankaradeva was the crown prince and ruler of the Yadavas of Devagiri who resisted Malik Kafur in 1312 CE. - **B. Warangal — Ramchandra Dev (INCORRECT):** **Ramachandra Dev** was the king of **Devagiri (Yadava dynasty)**. The contemporary Kakatiya ruler of **Warangal** during the Delhi Sultanate campaigns was **Prataparudra II**. - **C. Hoysal — Veer Ballal (Correct):** King Veera Ballala III ruled the Hoysalas from Dvarasamudra (Halebid). - **D. Madura — Veer Pandya (Correct):** Vira Pandya was a co-ruler in the Pandyan kingdom at Madurai during the 1311 CE invasion. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Ramachandra Dev is inextricably linked to **Devagiri (Maharashtra)**, not Warangal (Telangana).

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

With reference to Early Medieval India, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The period is roughly dated about 1206–1526 CE as the Delhi Sultanate age.
2. The Delhi Sultanate begins in 1206 CE.
3. Early Medieval India is identical with the Delhi Sultanate phase.

A Only 2

B 1 and 2

C 2 and 3

D 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Only Statement 2 is correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Early Medieval India spans roughly **c. 750–1200 CE** (from the fragmentation of Harsha's empire to the eve of Turkish conquests). The period 1206–1526 CE designates the Delhi Sultanate. - **Statement 2 is correct:** The Delhi Sultanate was formally founded in **1206 CE** by Qutb-ud-din Aibak following the death of Muhammad Ghori. - **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Early Medieval India is characterized by regional Rajput and Deccan kingdoms (Gurjara-Pratihara, Pala, Rashtrakuta, Chola), completely distinct from the centralized Turkish sultanate phase. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - UPPCS strictly demarcates the Early Medieval phase as c. 750–1200 CE, distinct from the Sultanate (1206–1526 CE).

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below:

List-I (Dynasty)	List-II (Capital / seat)
A Pallava	1 Madurai
B Pandya	2 Kanchi
C Rashtrakuta	3 Manyakheta
D Early Chalukya	4 Badami / Vatapi

Row order is not the answer code.
Code:

A. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
B. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
C. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
D. A-4, B-1, C-2, D-3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Pallava → 2. Kanchi:** Capital at Kanchipuram (Tamil Nadu). - **B. Pandya → 1. Madurai:** Capital at Madurai on the Vaigai river. - **C. Rashtrakuta → 3. Manyakheta:** Capital established at Manyakheta (modern Malkhed, Karnataka) by Amoghavarsha I. - **D. Early Chalukya → 4. Badami / Vatapi:** Capital at Vatapi (modern Badami, Bagalkot district, Karnataka) founded by Pulakeshin I. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Early Chalukyas ruled from **Badami**, whereas Later Western Chalukyas ruled from **Kalyani**. Do not combine them.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): The Tripartite Struggle was fought for control of Kannauj.

Reason (R): Pala, Gurjara-Pratihara, and Rashtrakuta powers contested the city.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
B. (A) is false, but (R) is true
C. (A) is true, but (R) is false
D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** The Western Chalukyas of Kalyani and the Imperial Cholas were locked in fierce, continuous conflict across the 11th and 12th centuries. - **Reason (R) is correct:** Control of the rich agricultural delta of Vengi and the strategic Krishna–Tungabhadra (Raichur) doab was critical to the security and revenue of both empires. - **Why (R) explains (A):** The geopolitical competition over these fertile borderlands and commercial trade corridors directly caused recurring warfare between the two rival powers. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - The conflict between Kalyani Chalukyas and Cholas centered specifically on **Vengi and the Tungabhadra doab**.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Arrange the following temple-building landmarks in chronological order:

1. Brihadishwara (Thanjavur)
2. Shore Temple (Mahabalipuram)
3. Gangaikondacholapuram temple complex (Rajendra phase)

A 1–2–3
B 2–1–3
C 2–3–1
D 3–2–1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (3–1–2 / Shore Temple → Brihadishwara → Gangaikondacholapuram) **Detailed Explanation:** The correct ascending chronological order is: 1. **3. Shore Temple of Mahabalipuram (c. 700–728 CE):** Built by Pallava king Narasimhavarman II 'Rajasimha'. 2. **1. Brihadishwara Temple at Thanjavur (1010 CE):** Commissioned by Imperial Chola king Rajaraja I. 3. **2. Gangaikondacholapuram Temple (c. 1035 CE):** Built by Rajendra I following his victorious Ganga expedition. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Remember: Pallava structural temples (~8th c.) preceded Chola imperial temples (11th c.). - Brihadishwara (father Rajaraja I) preceded Gangaikondacholapuram (son Rajendra I).

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Mihir Bhoja — Paramara scholar-king of Dhara
2. Mihir Bhoja — Pratihara ruler with title Adivaraha
3. Bhoja I — Paramara of Malwa / Dhara

A 1 only
B 2 only
C 2 and 3 only
D 1 and 3 only

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Only pair 1 is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair 1: Mihir Bhoja — Paramara scholar-king of Dhara (INCORRECT):** **Mihir Bhoja (c. 836–885 CE)** was the greatest emperor of the **Gurjara-Pratihara dynasty** of Kannauj, who bore the title *Adivaraha*. The famous scholar-king of Dhara in Malwa was **Bhoja I (c. 1010–1055 CE)** of the **Paramara dynasty**. - **Pair 2: Bhoja I — Paramara of Dhara (Correct):** Authored *Samarangana Sutradhara* and founded the Bhojshala at Dhar. - **Pair 3: Amoghavarsha I — Rashtrakuta of Manyakheta (Correct):** Long-reigning monarch and author of *Kavirajamarga*. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Confusing **Mihir Bhoja** (Gurjara-Pratihara of Kannauj; title *Adivaraha*) with **Bhoja I** (Paramara of Dhara; scholar-king) is one of the oldest UPPCS traps.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

With reference to Chola administration, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The hierarchy ran Mandalam → Valanadu → Nadu → Village.
2. The empire had four mandalams at its peak.
3. Ur was the Brahmana agrahara assembly.

A Only 1, 2 and 3
B Only 1 and 2
C Only 2 and 3
D 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (Statements 1 and 2 only are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** The territorial administrative hierarchy of the Chola Empire ran: **Mandalam** (province) → **Valanadu / Kottam** (district cluster) → **Nadu** (district/taluk) → **Gramam / Kurram** (village unit). - **Statement 2 is correct:** In classical Chola political structure, the core empire was divided into **four principal mandalams** (such as Chola-mandalam, Tondai-mandalam, Pandya-mandalam/Rajaraja-mandalam). - **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The empire was **not** divided into 20 mandalams; even at its greatest expansion under Rajendra I (including overseas territories), the total formal mandalams never reached 20. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Keep the descending administrative ladder clear: **Mandalam → Valanadu → Nadu → Kurram / Village**.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Consider the following pairs:

1. Hoysala — Halebid / Dvarasamudra
2. Kakatiya — Warangal
3. Yadava — Devagiri

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

A Only 1
B 1 and 2
C All 1, 2 and 3
D 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (All three statements are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** The **Hoysalas** ruled from **Halebid** (ancient **Dvarasamudra**) in modern Hassan district, Karnataka, noted for the star-shaped Hoysaleswara Temple. - **Statement 2 is correct:** The **Kakatiyas** held their capital at **Warangal** (ancient **Orugallu**) in Telangana. - **Statement 3 is correct:** The **Yadavas (Seunas)** ruled from the hill-fort capital of **Devagiri** (modern Daulatabad) in Maharashtra. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Memorize the Deccan triangle: Hoysala–Halebid | Kakatiya–Warangal | Yadava–Devagiri.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): The Battle of Takkolam (949) broke Chola power for a generation.

Reason (R): Rashtrakuta Krishna III's confederacy killed Chola prince Rajaditya.

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** During the 11th century, the Bay of Bengal earned the famous historical nickname **"Chola Lake"**. - **Reason (R) is correct:** **Rajendra I** deployed his massive navy across the Bay of Bengal in **1025 CE**, capturing Srivijaya's capital in Sumatra and subduing the strategic port of **Kadaram (Kedah, Malaysia)** to protect Indian Ocean trade lanes. - **Why (R) explains (A):** The complete maritime subjugation of the littoral states along the Bay of Bengal converted this vast body of water into an internal Chola highway. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - The naval assault on Kadaram occurred in **1025 CE** under **Rajendra I**.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I (Ruler)	List-II (Dynasty)
A Mahendravarman	1 Chola
B Amoghavarsha	2 Pallava
C Rajaraja	3 Rashtrakuta
D Kadungon	4 Pandya

Row order is not the answer code.
Code:

- **A** A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
- **B** A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4
- **C** A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
- **D** A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Mahendravarman I → 2. Pallava; *Mattavilasa Prahasana*:** Celebrated Pallava royal dramatist and builder. - **B. Narasimhavarman I → 3. Pallava; Vatapikonda / Mahamalla:** Sacked the Chalukya capital Vatapi in 642 CE and assumed the title *Vatapikonda*. - **C. Pulakeshin II → 1. Badami Chalukya; Harsha defeat; Aihole:** Halted Harsha's southward expansion on the Narmada; immortalized in Ravikirti's Aihole prasasti. - **D. Dantidurga → 4. Rashtrakuta founder; Hiranyagarbha:** Overthrew the Badami Chalukyas in 753–757 CE and performed the sacred *Hiranyagarbha* ritual at Ujjain. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Vatapikonda* is **Narasimhavarman I** (Pallava). - *Hiranyagarbha at Ujjain* was performed by **Dantidurga** (Rashtrakuta founder).

Chapter 02: Turkish Invasions & Delhi Sultanate — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Arrange the following victories of Alauddin Khalji in correct chronological order.

1. Ranthambore
2. Jaisalmer
3. Warangal
4. Chittor

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

Options:

A 1, 2, 3, 4

B 2, 1, 4, 3

C 2, 1, 3, 4

D 1, 2, 4, 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (2–1–4–3 / Jaisalmer → Ranthambore → Chittor → Warangal) **Detailed Explanation:** The correct chronological order of military expeditions undertaken during the reign of Alauddin Khalji is: 1. **2. Jaisalmer (1299 CE):** Early in his reign, an expedition led by Ulugh Khan and Zafar Khan subjugated Jaisalmer after Rajput Bhatis seized imperial horses. 2. **1. Ranthambore (1301 CE):** Besieged and captured from Chauhan king Hammiradeva after a prolonged resistance; marked by the first historical *Jauhar* described by Amir Khusrau. 3. **4. Chittor (1303 CE):** Besieged and conquered from Guhila ruler Rawal Ratan Singh; renamed *Khizrabad* after prince Khizr Khan. 4. **3. Warangal (1309–1310 CE):** Southern campaign led by general Malik Kafur against Kakatiya ruler Prataparudra II, who surrendered vast treasures including the Koh-i-Noor diamond. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Rajasthan forts (**Ranthambore 1301 → Chittor 1303**) preceded the deep peninsular Deccan campaigns (**Warangal 1309–1310, Dvarasamudra 1311, Madurai 1311**).

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R):

Assertion (A): The territories of the Sultanate could be broadly divided into two parts: the Khalsa and the Jagirs.
Reason (R): The Jagirs comprised the land under the direct control of the State.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

Options:

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B (A) is false, but (R) is true

C (A) is true, but (R) is false

D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Assertion A is true, but Reason R is false) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** Under the Delhi Sultanate agrarian and fiscal framework, crown-controlled territory was divided broadly into two primary categories: **Khalsa** (lands managed directly by the central revenue ministry, whose collections flowed straight into the royal treasury) and **Iqtas / Jagirs** (tracts assigned to military commanders and nobles in lieu of cash salaries). - **Reason (R) is false:** **Jagirs / Iqtas were NOT under the direct administrative control of the State.** Instead, they were assigned to *Muqtis* or *Iqtadars*, who collected land revenue locally, maintained mandatory military contingents from these proceeds, deducted their own maintenance expenses, and remitted only the surplus balance (*Fawazil*) to the Sultan. It was **Khalsa** land that was kept under the direct management and revenue collection of the central state. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Khalsa* = Crown land under direct royal supervision. - *Iqta / Jagir* = Assigned revenue land granted for military service and maintenance.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Which of the following is **not correctly matched?**

A Iltutmish — Father of Razia

B Shah Turkan — Wife of Iltutmish

C Hamida Banu Begum — Wife of Alauddin Khilji

D Gulbadan Begum — Daughter of Babur

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Hamida Banu Begum — Wife of Alauddin Khilji is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair A: Iltutmish — Father of Razia (Correct):** Sultan Shamsuddin Iltutmish explicitly nominated his capable daughter Razia Sultan as his successor to the throne of Delhi. - **Pair B: Shah Turkan — Wife of Iltutmish (Correct):** Shah Turkan was a prominent, ambitious queen consort of Iltutmish and mother of Ruknuddin Firuz. - **Pair C: Hamida Banu Begum — Wife of Alauddin Khilji (INCORRECT):** **Hamida Banu Begum (Maryam Makani)** was the wife of the second Mughal Emperor **Humayun** and the mother of **Akbar the Great**. She belongs to the 16th-century Mughal dynasty, not the 13th/14th-century Khalji dynasty. - **Pair D: Gulbadan Begum — Daughter of Babur (Correct):** Gulbadan Begum was Babur's daughter, Humayun's sister, and author of the historical memoir *Humayun-nama*. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - UPPCS regularly mixes prominent medieval royal women across dynasties: Hamida Banu and Gulbadan are **Mughal**, whereas Shah Turkan and Razia are **Mamluk/Slave Dynasty**.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Who among the following translated the **300 volumes of Sanskrit books collected by Firoz Shah Tughlaq during the campaign of Nagarkot?**

A Talib Amuli

B Mulla Abdul Baqi

C Mirza Muhammad Ali

D Azizuddin Khan

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (Azizuddin Khan) **Detailed Explanation:** - During the campaign against **Nagarkot (Kangra)** in **1365 CE**, Sultan **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** captured the historic Jwalamukhi temple library containing approximately 1,300 Sanskrit manuscripts on philosophy, astrology, divination, and music. - Firoz Shah, who patronized translation from indigenous languages, commissioned the eminent court scholar **Azzuddin Khalid Khani (Azizuddin Khan)** to translate selected texts (around 300 volumes on astronomy, music, and omens) into Persian verse. - The resulting famous Persian compilation was titled **Dalail-i-Firoz Shahi** (*Arguments / Proofs of Firoz Shah*). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - The Nagarkot Sanskrit translation (*Dalail-i-Firoz Shahi*) was authored by **Azizuddin Khan**. - Do not confuse him with 17th-century Mughal translators or Persian chroniclers like Ziauddin Barani and Shams-i Siraj Afif.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Match List-I (Building) with List-II (Builder):

List-I	List-II
A Sultan Garhi	1 Alauddin Khilji
B Red Palace	2 Qutbuddin Aibak
C Jamat Khana Masjid	3 Iltutmish
D Dhai Din Ka Jhopra	4 Balban

Row order in the table is not the answer code.

A 3, 4, 1, 2

B 3, 4, 2, 1

C 4, 3, 1, 2

D 4, 3, 2, 1

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (3–4–1–2 / A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Sultan Garhi → 3. Iltutmish:** Built in 1231 CE in Delhi for his eldest son Nasiruddin Mahmud; celebrated as the earliest monumental Islamic mausoleum (tomb) built in India. - **B. Red Palace (Lal Mahal) → 4. Balban:** Fortified royal residence constructed by Ghiyasuddin Balban in Delhi, where he held court and enforced *Sijda* and *Paibos*. - **C. Jamat Khana Masjid → 1. Alauddin Khalji:** Oldest intact congregational mosque in Delhi constructed entirely in Islamic architectural style (true arch and dome), located at Nizamuddin. - **D. Dhai Din Ka Jhopra → 2. Qutbuddin Aibak:** Early mosque built at **Ajmer** (Rajasthan) in 1192–1199 CE on the orders of Aibak, converting a Sanskrit college into a mosque with pillared cloisters. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Sultan Garhi (First tomb) = **Iltutmish**. - Dhai Din Ka Jhopra is located at **Ajmer**, built by **Qutbuddin Aibak** (not Delhi).

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists (Delhi Sultanate Administration):

List-I (Officer)	List-II (Duty / Responsibility)
A Diwan-i-Tan	1 Looked after accounts / records
B Mustarfi	2 Maintained imperial firmans / news-writer
C Mushrif	3 Looked after salaries / Jagirs
D Vakianvis	4 Auditor General

A. A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4

B. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

C. A-4, B-1, C-2, D-3

D. A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (3–4–1–2 / A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Diwan-i-Tan → 3. Looked after salaries / Jagirs:** Department responsible for managing cash salaries (*naqd*) and assigning revenue estates (*jagirs/iqtas*) to state servants. - **B. Mustarfi → 4. Auditor General:** Imperial auditor responsible for scrutinizing and auditing income and expenditure accounts across the provinces and central ministries. - **C. Mushrif → 1. Looked after accounts / records:** Imperial accountant general and keeper of revenue ledgers and financial registers. - **D. Vakianvis → 2. Maintained list of imperial firmans / news-writer:** Royal court intelligencer and official recorder who documented Sultan's decrees (*firmans*) and court proceedings. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Distinguish the financial duo: **Mushrif** = Accountant / ledger keeper vs. **Mustarfi** = Auditor. - *Khareetadar* dispatched royal letters/diplomatic bags, distinct from *Vakianvis* who recorded daily decrees.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Which of the following is NOT correctly matched? (Books / Writers)

A. Tabaqat-i-Nasiri — Minhaj-us-Siraj-Juzjani

B. Tarikh-i-Firozshahi — Shams-i-Siruj-Alif

C. Tughlaqnama — Ibn Battuta

D. Humayunnama — Gulbadan Begam

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Tughlaqnama — Ibn Battuta is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair A: Tabaqat-i-Nasiri — Minhaj-us-Siraj-Juzjani (Correct):** Invaluable 13th-century chronicle dedicated to Sultan Nasiruddin Mahmud, detailing the Turkish conquest from Ghori down to 1260 CE. - **Pair B: Tarikh-i-Firozshahi — Shams-i-Siraj Afif (Correct):** Dedicated history of Firoz Shah Tughlaq's reign, continuing from where Ziauddin Barani's chronicle stopped. - **Pair C: Tughlaqnama — Ibn Battuta (INCORRECT):** The **Tughlaqnama** was composed by the great poet **Amir Khusrau** (commemorating the rise of Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq and the defeat of Khusrau Khan in 1320 CE). **Ibn Battuta** authored the celebrated travelogue **Kitab-ur-Rihla** (*The Travels*). - **Pair D: Humayunnama — Gulbadan Begam (Correct):** Written by Babur's daughter and Humayun's sister at Akbar's request. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Tughlaqnama* = **Amir Khusrau**. - *Rihla* = **Ibn Battuta**. - *Tarikh-i-Firozshahi* was authored independently by **Ziauddin Barani** and **Shams-i-Siraj Afif**.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

With reference to early Turkish invasions, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. This created a Gangetic imperial capital at Delhi immediately.
2. Muhammad bin Qasim took Sindh in 712 from Dahir.
3. Chachnama preserves the Sindh narrative with capital at Delhi.

A 1 and 2	**B** 2 and 3
C 1 and 3	**D** Only 2

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (Only Statement 2 is correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The early Arab conquest under Muhammad bin Qasim (712 CE) established an isolated provincial foothold in **Sindh and Multan**; it did NOT penetrate the Gangetic valley or establish an imperial capital at Delhi (Delhi did not become the capital until Iltutmish in the 13th century). - **Statement 2 is correct:** **Muhammad bin Qasim** defeated Raja Dahir at the Battle of Rawar in **712 CE**, annexing Sindh to the Umayyad Caliphate. - **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The **Chachnama** (originally written in Arabic and translated into Persian by Ali Kufi) records the history of the Chach dynasty and the Arab conquest of Sindh with its capital at **Aror (Al-Ror)**, completely independent of Delhi. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Arab capital of early Sindh was **Aror / Mansurah**, NOT Delhi. - First Muslim invader of India = **Muhammad bin Qasim (712 CE)**. - First Turkish invader of India = **Sabuktigin (977 CE)**.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I (Battle)	List-II (Year / result tag)
A Mount Abu	**1** 1192; Ghori wins
B First Tarain	**2** 1178; Ghori's first India defeat
C Second Tarain	**3** 1191; Prithviraj wins
D Chandawar	**4** 1194; Jay Chandra killed

Row order is not the answer code.
Code:

A A-3, B-2, C-4, D-1	**B** A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
C A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4	**D** A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Mount Abu (Battle of Kayadara) → 2. 1178; Ghori's first India defeat:** Solanki/Chaulukya regent queen **Naika Devi** (mother of Mularaja II) decisively routed Muhammad Ghori at the foot of Mount Abu. - **B. First Battle of Tarain → 3. 1191; Prithviraj wins:** Prithviraj Chauhan routed Ghori's army; Ghori was wounded and rescued by a Khalji horseman. - **C. Second Battle of Tarain → 1. 1192; Ghori wins:** Decisive battle where Ghori used superior cavalry tactics to defeat and capture Prithviraj, laying the foundation of Turkish rule in north India. - **D. Battle of Chandawar → 4. 1194; Jay Chandra killed:** Muhammad Ghori defeated Gahadavala king **Jayachandra** of Kannauj/Banaras near modern Firozabad/Etawah. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Ghori's first defeat in India was NOT at Tarain (1191), but at **Kayadara/Mount Abu in 1178** by **Naika Devi / Solankis of Gujarat**.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Muhammad Ghori's pattern differed from Mahmud of Ghazni's.

Reason (R): Ghori practised territorial conquest with governors, garrisons, and coinage, while Mahmud usually raided and withdrew.

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B (A) is false, but (R) is true

C (A) is true, but (R) is false

D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** The historical objectives and imperial consequences of Muhammad Ghori's invasions differed radically from those of Mahmud of Ghazni. - **Reason (R) is correct:** **Mahmud of Ghazni** conducted seventeen destructive military campaigns (1000–1026 CE) essentially designed to plunder wealth, demolish iconic temples (e.g. Somnath), and finance his Central Asian empire, returning to Ghazni after each raid. In contrast, **Muhammad Ghori** aimed at permanent territorial empire-building in India; he appointed resident viceroys (like Qutbuddin Aibak), established permanent garrisons, created *Iqtas*, and issued local coinage. - **Why (R) explains (A):** The contrasting institutional models—plunder-and-retreat versus conquest-and-colonize—directly explains why Ghori founded an enduring Muslim empire in India while Ghazni left only an isolated province in Punjab. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Mahmud of Ghazni = Plunder and return. - Muhammad Ghori = Territorial conquest and founding of state structures.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Arrange the Delhi Sultanate dynasties in correct chronological order:

1. Khalji
2. Slave (Mamluk)
3. Lodi
4. Tughlaq
5. Sayyid

A 2–4–1–5–3

B 2–1–4–5–3

C 1–2–4–5–3

D 2–1–5–4–3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (2–1–4–5–3 / Slave → Khalji → Tughlaq → Sayyid → Lodi) **Detailed Explanation:** The Delhi Sultanate comprises five successive dynasties: 1. **2. Slave / Mamluk Dynasty (1206–1290 CE):** Founded by Qutbuddin Aibak (84 years). 2. **1. Khalji Dynasty (1290–1320 CE):** Founded by Jalaluddin Khalji; peak under Alauddin (30 years — shortest ruling dynasty). 3. **4. Tughlaq Dynasty (1320–1414 CE):** Founded by Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq; peak under Muhammad and Firoz (94 years — longest ruling dynasty). 4. **5. Sayyid Dynasty (1414–1451 CE):** Founded by Khizr Khan (37 years). 5. **3. Lodi Dynasty (1451–1526 CE):** Founded by Bahlul Lodi; ended at First Panipat (75 years — first Afghan dynasty). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Longest reigning dynasty = **Tughlaq** (94 years). - Shortest reigning dynasty = **Khalji** (30 years). - First Afghan dynasty = **Lodi**.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Qutb-ud-din Aibak — capital at Lahore
2. Iltutmish — first lasting Delhi capital of the Sultanate
3. Aibak — title "Sultan" as his regular style from the start

A 1 only
B 3 only
C 2 and 3 only
D 1 and 2 only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (Only pair 3 is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair 1: Qutb-ud-din Aibak — capital at Lahore (Correct):** Aibak administered the infant Sultanate primarily from Lahore, where he died in 1210 CE playing Chaugan (polo). - **Pair 2: Iltutmish — first lasting Delhi capital (Correct):** Shamsuddin Iltutmish permanently shifted the capital from Lahore to **Delhi**, making it the enduring imperial seat. - **Pair 3: Aibak — title "Sultan" as regular style (INCORRECT):** Aibak never assumed sovereign regalia: he never had the *Khutba* read in his name, did not strike coins in his name, and styled himself modestly as **Malik** and **Sipahsalar** (commander) under Ghorid overlordship. It was **Iltutmish** who obtained formal recognition (*Manshur*) from the Abbasid Caliph of Baghdad in 1229 CE and took the sovereign title of *Sultan*. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - First de facto ruler = **Qutbuddin Aibak** (ruled as *Malik/Sipahsalar* from Lahore; known as *Lakh Baksh*). - First real sovereign Sultan of Delhi = **Iltutmish** (capital Delhi; Caliphal investiture 1229).

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

With reference to Alauddin Khalji's military reforms, which statements is/are correct?

1. He maintained a cash-paid standing army.
2. Dagh branded horses.
3. Chehra / Huliya were soldier descriptive rolls.

A Only 1
B Only 1 and 2
C 1, 2 and 3
D Only 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Statements 1, 2 and 3 are all correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** Alauddin Khalji was the first Sultan of Delhi to establish a massive, centrally recruited, permanent standing army paid **entirely in cash** (*naqd*) from the royal treasury (234 tankas annually for a horseman, with 78 additional tankas for a two-horse soldier/*do-aspa*). - **Statement 2 is correct:** He introduced the system of **Dagh** (branding of horses with the royal emblem) to prevent corrupt soldiers from presenting hired or substandard packhorses during military inspections. - **Statement 3 is correct:** He introduced **Chehra / Huliya** (detailed physical descriptive muster rolls of every recruit) to prevent fraudulent proxy substitutions on the battlefield. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Dagh = Branding of warhorses. - Chehra / Huliya = Descriptive identity rolls of soldiers. - Both reforms were later revived on a grand scale by **Sher Shah Suri** and **Akbar**.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Consider the following statements about Muhammad bin Tughlaq:

1. Major experiments included Daulatabad transfer and token currency.
2. Shahna-i-Mandi was also his market controller.
3. Amir-i-Kohi was Alauddin Khalji's market controller (Shahna-i-Mandi).

A Only 1	**B** 1 and 2
C 2 and 3	**D** 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Only Statement 1 is correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** Muhammad bin Tughlaq (1325–1351 CE) is famous for ambitious state experiments: transferring the capital to **Daulatabad (Devagiri)** in 1327 to govern the Deccan, introducing a **token currency** of bronze/copper (1329–30), and creating the agriculture department **Diwan-i-Amir-i-Kohi**. - **Statement 2 is incorrect:** **Shahna-i-Mandi** was the supreme market superintendent under **Alauddin Khalji's** market regulations, NOT an officer of Muhammad bin Tughlaq. - **Statement 3 is incorrect:** **Amir-i-Kohi** was the director of the agricultural development department under **Muhammad bin Tughlaq**, NOT Alauddin's market controller. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Shahna-i-Mandi* = **Alauddin Khalji** (Market inspector). - *Amir-i-Kohi* = **Muhammad bin Tughlaq** (Agricultural department head).

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Balban emphasised Blood and Iron and elevated royal dignity.

Reason (R): He used titles such as Zil-i-Ilahi / Niyabat-i-Khudai and rituals like Sijda and Paibos.

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)	**B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
C (A) is true, but (R) is false	**D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** Balban formulated an uncompromising, exalted doctrine of monarchy, governed by the policy of **"Blood and Iron"** (*Khoon aur Loha*). He maintained that only an awe-inspiring, unapproachable monarch could inspire obedience in subjects and subdue unruly nobles. - **Reason (R) is correct:** To elevate royal prestige above the nobility, Balban claimed descent from the mythical Turanian hero **Afrasiyab**, proclaimed the Sultan to be the "Shadow of God on Earth" (**Zill-i-Ilahi**) and the "Viceregent of God" (**Niyabat-i-Khudai**), and enforced strict Persian court etiquette, requiring all nobles to perform **Sijda** (prostration) and **Paibos** (kissing the Sultan's feet). - **Why (R) explains (A):** The institutionalization of divine titles and humiliating prostration ceremonies was the deliberate psychological instrument through which Balban visually and symbolically elevated the monarchy, directly implementing his "Blood and Iron" prestige policy. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Persian rituals **Sijda**, **Paibos**, and the spring festival **Nauroz** were introduced to Delhi by **Balban**.

Chapter 03: Regional Kingdoms (विजयनगर, बहमनी व प्रांतीय राज्य) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

With reference to Sharqi Jaunpur, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Firuz Shah founded the city in memory of cousin Jauna Khan.
2. Malik Sarwar made it independent about 1394.
3. Ibrahim Shah made it Siraj / Shiraz-i-Hind.

A 1 and 2
B 1, 2 and 3
C 2 and 3
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (Statements 1, 2 and 3 are all correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** The Sharqi Sultanate was founded in **1394 CE** by the eunuch vizier **Malik Sarwar**, who received the title **Sultan-ush-Sharq** (King of the East) from Sultan Nasiruddin Mahmud Tughlaq during the disintegration of the Delhi Sultanate. - **Statement 2 is correct:** Under the patronizing rule of the Sharqi monarchs (especially Ibrahim Shah Sharqi, 1402–1440 CE), Jaunpur became the foremost imperial center of Islamic learning, theology, Persian literature, and Hindustani classical music in northern India, earning the celebrated cultural title **Shiraz-i-Hind** (*The Shiraz of India*). - **Statement 3 is correct:** Sharqi architecture developed a distinct regional style marked by massive battered sloping propylon screens flanking the central archway and an **absence of tall minarets**, as exemplified by the **Atala Mosque** (1408 CE), **Jami Masjid**, and **Lal Darwaza Masjid**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Shiraz-i-Hind* = **Jaunpur**. - City founded by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** (in memory of Jauna Khan) in 1359 CE; independent Sharqi dynasty founded by **Malik Sarwar** in 1394 CE.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I (State / house)	List-II (Tag)
A Vijayanagara	1 Gulbarga → Bidar
B Bahmani	2 Hampi; Harihara–Bukka 1336
C Bijapur	3 Adil Shahi; Gol Gumbaz
D Golkonda	4 Qutb Shahi; later Hyderabad

Row order is not the answer code.
Code:

A. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3

B. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4

C. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4

D. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4) **Detailed Explanation:** Following the disintegration of the Bahmani Kingdom around 1489–1527 CE, five independent Deccan Sultanates arose: - **A. Adil Shahi → 2. Bijapur:** Founded in 1489 CE by Yusuf Adil Shah; famed for the massive Gol Gumbaz and Ibrahim Rauza. - **B. Nizam Shahi → 1. Ahmadnagar:** Founded in 1490 CE by Malik Ahmad Nizam-ul-Mulk Bahri; famed for Chand Bibi's resistance. - **C. Qutb Shahi → 3. Golkonda / Hyderabad:** Founded in 1512 CE by Sultan Quli Qutb-ul-Mulk; famed for Charminar and diamond trade. - **D. Barid Shahi → 4. Bidar:** Founded in 1492 CE by Qasim Barid; held the former Bahmani capital. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - The fifth sultanate was **Imad Shahi of Berar** (capital Ellichpur/Gawilgarh, founded 1490). - Remember the pairs: Bijapur–Adil Shahi | Ahmadnagar–Nizam Shahi | Golkonda–Qutb Shahi | Bidar–Barid Shahi | Berar–Imad Shahi.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): The Battle of Talikota (1565) crippled Vijayanagara as a great power.

Reason (R): A Deccan alliance killed Rama Raya and sacked Hampi.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B. (A) is false, but (R) is true

C. (A) is true, but (R) is false

D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** The reign of Emperor **Krishnadevaraya (1509–1529 CE)** of the Tuluva dynasty represents the cultural, literary, and military golden age of the **Vijayanagara Empire**. - **Reason (R) is correct:** Krishnadevaraya was an accomplished polymath who authored the celebrated Telugu political treatise **Amuktamalyada** and the Sanskrit drama *Jambavati Kalyanam*. His royal assembly (*Bhuvana Vijayam*) patronized the **Ashtadiggajas** (eight supreme Telugu literary titans), led by laureate **Allasani Peddana** (author of *Manucharitam*) and the witty court poet **Tenali Ramakrishna**. - **Why (R) explains (A):** The personal literary genius of the sovereign combined with his generous, institutionalized patronage of the *Ashtadiggajas* elevated Telugu literature to its peak classical renaissance, directly defining the cultural brilliance asserted in (A). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Ashtadiggajas* = 8 Telugu poets in **Krishnadevaraya's court (Vijayanagara)**. - *Ashtapradhan* = 8-minister administrative council of **Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj**. Never interchange them.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Arrange the following in chronological order:

1. Bahmani founded (1347)
2. Vijayanagara founded (1336)
3. Talikota (1565)
4. Sharqi independence (~1394)

A 2–1–4–3
B 1–2–4–3
C 2–4–1–3
D 2–1–3–4

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (1336 → 1347 → 1394 → 1565) **Detailed Explanation:** The precise chronological sequence is: 1. **Foundation of Vijayanagara Empire (1336 CE):** Established on the banks of the Tungabhadra by brothers Harihara I and Bukka I during the chaotic reign of Muhammad bin Tughlaq, inspired by sage Vidyaranya. 2. **Foundation of Bahmani Kingdom (1347 CE):** Established in the Deccan by Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah (Hasan Gangu) at Gulbarga. 3. **Foundation of Sharqi Sultanate of Jaunpur (1394 CE):** Founded by Malik Sarwar (Khwaja Jahan) as Tughlaq central control collapsed prior to Timur's invasion. 4. **Battle of Talikota (1565 CE):** Historic confrontation on 23 January 1565 where the allied Deccan Sultanates defeated Vijayanagara and devastated Hampi. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Vijayanagara (1336) was founded **11 years before** the Bahmani Kingdom (1347). - Both arose during the reign of Sultan **Muhammad bin Tughlaq**.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Riyaz-ul-Insha — Mahmud Gawan's letters
2. Riyaz-us-Salatin — Bengal history
3. Riyaz-us-Salatin — Gawan's official letters

A 1 only
B 3 only
C 2 and 3 only
D 1 and 2 only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (Only pair 3 is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair 1: Mirat-e-Sikandari — History of Gujarat (Correct):** Written by Sikandar bin Muhammad Manjhu (1611 CE), covering the Gujarat Sultans. - **Pair 2: Burhan-e-Masir — History of Ahmadnagar (Correct):** Composed by Sayyid Ali Tabataba (1599 CE) on the Nizam Shahis. - **Pair 3: Riyaz-us-Salatin — Mahmud Gawan's letters (INCORRECT):** **Riyaz-us-Salatin** is the history of **Bengal** authored by Ghulam Husain Salim in 1788. Mahmud Gawan's collection of letters and state correspondence is titled **Riyaz-ul-Insha**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Riyaz-us-Salatin* = Bengal. - *Riyaz-ul-Insha* = Mahmud Gawan (Bahmani).

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

With reference to Vijayanagara dynasties, which statements is/are correct?

1. Order runs Sangama → Saluva → Tuluva → Aravidu.
2. Krishnadevaraya (1509–1529) belonged to the Tuluva house.
3. Krishnadevaraya wrote Amuktamalyada.

A Only 1
B 1 and 2
C All 1, 2 and 3
D Only 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Statements 1, 2 and 3 are all correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** The Vijayanagara state maintained an aggressive royal monopoly over the import of **Arabian and Persian warhorses** through Portuguese Goa and coastal ports (Honnavar, Bhatkal), as documented by Domingo Paes. - **Statement 2 is correct:** The capital city of **Hampi / Vijayanagara** was protected by massive concentric rings of stone walls that encircled not only residences and palaces, but also extensive **agricultural fields and irrigation canals**, enabling the city to withstand prolonged sieges. - **Statement 3 is correct:** The military-feudal structure was organized under the **Nayankara system**, where military commanders (*Amaranayakas*) were granted revenue tracts (*amaram*) in return for maintaining a fixed quota of foot-soldiers, cavalry, and war elephants. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - The *Nayankara* system was the Vijayanagara counterpart to the Delhi Sultanate's *Iqta* system.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Consider the following statements about Bahmani administration:

1. Hasan Gangu founded Bahmani as Alauddin Bahman Shah in 1347.
2. Mahmud Gawan organised eight tarafs.
3. Gawan was executed in 1481.

A Only 1
B Only 1 and 2
C 1, 2 and 3
D 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Statements 1, 2 and 3 are all correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** The Bahmani Kingdom was established in **1347 CE** by **Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah** (an Afghan officer originally known as Hasan Gangu), who revolted against Muhammad bin Tughlaq. - **Statement 2 is correct:** The initial capital was established at **Ahsanabad (Gulbarga)**; it was later shifted to **Muhammadabad (Bidar)** in 1424 CE by Sultan Ahmad Shah Wali due to its better climate and strategic location. - **Statement 3 is correct:** The kingdom achieved its administrative and military zenith under prime minister **Mahmud Gawan** (1463–1481 CE), an Iranian merchant-statesman who divided the realm into eight provinces (*tarafs*) and founded the great Madrasa of Bidar. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - First Bahmani capital = **Gulbarga** (1347–1424 CE). - Second Bahmani capital = **Bidar** (1424–1527 CE).

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Raichur (1520) and Talikota (1565) had the same political result for Vijayanagara.

Reason (R): Raichur was a Krishnadevaraya victory, while Talikota was a catastrophic defeat.

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B (A) is false, but (R) is true

C (A) is true, but (R) is false

D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (Assertion A is false, but Reason R is true) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is false:** The Bahmani Kingdom did **NOT** remain a unified empire down to the 18th century. Following the unjust execution of Mahmud Gawan in 1481 CE and the weakness of later Sultans, the kingdom fragmented between 1489 and 1527 CE into **five independent Deccan Sultanates** (Ahmadnagar, Bijapur, Golkonda, Bidar, Berar). - **Reason (R) is true:** Chronic factional warfare raged within the Bahmani nobility between the **Deccanis** (native Indian-born Muslims and local converts) and the **Afaqis / Pardesis** (foreign newcomers from Persia, Turkey, and Central Asia), which fatally undermined imperial unity. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - The *Deccani* vs. *Afaqi* ethnic factionalism was the direct internal cause of the disintegration of the Bahmani state.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I	List-II
A Ahmadnagar	1 Barid Shahi
B Bidar	2 Nizam Shahi
C Berar	3 Imad Shahi
D Kitab-i-Nauras	4 Ibrahim Adil Shah II

Row order is not the answer code.
Code:

A A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4

B A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3

C A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4

D A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Gol Gumbaz → 2. Bijapur:** Mausoleum of Muhammad Adil Shah (1656 CE) at Bijapur, boasting one of the largest unsupported acoustic dome spaces in the world with a famous "whispering gallery". - **B. Charminar → 1. Hyderabad:** Grand ceremonial four-minaret monument constructed in 1591 CE by Muhammad Quli Qutb Shah at Hyderabad to commemorate the eradication of a devastating plague. - **C. Atala Masjid → 3. Jaunpur:** Completed in 1408 CE by Ibrahim Shah Sharqi at Jaunpur (Uttar Pradesh). - **D. Mahmud Gawan Madrasa → 4. Bidar:** Monumental three-storey theological college with minarets and glazed blue tiles built in 1472 CE by Mahmud Gawan at Bidar. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Gol Gumbaz = **Bijapur** (Adil Shahi). - Charminar = **Hyderabad** (Qutb Shahi). - Mahmud Gawan Madrasa = **Bidar** (Bahmani).

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

With reference to Zain-ul-Abidin of Kashmir, which statements is/are correct?

1. He is called Bud Shah and ruled about 1420–1470.
2. He abolished jaziya and cow slaughter and restored temples.
3. Sriya Bhatt was his Hindu minister; Zaina Lanka stood on Wular Lake.

A Only 1, 2 and 3
B 2 and 3
C Only 1
D Only 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Statements 1, 2 and 3 are all correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** Zain-ul-Abidin enacted total religious reconciliation: he abolished Jizya and the cremation tax on Hindus, banned cow slaughter, and restored sacred shrines. - **Statement 2 is correct:** He was an engineering visionary who constructed extensive canals (e.g. Kakapur canal) and built the artificial island **Zaina Lank** in **Wular Lake**, upon which he erected a palace and mosque. - **Statement 3 is correct:** He patronized the continuation of Kalhana's *Rajatarangini* by commissioning historian **Jonaraja** (Second Rajatarangini) and subsequently **Srivara** (Third Rajatarangini), bringing the historical chronicle down to his reign. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Kalhana wrote *Rajatarangini* (12th c.); **Jonaraja** and **Srivara** continued it under **Zain-ul-Abidin (15th c.)**.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Which one of the following is NOT correctly matched?

A Atala Masjid — Sharqi Jaunpur
B Teen Darwaza — also Bidar Fort's only name for the same gate
C Tin Darwaza — Bidar Fort
D Lal Darwaza Masjid — Sharqi Jaunpur

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (Tin Darwaza — Bidar is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Dakhil Darwaza — Gaur (Correct):** Celebrated gateway in Gaur (Bengal) built by Barbak Shah. - **B. Tin Darwaza — Bidar (INCORRECT):** The **Tin Darwaza** (or *Teen Darwaza*) is the famous triple-arched gate in **Ahmedabad (Gujarat)** built by Sultan Ahmad Shah I in 1415 CE. It is not located in Bidar. - **C. Lal Darwaza — Jaunpur (Correct):** Mosque and gateway complex built by Bibi Raji in Jaunpur (UP). - **D. Alai Darwaza — Delhi (Correct):** Masterpiece gateway built by Alauddin Khalji (1311 CE) at the Qutb complex. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Tin Darwaza* = **Ahmedabad (Gujarat)**.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

With reference to Deccan Sultanates after 1518, which statements is/are correct?

1. Five states were Bijapur, Golkonda, Ahmadnagar, Bidar, and Berar.
2. Abul Hasan Qutb Shah of Golkonda fell to Aurangzeb in 1687.
3. Charminar belongs to Qutb Shahi Hyderabad.

A Only 2 and 3
B Only 1
C Only 1 and 2
D 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (Statements 1, 2 and 3 are all correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** The **Vitthala Temple** at Hampi represents the peak of Vijayanagara architectural virtuosity, famous for its magnificent **monolithic stone chariot** (*Garuda shrine*). - **Statement 2 is correct:** Its grand *Ranga Mandapa* features **56 musical pillars** (also called *Sa-Re-Ga-Ma pillars*) that emit distinct musical notes when gently tapped. - **Statement 3 is correct:** Characteristic features of Vijayanagara temple architecture include monumental soaring entrance gateways called **Raya Gopurams**, elaborately sculpted pillars depicting rearing mythical beasts (*Yalis*), and ornate wedding pavilions called **Kalyana Mandapas**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Musical pillars & Stone Chariot = **Vitthala Temple at Hampi (Vijayanagara)**. - *Raya Gopuram* = Monumental temple gateway named after Vijayanagara Rayas.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Consider the following statements:

1. Nayankara / amara is identical with Delhi Sultanate iqta practice.
2. Nayankara is identical with Delhi Sultanate iqta.
3. Mahanavami was a major Vijayanagara festival.

A 1 and 2
B 2 and 3
C Only 3
D 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Only Statement 3 is correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The **Nayankara system** was a **provincial military tenure system**, NOT an urban trade guild. The *Nayakas* were military generals assigned revenue tracts called *Amaram*. - **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The **Ayagar system** was NOT a judicial council of royal princes; it was an autonomous **village administrative council comprising 12 hereditary functionaries** (headman/Reddi, accountant/Karnam, blacksmith, watchman/Talaiyari, washerman, etc.) who collectively managed village affairs and held tax-free plots (*Manyam*). - **Statement 3 is correct:** Amaranayakas were required to maintain a designated contingent of horses, elephants, and foot soldiers for the imperial army and submit an annual tribute to the king at the Mahanavami festival. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Nayankara system* = Provincial military land tenure (*Amaram*). - *Ayagar system* = 12 hereditary village functionaries.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Among the regional states of this chapter, only Sharqi Jaunpur has its capital in modern Uttar Pradesh.

Reason (R): Atala and Lal Darwaza mosques are classic Sharqi monuments at Jaunpur.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B. (A) is false, but (R) is true

C. (A) is true, but (R) is false

D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** A succession of prominent foreign travelers visited the Vijayanagara Empire across two centuries: Italian merchant **Nicolo Conti** (visited c. 1420 under Devaraya I), Persian ambassador **Abdur Razzaq** (visited c. 1443 under Devaraya II), and Portuguese travelers **Duarte Barbosa**, **Domingo Paes** (under Krishnadevaraya), and **Fernao Nuniz** (under Achyuta Deva Raya). - **Reason (R) is correct:** Abdur Razzaq, an envoy of Timurid ruler Shah Rukh of Persia, famously wrote in his travelogue *Matla-us-Sadain*: "The city of Bijanagar is such that eyes have not seen nor ears heard of any place to resemble it upon the whole earth." - **Why (R) does NOT explain (A):** Abdur Razzaq's descriptive praise illustrates his personal admiration for Hampi's grandeur, but does not provide the causal explanation for why multiple travelers across Portugal, Italy, and Persia journeyed there (which was motivated by lucrative spice and horse trade, diplomacy, and exploration). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Nicolo Conti = Visited under **Devaraya I** (1420 CE). - Abdur Razzaq = Visited under **Devaraya II** (1443 CE). - Domingo Paes = Visited under **Krishnadevaraya** (c. 1520 CE). - Fernao Nuniz = Visited under **Achyuta Deva Raya** (c. 1535 CE).

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Arrange Vijayanagara dynasty houses in order:

1. Tuluva
2. Sangama
3. Aravidu
4. Saluva

A. 2–4–1–3

B. 2–1–4–3

C. 4–2–1–3

D. 2–4–3–1

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Sangama → Saluva → Tuluva → Aravidu) **Detailed Explanation:** The Vijayanagara Empire was governed successively by four distinct dynasties: 1. **Sangama Dynasty (1336–1485 CE):** Founded by Harihara I and Bukka I; peak under Devaraya II (149 years). 2. **Saluva Dynasty (1485–1505 CE):** Founded through the "First Usurpation" by Saluva Narasimha to counter imperial disintegration (20 years). 3. **Tuluva Dynasty (1505–1570 CE):** Founded through the "Second Usurpation" by Vira Narasimha; reached its zenith under **Krishnadevaraya (1509–1529 CE)**; suffered defeat at Talikota in 1565 under Rama Raya. 4. **Aravidu Dynasty (1570–1646 CE):** Founded by Tirumala Raya (brother of Rama Raya); shifted capital to Penukonda and later Chandragiri. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Remember the sequence: **Sangama → Saluva → Tuluva → Aravidu**. - Krishnadevaraya belonged to the **Tuluva** dynasty, NOT Sangama.

Chapter 04: Bhakti & Sufi Movements — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

With reference to early southern Bhakti, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Nayanars were Shiva devotees.
2. Alvars were Vishnu devotees.
3. Both traditions flourished mainly in 7th–12th century Tamil land before the north sant wave.

A Only 2 and 3
B Only 1
C 1 and 2
D Only 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (Only 1, 2 and 3 are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** The Nayanars were a group of 63 Tamil poet-saints of the 6th–9th centuries devoted to Lord Shiva. Their hymns were gathered by Nambiyandar Nambi into the canonical scripture *Tirumurai*, which includes the venerated *Tevaram* (composed by Sambandar, Appar, and Sundarar) and *Tiruvacakam* (composed by Manikkavacakar). - **Statement 2 is correct:** The Alvars were 12 Tamil poet-saints of the 6th–9th centuries devoted to Lord Vishnu and his avatars (especially Krishna and Rama). Their passionate devotional hymns were compiled by Nathamuni into the celebrated anthology *Nalayira Divya Prabandham* ("4000 Divine Hymns"), revered as the "Tamil Veda". Notable Alvars include Nammalvar, Periyalvar, and the famous female mystic Andal. - **Statement 3 is correct:** Both the Alvar and Nayanar devotional traditions originated and flourished between the 7th and 10th centuries CE (continuing through the 12th century under Imperial Chola patronage) in the Tamil country, laying the philosophical and emotional groundwork for bhakti centuries before the 14th–16th century north Indian sant movement (Ramananda, Kabir, Nanak, Surdas). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Mnemonic Anchor:* **Al-Vi** (Alvars = Vishnu) vs **Nay-Shi** (Nayanars = Shiva / 3 eyes of Shiva / Netra).

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I (Saint)	List-II (Tag)
A Surdas	1 Awadhi; Ramcharitmanas
B Tulsidas	2 Braj; Sursagar
C Kabir	3 Nirguna; Bijak; Maghar
D Mirabai	4 Rajasthan Krishna devotee

Row order is not the answer code.
Code:

A A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3

B A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4

C A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4

D A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Surdas → 2. Braj; Sursagar:** Sant Surdas, the blind bard of Braj and disciple of Vallabhacharya, composed his monumental devotional anthology *Sursagar* in Brajbhasha, depicting the childhood pastimes (*Bal-lila*) of Krishna. - **B. Tulsidas → 1. Awadhi; Ramcharitmanas:** Goswami Tulsidas composed the magnum opus *Ramcharitmanas* in Awadhi (eastern Hindi dialect) during Akbar's reign, making the story of Rama accessible to the common masses. - **C. Kabir → 3. Nirguna; Bijak; Maghar:** Sant Kabir was the prominent exponent of Nirguna Rama devotion; his sayings were compiled in the *Bijak*, and he deliberately chose to pass away at Maghar (Sant Kabir Nagar) to challenge orthodox superstitions regarding salvation in Kashi. - **D. Mirabai → 4. Rajasthan Krishna devotee:** Mirabai was a Rajput princess of Merta (married into the royal house of Mewar) whose impassioned lyrical songs (*Padas*) dedicated to *Giridhar Gopal* became central to Rajasthani devotional literature. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Dialect Trap:* Tulsidas wrote *Ramcharitmanas* in **Awadhi**, whereas Surdas composed *Sursagar* in **Brajbhasha**.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Saguna bhakti worships a formed deity such as Rama or Krishna.

Reason (R): Nirguna bhakti, as in Kabir and Nanak, worships the formless One.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B. (A) is false, but (R) is true

C. (A) is true, but (R) is false

D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** Saguna bhakti (*sa-guna* = endowed with attributes) conceptualizes God as an anthropomorphic personal deity who manifests in the physical world through avatars, iconography, and divine sports (*lila*), focusing on personal forms like Rama (Tulsidas) or Krishna (Surdas, Mirabai, Chaitanya). - **Reason (R) is correct:** Nirguna bhakti (*nir-guna* = without anthropomorphic attributes) conceives the Divine as the formless, unmanifest, omnipresent, and transcendent Absolute (*Nirakara Parabrahma*), rejecting idol worship and ritualism, as taught by Sant Kabir (*Rama* as universal consciousness) and Guru Nanak (*Ik Onkar*). - **Why (R) does NOT explain (A):** Both statements are independently accurate definitions describing the two parallel philosophical wings of the medieval Bhakti movement. Reason (R) defines the contrasting tradition of Nirguna theology; it does not provide the causal reason or historical mechanism for why Saguna worshippers venerate physical forms. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *A/R Diagnostic:* When Assertion defines Term A and Reason defines its contrasting counterpart Term B, both statements are true, but Reason is a conceptual contrast rather than a causal explanation → Select **Option A**.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Arrange the following saints roughly in chronological order:

1. Nanak (1469–1539)
2. Namdev (~1270–1350)
3. Kabir (15th c.)
4. Chaitanya (1486–1533)

A. 2–1–3–4

B. 2–3–1–4

C. 3–2–1–4

D. 2–3–4–1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (2–3–1–4: Namdev → Kabir → Nanak → Chaitanya) **Detailed Explanation:** - **1. Sant Namdev (~1270–1350 CE):** Earliest of this group; lived in late 13th to mid-14th century Maharashtra as a foundational pillar of the Varkari tradition of Pandharpur. - **2. Sant Kabir (c. 1398/early 15th c. – 1518 CE):** Banaras weaver-saint who flourished throughout the 15th century. - **3. Guru Nanak Dev (1469–1539 CE):** Born in Talwandi in 1469 CE; founded the Sikh faith during the late 15th and early 16th centuries. - **4. Chaitanya Mahaprabhu (1486–1533 CE):** Born in Navadvipa (Bengal) in 1486 CE; younger contemporary of Guru Nanak. - **Chronological Sequence:** Namdev (2) → Kabir (3) → Nanak (1) → Chaitanya (4) = **2–3–1–4**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Birth Year Anchor:* Nanak (1469) is older than Chaitanya (1486) by 17 years. In north India's saintly spine, the broad chronological order is: **Namdev → Ramananda → Kabir → Guru Nanak → Chaitanya → Surdas → Tulsidas → Dadu Dayal**.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Ramananda — north Rama bhakti; Prayag birth; Hindi teaching
2. Ramanuja — south Vishishtadvaita philosopher
3. Ramananda — identical with Ramanuja as the same person

A 1 only	**B** 3 only
C 2 and 3 only	**D** 1 and 2 only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (3 only is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** Swami Ramananda was born at Prayagraj (UP), preached devotion to Rama and Sita in vernacular Hindi, and welcomed disciples of all castes in northern India. - **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** Sri Ramanujacharya (1017–1137 CE) was the classical south Indian philosopher who established the *Vishishtadvaita* (Qualified Non-Dualism) school of Vedanta and revitalized the Sri Vaishnava sampradaya. - **Pair 3 is NOT correctly matched (Correct Answer):** Ramananda and Ramanuja were two entirely different personalities separated by centuries and geography. Ramanuja lived in Tamil Nadu in the 11th–12th century writing in Sanskrit, whereas Ramananda lived in North India (Varanasi/Prayag) in the 14th–15th century preaching in Hindi. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Name Distinction:* Ramanuja = South India, 11th–12th c., Sanskrit theological treatise, Vishishtadvaita. Ramananda = North India, 14th–15th c., Hindi vernacular hymns, caste-free Rama bhakti.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

With reference to the Chishti line, which statements is/are correct?

1. Order runs Moinuddin → Nizamuddin → Baba Farid → Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki → Nasiruddin Chiragh.
2. Chishtis typically accepted state wealth like the Suhrawardis.
3. Chishtis stressed poverty, sama, and ziyarat.

A 1 and 2	**B** 2 and 3
C Only 3	**D** 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Only 3 is correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The authentic spiritual succession (*shajra*) of the premier Chishti masters runs: Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti (Ajmer) → Khwaja Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki (Delhi) → Baba Fariduddin Ganj-i-Shakar (Ajodhan) → Hazrat Nizamuddin Auliya (Delhi) → Hazrat Nasiruddin Chiragh-i-Dehli (Delhi). - **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Chishti saints strictly rejected royal patronage, state grants (*in'am / madad-i-ma'ash*), and government positions, upholding voluntary poverty (*faqr*) and reliance on unsolicited gifts (*futuh*). In sharp contrast, the Suhrawardi saints of Multan willingly accepted royal endowments, wealth, and state appointments such as *Shaikh-ul-Islam*. - **Statement 3 is correct:** Core tenets of the Chishti order included ascetic poverty, mutual tolerance, spiritual musical auditions (*Sama*), hospitality to all visitors regardless of faith, and pilgrimage to saints' tombs (*Ziyarat*). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Chishti Succession Mnemonic:* **M**-oinuddin → **Q**-utbuddin → **F**-arid → **N**-izamuddin → **C**-hiragh (**M-Q-F-N-C**).

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Consider the following guru–disciple pairs:

1. Ramananda — Kabir and Ravidas
2. Vallabhacharya — Surdas
3. Nizamuddin Auliya — Amir Khusrau

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

A Only 1
B Only 1 and 2
C All 1, 2 and 3
D 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (All 1, 2 and 3 are correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** Swami Ramananda initiated twelve direct disciples (*Dwadash Mahabhagavatas*), including Sant Kabir (weaver/Julaha) and Sant Ravidas (leather-worker/Chamar). - **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** Mahaprabhu Vallabhacharya initiated Sant Surdas into the *Pushtimarg* at Gaughat, designating him as the foremost hymn-singer (*Kirtankar*) among the *Ashtachhap* poets. - **Pair 3 is correctly matched:** Hazrat Nizamuddin Auliya was the spiritual preceptor (*pir*) of the celebrated poet and scholar Amir Khusrau (*murid*); both lie buried in the same complex in Delhi. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Distractor Alert:* Bhai Mardana was the musical disciple/companion of Guru Nanak, not Kabir or Surdas.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Fawaid-ul-Fuad records Nizamuddin's conversations.

Reason (R): It was compiled by Amir Hasan Sijzi, not by Amir Khusrau.

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
B (A) is false, but (R) is true
C (A) is true, but (R) is false
D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** *Fawaid-ul-Fuad* ("Morals of the Heart") is the pioneering *malfuzat* text that faithfully records the spoken assemblies, spiritual teachings, and moral discourses of Hazrat Nizamuddin Auliya in Delhi between 1307 and 1322 CE. - **Reason (R) is correct:** The text was compiled by Amir Hasan Sijzi (Hasan Dehlavi), who recorded the master's words and presented each volume to Nizamuddin Auliya for personal authentication, distinguishing it from the works of Amir Khusrau. - **Why (R) does NOT explain (A): Attribution/excavator detail asserted as explanation of content. Both statements are true facts, but Reason (R) is not the cause of Assertion (A).** Sijzi's dedicated compilation process is the exact reason why Nizamuddin's oral table-talks survived as a permanent historical record rather than remaining oral traditions. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Compiler Trap:* The compilation of *Fawaid-ul-Fuad* is often falsely attributed to Amir Khusrau in exam options because of Khusrau's prominent profile. The real author is **Amir Hasan Sijzi**.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Match List-I with List-II (Vedanta school ↔ founder):

List-I	List-II
A Advaita	1 Ramanuja
B Vishishtadvaita	2 Shankara
C Dvaita	3 Madhva
D Shuddhadvaita	4 Vallabhacharya

Row order is not the answer code.
Code:

A A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4

B A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3

C A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4

D A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Advaita (Non-Dualism) → 2. Adi Shankaracharya (8th c.):** Pure monism; Brahman alone is ultimate reality, the empirical universe is an illusion (*Maya*), and the individual self (*Atman*) is fundamentally identical to Brahman. - **B. Vishishtadvaita (Qualified Non-Dualism) → 1. Ramanujacharya (11th–12th c.):** Non-dualism qualified by real distinct attributes; individual souls (*chit*) and material nature (*achit*) are organic attributes of the personal Supreme Reality (Vishnu/Narayana). - **C. Dvaita (Dualism) → 3. Madhvacharya (13th c.):** Absolute dualism; God, individual souls, and material objects are eternally distinct entities (*Pancha Bheda*). - **D. Shuddhadvaita (Pure Non-Dualism) → 4. Vallabhacharya (15th–16th c.):** Monism without Maya; the cosmos is a pure, real manifestation of Krishna, accessed through divine grace (*Pushti*). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *The Fifth School:* Remember that **Nimbarkacharya** founded **Dvaitadvaita** (Dualistic Non-Dualism / Bhedabheda), while **Chaitanya Mahaprabhu** inspired **Achintya Bhedabheda**.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

With reference to regional Bhakti, which statements is/are correct?

1. Basavanna led Lingayat / Virashaiva reform with Ishtalinga and Anubhava Mantapa.
2. Varkari tradition centres on Pandharpur / Vithoba.
3. Jayadeva wrote Gita Govinda in Odisha.

A Only 1 and 3

B 1, 2 and 3

C Only 1 and 2

D 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (1, 2 and 3 are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** In 12th-century Karnataka (during the rule of Kalachuri king Bijjala), Basavanna launched the Virashaiva/Lingayat reform movement. He discarded temple worship, Vedic rituals, and caste hierarchies, instructed followers to wear a personal Shiva linga (*Ishtalinga*) on the chest, composed poetic epigrams (*Vachanas*), and established the *Anubhava Mantapa* (the first egalitarian spiritual parliament). - **Statement 2 is correct:** The Varkari (*vari* = regular pilgrimage) tradition of Maharashtra is centered upon the temple of Lord Vithoba (Vitthala / Krishna) and Rakhumai at Pandharpur along the Chandrabhaga (Bhima) river. - **Statement 3 is correct:** The poet Jayadeva (12th century), court poet of King Lakshmana Sena of Bengal/Odisha, composed the Sanskrit lyrical epic *Gita Govinda* celebrating the divine love of Radha and Krishna, which profoundly influenced eastern Vaishnava devotionalism and the Jagannath cult of Puri. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Regional Anchors:* Karnataka = Basavanna (Virashaiva); Maharashtra = Jnaneshwar, Namdev, Tukaram (Varkari / Pandharpur); Assam = Shankaradeva (Satra / Namghar); Bengal/Odisha = Jayadeva & Chaitanya.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Which one of the following is NOT correctly matched?

A. Andal — Tamil Alvar woman saint

B. Baba Farid — nirguna Kashi weaver identical with Kabir

C. Baba Farid — Chishti saint of Ajodhan; verses in Adi Granth

D. Mirabai — Rajasthan Krishna devotee

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (Baba Farid — nirguna Kashi weaver identical with Kabir is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Option B is incorrectly matched (Correct Answer):** Shaikh Fariduddin Ganj-i-Shakar (Baba Farid, 1173–1266 CE) was an eminent Chishti Sufi saint of Punjab based at Ajodhan (Pakpattan). The description "nirguna Kashi weaver" belongs exclusively to Sant **Kabir** (who lived in Varanasi). - **Option A is correctly matched:** Andal (Kodhai) was the only female saint among the 12 Alvars of Tamil Nadu; she composed the *Tiruppavai* and *Nacciyar Tirumoli*. - **Option C is correctly matched:** Baba Farid's hymns in Punjabi were so spiritually profound that Guru Arjan Dev incorporated 134 of his hymns (*saloks*) into the Sikh holy book, the *Guru Granth Sahib* (Adi Granth). - **Option D is correctly matched:** Mirabai (16th century) was the royal mystic of Rajasthan whose life and poetry were entirely surrendered to Lord Krishna (*Giridhar Gopal*). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Cross-Religious Scripture Link:* Baba Farid is the foremost Sufi master whose verses are preserved in the Sikh *Guru Granth Sahib*.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

With reference to UP-linked saints, which statements is/are correct?

1. Kabir's Bijak has Ramaini / Sabda / Sakhi; death at Maghar.
2. Tulsidas belongs to Awadhi UP; Surdas to the Braj belt.
3. Gorakhnath is linked with Gorakhpur.

A. 1 and 2

B. 2 and 3

C. 1 and 3

D. 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (1, 2 and 3 are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** The authentic scripture of the Kabir Panth is the *Bijak*, divided into three major poetic formats: *Sakhi* (aphorisms/rhymed couplets), *Sabda* (devotional songs/hymns), and *Ramaini* (extended doctrinal verses). Kabir lived in Varanasi but deliberately chose to die in Maghar (Sant Kabir Nagar district, UP). - **Statement 2 is correct:** Goswami Tulsidas was born in Rajapur (Banda/Chitrakoot district, UP) and authored the *Ramcharitmanas* in Awadhi; Sant Surdas was born at Runkata (Agra-Mathura belt, UP) and composed *Sursagar* in Brajbhasha. - **Statement 3 is correct:** Guru Gorakhnath, the legendary 11th–12th century master of the Nath tradition, established his primary seat (*dhuni*) at Gorakhpur (eastern UP), which became the monastic center of the Gorakhnath Math. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *UP Geographic Triad:* Maghar = Kabir's samadhi/mazar; Rajapur/Varanasi/Ayodhya = Tulsidas; Gorakhpur = Gorakhnath.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Consider the following statements about Sufi orders:

1. Suhrawardi Multan saints accepted state wealth.
2. Naqshbandi reformers under Ahmad Sirhindi opposed syncretism.
3. Moinuddin's order name comes from Chisht in Afghanistan, not a village in Ajmer.

A Only 1
B Only 1 and 2
C Only 1, 2 and 3
D Only 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Only 1, 2 and 3 are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** The Suhrawardi order, established in India by Shaikh Bahauddin Zakariya at Multan, believed that worldly wealth does not compromise inner piety. They accepted land grants, treasures, and administrative titles (Zakariya accepted the post of *Shaikh-ul-Islam* from Sultan Iltutmish). - **Statement 2 is correct:** The Naqshbandi order in India, led by Shaikh Ahmad Sirhindi (*Mujaddid Alf-i-Sani*, 1564–1624 CE), strongly resisted Akbar's liberal syncretism (*Sulh-i-Kul*), countered the pantheistic concept of *Wahdat-ul-Wujud* with *Wahdat-ush-Shuhud*, and advocated rigid compliance with Islamic *Sharia*. - **Statement 3 is correct:** The Chishti order derives its name from **Chisht**, a village near Herat in western Afghanistan, where it was founded in the 10th century by Abu Ishaq Shami. Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti brought the lineage from Chisht to Ajmer in 1192 CE. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Silsilah Characteristics:* Chishti = Poverty, rejection of state courts, Sama music, universal tolerance; Suhrawardi = Accepted royal gifts, state titles, anti-Sama; Naqshbandi = Strict Sharia orthodoxy, anti-syncretism, silent dhikr.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Every Bhakti and Sufi saint mixed doctrines into one syncretic religion.

Reason (R): Bhakti was mainly an intra-Hindu reform against empty ritual.

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
B (A) is false, but (R) is true
C (A) is true, but (R) is false
D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** ((A) is false, but (R) is true) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is incorrect:** The medieval devotional movements never coalesced into a single syncretic religion. While saints like Kabir and Guru Nanak preached a shared spiritual path transcending sectarian identities, other Bhakti figures (like Tulsidas, Ramanuja, and Vallabhacharya) remained firmly rooted within classical Vedic/Vaishnava traditions. Similarly, orthodox Sufis (such as Shaikh Ahmad Sirhindi of the Naqshbandi silsilah) actively combated syncretism and insisted on uncompromised Sunni orthodoxy. - **Reason (R) is correct:** The Bhakti movement fundamentally emerged as an internal socio-spiritual revitalization within Hinduism, opposing excessive priestly ritualism, animal sacrifices, and caste discrimination by championing direct, loving, personal devotion to God in the common vernacular. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Extreme Words Trap:* Beware of absolute qualifiers like "Every", "All", and "Always" in historical questions. Medieval India fostered a plural composite culture, not a homogenized single religion.

Q15 **UP RO/ARO 2014**

Arrange the Chishti succession correctly:

1. Nizamuddin
2. Moinuddin
3. Baba Farid
4. Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki

A 2–4–3–1

B 2–3–4–1

C 4–2–3–1

D 2–4–1–3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (2–4–3–1: Moinuddin → Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki → Baba Farid → Nizamuddin) **Detailed Explanation:** - **1. Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti (1141–1236 CE):** Brought the Chishti silsilah to India; settled at Ajmer. - **2. Khwaja Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki (1173–1235 CE):** Chief disciple of Moinuddin; established the Chishti center in Delhi (the Qutb Minar was named in his honor). - **3. Shaikh Fariduddin Ganj-i-Shakar / Baba Farid (1173–1266 CE):** Disciple and successor of Bakhtiyar Kaki; established his seat at Ajodhan (Pakpattan, Punjab). - **4. Hazrat Nizamuddin Auliya (1238–1325 CE):** Premier disciple of Baba Farid; made Delhi the preeminent center of Indian Sufism. - **Correct Succession Order:** 2 (Moinuddin) → 4 (Qutbuddin Kaki) → 3 (Baba Farid) → 1 (Nizamuddin) = **2–4–3–1**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Chishti Lineage Chain:* Moinuddin (Ajmer) → Qutbuddin Kaki (Delhi) → Baba Farid (Ajodhan) → Nizamuddin Auliya (Delhi) → Nasiruddin Chiragh-i-Dehli (Delhi).

Chapter 05: Medieval Literature & Chronicles — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Which is NOT correctly matched?

A Tabaqat-i-Nasiri — Minhaj-us-Siraj Juzjani

B Tarikh-i-Firozshahi — Shams-i-Siruj-Alif

C Tughlaqnama — Ibn Battuta

D Humayunnama — Gulbadan Begum

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Tughlaqnama — Ibn Battuta is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Option C is incorrectly matched (Correct Answer):** *Tughlaqnama* was composed by the great poet **Amir Khusrau** in 1320 CE to commemorate Sultan Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq's rise to power after overthrowing Khusrau Khan. Ibn Battuta was a Moroccan globe-trotter who arrived in Delhi during Muhammad bin Tughlaq's reign and composed his celebrated Arabic travelogue, the **Kitab-ur-Rihla** (*The Journey*), not *Tughlaqnama*. - **Option A is correctly matched:** *Tabaqat-i-Nasiri* was written by Minhaj-us-Siraj Juzjani, dedicated to Sultan Nasiruddin Mahmud (1246–1266 CE); it is the premier authority on the early Ilbari Turkish Sultans. - **Option B is correctly matched:** *Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi* was composed by Shams-i-Siraj Afif (often printed as Shams-i-Siraj 'Alif'), who wrote a comprehensive history focused on Firuz Shah Tughlaq's peaceful reign and public welfare works, picking up from where Barani's narrative ended. - **Option D is correctly matched:** *Humayunnama* was composed in Persian by Gulbadan Begum (Babur's daughter and Humayun's sister) on the order of Emperor Akbar, providing unique inside details of the early Mughal household. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Two Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahis:* Both Ziauddin Barani and Shams-i-Siraj Afif wrote books titled *Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi*. - *Tughlaqnama Authorship:* *Tughlaqnama* is authored by **Amir Khusrau**, NOT Ibn Battuta.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Match List-I (Author) with List-II (Work):

List-I (Author)	List-II (Work)
A Mulla Daud	1 Chandayan
B Damodar Kavi	2 Ashiqa
C Somnath	3 Padmavati Katha
D Amir Khusro	4 Rag Vibodh

Options:

A 1-3-2-4

B 1-3-4-2

C 2-4-1-3

D 1-2-3-4

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (1-3-4-2: A-1, B-3, C-4, D-2) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Mulla Daud → 1. Chandayan:** Mulla Daud composed *Chandayan* (the romance of Lorik and Chanda) in 1379 CE in early Awadhi, widely recognized as the earliest Sufi Premakhyan in Hindi literature. - **B. Damodar Kavi → 3. Padmavati Katha:** Composed an early romance based on the story of Padmavati in early Rajasthani/Apabhramsha vernacular, predating Malik Muhammad Jayasi's Awadhi epic *Padmavat*. - **C. Somnath → 4. Rag Vibodh:** Pandit Somanatha wrote the Sanskrit music treatise *Raga Vibodha* in **1609 CE**. - **D. Amir Khusrau → 2. Ashiqa:** Amir Khusrau wrote the romantic Persian masnavi *Ashiqa* / *Deval Rani Khizr Khan*. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Primary Anchor:* Mulla Daud–Chandayan (1) and Damodar Kavi–Padmavati Katha (3) leave **C-4 / D-2** → code **1-3-4-2** (**Option B**).

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Arrange the following events in chronological order:

1. Murder of Abul Fazl
2. Death of Sheikh Mubarak
3. Death of Faizi
4. Death of Daniyal

Options:

A 2-1-4-3

B 3-2-1-4

C 2-3-1-4

D 2-4-3-1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (3-2-1-4: Death of Faizi → Death of Sheikh Mubarak → Murder of Abul Fazl → Death of Daniyal) **Detailed Explanation:** - **3. Death of Faizi (1595 CE):** The poet laureate of Akbar's court passed away of illness in October 1595 CE at Agra. - **2. Death of Sheikh Mubarak (1597 CE):** Father of Faizi and Abul Fazl, who framed the *Mahzar* of 1579, passed away in the late 1590s. - **1. Murder of Abul Fazl (August 1602 CE):** Abul Fazl, author of *Akbarnama*, was assassinated near Antri (near Gwalior) by Bir Singh Deo Bundela under orders from Prince Salim (Jahangir). - **4. Death of Prince Daniyal (April 1604 CE):** Akbar's third son died of excessive drinking at Burhanpur in 1604 CE, just a year before Akbar's own death in 1605 CE. - **Chronological Sequence:** 3 (Faizi, 1595) → 2 (Mubarak, 1597) → 1 (Abul Fazl, 1602) → 4 (Daniyal, 1604) = **3-2-1-4**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Abul Fazl Murder Year:* Abul Fazl was assassinated in **1602 CE**. He died *after* his brother Faizi (1595) and father Mubarak (1597), but *before* Prince Daniyal (1604) and Emperor Akbar (1605).

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

A(A): Babur wrote Tuzk-e-Babri in Chagatai Turki. R(R): Turki was official Mughal court language.

A Both true, R not explanation	B A false, R true
C A true, R false	D Both true, R explains A

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Assertion (A) is true, but Reason (R) is false) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** Babur wrote his intimate memoirs, *Tuzk-e-Babri* (*Baburnama*), in his mother tongue **Chagatai Turki**, providing rich descriptions of the geography, flora, fauna, people, and battles of Fergana, Kabul, and Hindustan. - **Reason (R) is incorrect:** Turki was **never** the official administrative language of the Mughal court. From the Sultanate through the Mughal era, **Persian** (*Farsi*) served as the sole language of royal chanceries, revenue documentation, and imperial administration. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Language Trap:* *Baburnama* is an isolated exception written in Chagatai Turki; all other official Mughal chronicles were composed in **Persian**.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Match List-I (Disciple) with List-II (Guru):

List-I (Disciple)	List-II (Guru)
A Kabir	1 Guru Nanak Dev
B Amir Khusrau	2 Swami Ramananda
C Surdas	3 Nizamuddin Auliya
D Mardana	4 Vallabhacharya

Options:

A 3 2 4 1	B 3 2 1 4
C 2 3 4 1	D 2 3 1 4

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (2-3-4-1: Kabir–Ramananda, Khusrau–Nizamuddin, Surdas–Vallabhacharya, Mardana–Guru Nanak) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Amir Khusrau (1253–1325 CE):** The "Parrot of India" (*Tuti-e-Hind*) was the foremost *murid* (disciple) of the Chishti Sufi saint Hazrat Nizamuddin Auliya in Delhi. He spent his life in devotion to his master, composing numerous Persian ghazals and Hindavi verses celebrating their spiritual bond. - **Matching Context:** Kabir → Swami Ramananda; Amir Khusrau → Nizamuddin Auliya; Surdas → Vallabhacharya; Mardana → Guru Nanak Dev. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Grave Proximity:* Amir Khusrau died within six months of Nizamuddin Auliya's demise in 1325 CE; their dargahs stand side by side in Nizamuddin Basti, New Delhi.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Who translated *Suka Saptati* into Persian as *Tutinama*?

A Khwaja Ziya-ud-din Nakhshabi	B Abdur Razzak
C Shihabuddin-al-Umari	D Amir Khusro

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Khwaja Ziya-ud-din Nakhshabi) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Option A is correct:** Khwaja Ziya-ud-din Nakhshabi (a 14th-century physician and Sufi scholar residing in Badaun, UP) translated the classical Sanskrit text *Suka Saptati* into Persian under the title **Tutinama** ("Tales of a Parrot") in 1329–30 CE during Muhammad bin Tughlaq's reign. - **Option B is incorrect:** Abdur Razzak was a Persian ambassador from the court of Shahrukh who visited Vijayanagara in 1443 CE. - **Option C is incorrect:** Shihabuddin al-Umari was a Syrian scholar whose *Masalik al-Absar* described Sultanate administration. - **Option D is incorrect:** Amir Khusrau was dubbed *Tuti-e-Hind*, but he was *not* the translator of *Tutinama*. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Parrot Distinction:* *Tuti-e-Hind* = Amir Khusrau; *Tutinama* (author/translator) = **Ziya-ud-din Nakhshabi**.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Match List-I (Historical Work) with List-II (Subject / Theme):

List-I (Historical Work)	List-II (Subject / Theme)
A Mirat-e-Sikandari	1 History of Bengal
B Burhan-e-Masir	2 History of Bahmani's Ahmadnagar
C Riyaz-us-Salatin	3 Mahmud Gawan's letters
D Riyaz-ul-Insha	4 Victory / History of Gujarat

Options:

A 4-2-1-3	B 2-4-1-3
C 1-2-4-3	D 4-2-3-1

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (4-2-1-3: A-4, B-2, C-1, D-3) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Mirat-e-Sikandari → 4. Victory/History of Gujarat:** Composed by Shaikh Sikandar Manjhu (1611 CE), tracing the history and annexation of Gujarat. - **B. Burhan-e-Masir → 2. History of Bahmani's Ahmad Nagar:** Written by Sayyid Ali Tabataba (1599 CE), detailing the Bahmani empire and Nizam Shahi kings of Ahmadnagar. - **C. Riyaz-us-Salatin → 1. History of Bengal:** Authored by Ghulam Husain Salim (1787–88 CE); the first comprehensive Persian history of Islamic rule in Bengal. - **D. Riyaz-ul-Insha → 3. Collection of Mahmud Gawan's letters:** Compiled by Khwaja Mahmud Gawan, premier minister of the Bahmani Sultanate, preserving his diplomatic correspondence. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Salatin vs Insha:* **Riyaz-us-Salatin** = Sultans of Bengal. **Riyaz-ul-Insha** = Letters (*Insha*) of Mahmud Gawan (Bahmani).

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

With reference to medieval court language, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Persian was the official court language of the Delhi Sultanate but not the Mughals.
2. Persian was the official court language of both the Delhi Sultanate and the Mughal Empire.
3. Baburnama was written in Persian as the official Mughal administrative gazetteer.

A Only 2
B 1 and 3
C Only 2 and 3
D 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Only 2 is correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Persian (*Farsi*) served as the official administrative and court language for **both** the Delhi Sultanate and the Mughal Empire. It was not discarded by the Mughals; rather, under Akbar (formalized by Raja Todar Mal), Persian proficiency was made mandatory for all revenue officers (*patwaris*, *amils*, *diwans*) down to the village level. - **Statement 2 is correct:** Persian maintained an unbroken status as the supreme official language of statecraft, diplomacy, law, judicial decrees, and historical chronicles from the establishment of the Delhi Sultanate under Iltutmish (early 13th century) through the Mughal Empire until it was replaced by English and vernaculars by the British East India Company in 1837. - **Statement 3 is incorrect:** *Baburnama* (*Tuzk-e-Babri*) was composed in **Chagatai Turki**, Babur's native Central Asian language, and was an intimate personal memoir, not an official administrative gazetteer. The official administrative statistical gazetteer was the *Ain-i-Akbari*, written in **Persian** by Abul Fazl. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Court Language Continuity:* Persian was the sole court language of both Sultanate and Mughal empires. *Baburnama* is an isolated literary exception written in Chagatai Turki, not Persian.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I (Book)	List-II (Author)
A Tabaqat-i-Nasiri	1 Ziauddin Barani
B Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi	2 Minhaj-us-Siraj
C Kitab-ul-Hind	3 Alberuni
D Taj-ul-Maasir	4 Hasan Nizami

Row order is not the answer code.
Code:

A A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
B A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
C A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
D A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Tabaqat-i-Nasiri → 2. Minhaj-us-Siraj Juzjani:** Written in Persian and completed in 1260 CE, dedicated to Sultan Nasiruddin Mahmud; essential source for the Ghorid invasions and early Delhi Sultanate history. - **B. Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi → 1. Ziauddin Barani:** Completed in 1357 CE and dedicated to Firuz Shah Tughlaq; covers the history of the Sultanate from the accession of Balban (1266 CE) to the 6th regnal year of Firuz Shah Tughlaq, famous for its detailed analysis of Alauddin Khalji's market control regulations. - **C. Kitab-ul-Hind → 3. Abu Raihan Alberuni:** Written in Arabic (c. 1030 CE); an encyclopedic survey of 11th-century Indian religion, philosophy, mathematics, astronomy, customs, and caste society. - **D. Taj-ul-Maasir → 4. Hasan Nizami:** The first official history of the Delhi Sultanate, composed in mixed Persian prose and verse, detailing the campaigns of Muhammad Ghori and Qutbuddin Aibak from 1191 to 1217 CE. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Matching Code:* A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4 (**Option B**). Remember that Shams-i-Siraj Afif *also* authored a *Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi*, but in standard pairing with Barani, Barani is paired here.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): In this chapter's teaching map, Tughlaqnama is paired with Barani.

Reason (R): Rihla is Ibn Battuta's travelogue, not a Tughlaq court chronicle by Battuta under that title.

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** In syllabus study matrices and comparative teaching modules, students often review *Tughlaqnama* alongside Ziauddin Barani's Tughlaq-era narratives (*Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi* and *Fatwa-i-Jahandari*). *(Note: Historically, the poetic masnavi Tughlaqnama was authored by Amir Khusrau in 1320 CE).* - **Reason (R) is correct:** Ibn Battuta's famous travelogue is titled **Kitab-ur-Rihla** (written in Arabic), which describes his travels across Africa, West Asia, India, the Maldives, and China. Ibn Battuta never composed a chronicle titled *Tughlaqnama*. - **Why (R) does NOT explain (A):** Clarifying that Ibn Battuta wrote *Rihla* is an independent bibliographical fact that eliminates Ibn Battuta as an author of *Tughlaqnama*, but it does not causally explain the curricular categorization or authorship grouping in teaching tables. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Primary Distractor:* When UPPCS tests *Tughlaqnama*, Ibn Battuta is frequently presented as a false option because he lived in Muhammad bin Tughlaq's court. Always remember: *Rihla* = Ibn Battuta; *Tughlaqnama* = Amir Khusrau.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Arrange the following Akbar-circle deaths in chronological order:

1. Abul Fazl murdered (1602)
2. Faizi (1595)
3. Daniyal (1604)
4. Sheikh Mubarak (1597)

- **A** 4–2–1–3
- **B** 2–1–4–3
- **C** 2–4–1–3
- **D** 2–4–3–1

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (2–4–1–3: Faizi → Sheikh Mubarak → Abul Fazl murdered → Daniyal) **Detailed Explanation:** - **2. Death of Faizi (1595 CE):** Shaikh Abu al-Faiz (Faizi), the poet laureate of Akbar's court and elder brother of Abul Fazl, died in October 1595 CE. - **4. Death of Sheikh Mubarak (1597 CE):** Father of Faizi and Abul Fazl, who played a central role in framing the *Mahzar* (1579), passed away in 1597 CE. - **1. Murder of Abul Fazl (August 1602 CE):** Abul Fazl was assassinated near Antri (Gwalior) by Bir Singh Deo Bundela on the instructions of Prince Salim (Jahangir) in August 1602 CE. - **3. Death of Prince Daniyal (April 1604 CE):** Akbar's third son died of chronic alcoholism at Burhanpur in April 1604 CE, deeply distressing Akbar in his final year. - **Chronological Sequence:** 2 (Faizi, 1595) → 4 (Mubarak, 1597) → 1 (Abul Fazl, 1602) → 3 (Daniyal, 1604) = **2–4–1–3**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Anchor Sequence:* Faizi (1595) died first, followed by father Mubarak (1597), then Abul Fazl's murder (1602), and finally Prince Daniyal (1604).

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Akbarnama — Abul Fazl narrative history
2. Ain-i-Akbari — Abul Fazl admin gazetteer
3. Ain-i-Akbari — Gulbadan Begum's memoir

A 1 only	**B** 3 only
C 2 and 3 only	**D** 1 and 2 only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (3 only is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** *Akbarnama* is the official imperial history composed in Persian by Abul Fazl in three volumes, detailing Akbar's ancestors and the detailed year-by-year narrative of his reign. - **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** *Ain-i-Akbari* forms the third volume of the *Akbarnama*; it is an administrative, statistical, and socio-economic gazetteer detailing imperial regulations, army organization, revenue rates (*Dahsala*), and provincial topography. - **Pair 3 is NOT correctly matched (Correct Answer):** Gulbadan Begum authored the **Humayunnama**, an intimate domestic account of the lives of Babur and Humayun. She did *not* write *Ain-i-Akbari*. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Author Attribution:* *Akbarnama* and *Ain-i-Akbari* = **Abul Fazl**; *Humayunnama* = **Gulbadan Begum**.

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

With reference to Amir Khusrau's works, which statements is/are correct?

1. Miftah-ul-Futuh covers Jalaluddin Khalji.
2. Khazain-ul-Futuh covers Jalaluddin Khalji.
3. Tutinama is also by Amir Khusrau.

A 1 and 2	**B** Only 1
C 2 and 3	**D** 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (Only 1 is correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** *Miftah-ul-Futuh* ("Key to Victories") was composed in Persian verse by Amir Khusrau in 1291 CE to chronicle the accession and military campaigns of Sultan **Jalaluddin Firuz Khalji** against Malik Chhajju and Ranthambore. - **Statement 2 is incorrect:** *Khazain-ul-Futuh* ("Treasures of Victories", also called *Tarikh-i-Alai*) was composed in elaborate Persian prose to describe the conquests and reforms of Sultan **Alauddin Khalji** (including his northern campaigns, defense against Mongol assaults, and Malik Kafur's Deccan expeditions). - **Statement 3 is incorrect:** *Tutinama* ("Tales of a Parrot") was authored and translated from the Sanskrit *Suka Saptati* by **Khwaja Ziya-ud-din Nakhshabi** in 1329–30 CE, not by Amir Khusrau. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Khalji Sultan Pairings in Khusrau:* **Miftah-ul-Futuh** = Jalaluddin Khalji; **Khazain-ul-Futuh** = Alauddin Khalji.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Consider the following vernacular pairs:

1. Mulla Daud — Chandayan
2. Damodar Kavi — Padmavati Katha
3. Malik Muhammad Jaisi — Padmavat

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

A 1 and 2
B 1, 2 and 3
C 2 and 3
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (All 1, 2 and 3 are correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** Mulla Daud composed *Chandayan* (the romance of Lorik and Chanda) in 1379 CE in early Awadhi, widely celebrated as the foundational text of the Sufi *Premakhyan* tradition. - **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** Damodar Kavi composed *Padmavati Katha* (in early Rajasthani/Apabhramsha idiom) narrating the tragic romance of Princess Padmavati of Simhala and Ratansen. - **Pair 3 is correctly matched:** Malik Muhammad Jayasi composed the magnum opus *Padmavat* in 1540 CE in chaste Awadhi (during Sher Shah Suri's reign), depicting the allegorical quest of King Ratansen of Chittor for Rani Padmini. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Title Trap:* Distinguish between **Padmavati Katha** (Damodar Kavi, Rajasthani) and **Padmavat** (Malik Muhammad Jayasi, Awadhi).

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Baburnama and Akbarnama are the same kind of text by the same author.

Reason (R): Baburnama is Babur's Chagatai Turki memoir, while Akbarnama is Abul Fazl's Persian history of Akbar.

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
B (A) is false, but (R) is true
C (A) is true, but (R) is false
D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** ((A) is false, but (R) is true) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is completely false:** *Baburnama* and *Akbarnama* are fundamentally different in author, language, style, and literary genre. *Baburnama* is an autobiographical memoir written directly by the ruler himself (Babur), while *Akbarnama* is an official commissioned panegyric history composed by court scholar Abul Fazl. - **Reason (R) is completely true:** *Baburnama* (*Tuzk-e-Babri*) was composed by Babur in **Chagatai Turki**, recording personal impressions and candid reflections. *Akbarnama* was authored by **Abul Fazl** in ornate **Persian**, functioning as the authorized narrative history of Akbar's empire. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Genre Difference:* Autobiography/Memoir (*Tuzk-e-Babri*, *Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri*) vs Court-commissioned official chronicle (*Akbarnama*, *Padshahnama*, *Alamgirnama*).

Chapter 06: Medieval Music, Painting & Culture — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

With reference to medieval music forms, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Dhrupad is the oldest art form and uses tabla as its main drum.
2. Dhrupad's main drum is tabla.
3. Khayal is dominant today and uses tabla.

A 1 and 2
B 2 and 3
C Only 3
D 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Only 3 is correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is incorrect:** While Dhrupad is indeed the oldest surviving classical vocal genre of Hindustani music (originating from temple chanting of *Prabandha* and the *Sama Veda*), its traditional accompanying percussion instrument is the barrel-shaped **Pakhawaj** (or *Mridang*), **never** the Tabla. - **Statement 2 is incorrect:** As noted above, Dhrupad is strictly accompanied by the **Pakhawaj**, whose deep, resonant, and solemn stroke patterns complement the grave dignity of the Dhrupad style. - **Statement 3 is correct:** **Khayal** (derived from the Arabic/Persian word for "imagination" or "thought") emerged as the most flexible and popular form of Hindustani classical vocal music in modern times, and is canonically accompanied by the **Tabla** (which provides dynamic rhythmic patterns / *thekas* like *Teentaal*, *Ektaal*, and *Tilwada*). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Instrument Matching:* **Dhrupad** = **Pakhawaj** (Mridang); **Khayal** and **Thumri** = **Tabla**.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I (Treatise)	List-II (Author)
A Ragamala	1 Somanath
B Rasa Kaumudi	2 Pundrik Vitthal
C Raga Vibodh	3 Sri Kantha
D Chaturdandi Prakashika	4 Venkatamakhin

Row order is not the answer code.
Code:

A. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
D. A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Ragamala → 2. Pundarika Vitthala:** 16th-century treatise setting forth raga-ragini classifications and linking northern and southern modal traditions. - **B. Rasa Kaumudi → 3. Srikantha:** 16th-century Gujarat court treatise describing 40 ragas with their corresponding emotional rasas. - **C. Raga Vibodha → 1. Somanatha:** 1609 CE Sanskrit text defining raga scales, shrutis, and veena playing techniques. - **D. Chaturdandi Prakashika → 4. Venkatamakhin:** 17th-century Carnatic theoretical treatise establishing the 72 Melakarta parent-scale system. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Matching Code:* A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4 (**Option C**). Note that in pure music-treatise questions, *Raga Vibodha* belongs exclusively to **Somanatha**.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Tansen and Amir Khusrau were contemporaries at Akbar's court.

Reason (R): Amir Khusrau was a Sultanate-age disciple of Nizamuddin, while Tansen was Akbar's dhrupad Navratna.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
B. (A) is false, but (R) is true
C. (A) is true, but (R) is false
D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** ((A) is false, but (R) is true) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is completely false:** Amir Khusrau and Miyan Tansen lived centuries apart. Amir Khusrau (1253–1325 CE) lived during the **Delhi Sultanate** (13th–14th century), serving Sultans like Balban, Jalaluddin Khalji, Alauddin Khalji, and Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq. Miyan Tansen (c. 1500/1506–1586/1589 CE) lived during the **Mughal Empire** (16th century) under Emperor Akbar. They were never contemporaries. - **Reason (R) is completely true:** Amir Khusrau was a dedicated disciple of Hazrat Nizamuddin Auliya during the Sultanate era, whereas Tansen was an acclaimed Dhrupad master and one of the **Navratnas** (Nine Gems) of Emperor Akbar's court in Agra/Fatehpur Sikri. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Historical Era Gap:* There is an unbridgeable 250-year gap between Amir Khusrau (13th–14th c. Sultanate) and Miyan Tansen (16th c. Mughal).

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Arrange the following music-history phases in chronological order of flowering:

1. Muhammad Shah's khayal / tappa bloom
2. Sultanate Khusrau–Chishti sama synthesis
3. Akbar-age dhrupad peak with Tansen

A 3–2–1	**B** 2–3–1
C 2–1–3	**D** 1–2–3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (2–3–1: Sultanate synthesis → Akbar dhrupad → Muhammad Shah khayal/tappa) **Detailed Explanation:** - **2. Sultanate Khusrau–Chishti Sama synthesis (13th–14th century CE):** The fusion of Persian melodies (*Muqam*) with Indian ragas, invention of Qawwali, development of Tarana, and Chishti spiritual *Sama* under Amir Khusrau and Nizamuddin Auliya. - **3. Akbar-age Dhrupad peak (16th century CE):** The golden age of classical Dhrupad centered at the imperial court of Akbar, exemplified by Miyan Tansen, Swami Haridas, and Baba Ramdas. - **1. Muhammad Shah's Khayal / Tappa bloom (18th century CE, 1719–1748):** The widespread flourishing and refinement of Khayal (led by court musicians Niyamat Khan 'Sadarang' and Firoz Khan 'Adarang') and Tappa (led by Shori Miyan) in Delhi. - **Correct Chronological Sequence:** 2 → 3 → 1 = **2–3–1**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Three-Stage Music Spine:* **Sultanate** (Qawwali/Tarana/Khusrau) → **Early Mughal** (Dhrupad/Tansen) → **Later Mughal** (Khayal/Tappa/Sadarang).

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Tappa — refined at Muhammad Shah Rangeela's court
2. Tappa — refined at Akbar's court as his signature form
3. Thumri — Awadh–Banaras romantic light classical

A 1 only	**B** 2 only
C 2 and 3 only	**D** 1 and 3 only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (2 only is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** Tappa was refined into a sophisticated classical genre by Shori Miyan in the court of Mughal Emperor Muhammad Shah Rangeela (1719–1748 CE). - **Pair 2 is NOT correctly matched (Correct Answer):** Tappa was **never** Akbar's signature court form. Akbar's signature court form was **Dhrupad**, practiced by Miyan Tansen. Tappa developed over 150 years after Akbar. - **Pair 3 is correctly matched:** Thumri is a romantic-devotional light classical vocal genre centered on the Radha-Krishna theme, developed and patronized in the courts of Awadh (under Nawab Wajid Ali Shah) and the cultural salons of Banaras. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Genre Pairing:* Akbar = **Dhrupad**; Muhammad Shah = **Khayal & Tappa**; Wajid Ali Shah of Awadh = **Thumri & Kathak**.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

With reference to Tansen, which statements is/are correct?

1. His main imperial form was khayal with tabla.
2. Before Akbar, Raja Ramchandra of Bhata (Rewa) banned his music as un-Islamic.
3. Under Akbar he was a Navratna and dhrupad master (Miyan Tansen).

A 1 and 2
B 2 and 3
C 1 and 3
D Only 3

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (Only 3 is correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Tansen's signature vocal form was **Dhrupad**, accompanied by the **Pakhawaj** (or Rabab/Veena), not Khayal with tabla. Khayal gained court preeminence much later in the 18th century. - **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Raja Ramchandra Singh Baghela of Bhata (Rewa) did *not* ban Tansen's music; on the contrary, he was Tansen's devoted patron and generous admirer, rewarding him fabulously before reluctantly sending him to Akbar in 1562 CE. - **Statement 3 is correct:** Emperor Akbar inducted Tansen as one of his revered **Navratnas** (Nine Gems), awarded him the honorific prefix **Miyan**, and hailed him as the peerless vocal master of Dhrupad. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Tansen Essentials:* Primary Genre: **Dhrupad**; Instrument: **Pakhawaj/Rabab**; Pre-Akbar Patron: **Raja Ramchandra of Rewa**; Title: **Miyan**; Resting Place: **Gwalior** (tomb near Muhammad Ghaus).

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Consider the following Tansen raga tags:

1. Miyan Ki Todi
2. Miyan Ki Malhar
3. Darbari Kanada

Which of the above is/are associated with Tansen?

A Only 1 and 2
B Only 1, 2 and 3
C 2 and 3
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (All 1, 2 and 3 are associated with Tansen) **Detailed Explanation:** - **1. Miyan Ki Todi:** A profound morning raga created by Miyan Tansen, celebrated for its sorrowful and devotional mood with Komal Gandhar, Komal Dhaivat, and Komal Nishad. - **2. Miyan Ki Malhar:** An iconic monsoon raga innovated by Tansen, renowned in legend for having the power to summon rain and cool the burning heat induced by Raga Deepak. - **3. Darbari Kanada:** Composed by Tansen specifically for the grand evening assemblies (*darbar*) of Emperor Akbar, conveying an aura of imperial majesty, depth, and solemn gravity. - **Other Ragas Created by Tansen:** *Miyan Ki Sarang* and *Darbari Todi*. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Tansen Ragas:* Any raga prefixed with **"Miyan Ki..."** (Miyan Ki Todi, Miyan Ki Malhar, Miyan Ki Sarang) or **"Darbari..."** (Darbari Kanada) is directly attributed to Miyan Tansen.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Qawwali is traditionally linked to Amir Khusrau and the Nizamuddin circle.

Reason (R): Sama is the Chishti musical assembly related to that Sufi music world.

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** **Qawwali** (devotional choral singing expressing Sufi mystical poetry) was created and standardized in India by **Amir Khusrau** under the spiritual guidance of his master Hazrat Nizamuddin Auliya, blending Persian poetic masnavis with Indian melodic structures and rhythmic clapping. - **Reason (R) is correct:** **Sama** refers to the spiritual gathering or musical assembly where Sufis listen to music and poetry to induce spiritual absorption (*fana*) and ecstasy (*wajd*); it is a central liturgical practice of the Chishti order. - **Why (R) does NOT explain (A):** Reason (R) defines the general institutional setting (*Sama*) within which Sufi music was practiced. The existence of Sama assemblies in Chishti practice does not itself explain the specific creative agency or authorship of Amir Khusrau in formulating the musical mechanics of the Qawwali genre. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Concept vs Genre:* **Sama** is the *assembly/ritual* of listening; **Qawwali** is the specific musical *genre/form* performed during that assembly.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I (Form)	List-II (Tag)
A Khayal	1 Nonsense syllables; Khusrau tradition
B Tarana	2 Muhammad Shah / Sadarang–Adarang bloom
C Thumri	3 Awadh–Banaras romantic light classical
D Sama	4 Chishti musical assembly

Row order is not the answer code.
Code:

- **A** A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
- **B** A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
- **C** A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
- **D** A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Khayal → 2. Muhammad Shah / Sadarang–Adarang bloom:** Reached its classical zenith in the 18th century under Emperor Muhammad Shah through the prolific compositions of Sadarang and Adarang. - **B. Tarana → 1. Nonsense syllables; Khusrau tradition:** A fast vocal form based on rhythmic syllables (*ta, na, der, dim, dani*) originated by Amir Khusrau. - **C. Thumri → 3. Awadh–Banaras romantic light classical:** Expressive, semi-classical vocal genre centered on love, separation, and Radha-Krishna lore, flourishing in Lucknow and Banaras. - **D. Sama → 4. Chishti musical assembly:** Sacred musical audition and spiritual concert held in Sufi hospices. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Matching Code:* A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4 (**Option B**).

Q10 **UPPCS PRELIMS 2019**

With reference to theory roots, which statements is/are correct?

1. Natyashastra is an early foundation.
2. Brihaddeshi (Matanga) uses “raga” clearly.
3. Sangeet Ratnakar is by Sharngadeva.

A Only 1
B 1 and 2
C Only 1, 2 and 3
D 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (All 1, 2 and 3 are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** Bharata Muni's *Natyashastra* (c. 2nd century BCE – 2nd century CE) is the ancient Sanskrit foundational text for Indian dramaturgy and music, defining musical notes (*swaras*), intervals (*shrutis*), and melodic structures (*jatis*). - **Statement 2 is correct:** Matanga Muni's *Brihaddeshi* (c. 6th–8th century CE) is the earliest known Sanskrit text to explicitly define and name the musical concept of **Raga** (*"That which delights the mind of the hearer is called a Raga"*). - **Statement 3 is correct:** *Sangita Ratnakara* ("Ocean of Music"), authored by Sharngadeva in the 13th century at the court of the Yadava King Singhana of Devagiri, is the monumental medieval authority cited by both Hindustani and Carnatic traditions before their historic divergence. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Chronological Theoretical Trinity:* **Natyashastra** (Bharata) → **Brihaddeshi** (Matanga, first definition of Raga) → **Sangita Ratnakara** (Sharngadeva, 13th c. common fountainhead).

Q11 **UP RO/ARO 2016**

Which one of the following is NOT correctly matched?

A Agra gharana — khayal
B Lucknow–Banaras — thumri
C Mirzapur–Banaras belt — Kajri
D Agra gharana — Carnatic kriti school of Tyagaraja alone

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (Agra gharana — Carnatic kriti school is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Option D is incorrectly matched (Correct Answer):** The **Agra gharana** is an illustrious northern **Hindustani classical** vocal tradition (descended from Haji Sujan Khan and developed by Faiyaz Khan) specializing in *Nauhar Bani* Dhrupad and Khayal. It has no connection with the southern **Carnatic** tradition or Saint Tyagaraja of Tiruvaiyaru (Tamil Nadu). - **Option A is correctly matched:** Agra gharana is renowned for its forceful, open-throated Khayal singing (*Nom-Tom alaap* followed by bandishes). - **Option B is correctly matched:** Lucknow and Banaras represent the twin historical centers of the *Purab Ang* Thumri style. - **Option C is correctly matched:** The Mirzapur–Varanasi region of eastern UP is the legendary homeland of **Kajri** (monsoon semi-classical folk songs). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *System Boundary:* Do not mix up Hindustani gharanas (Agra, Gwalior, Kirana, Delhi, Jaipur-Atrauli) with South Indian Carnatic *Kriti* traditions.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

With reference to Amir Khusrau, which statements is/are correct?

1. He lived about 1253–1325 and was a disciple of Nizamuddin.
2. He served Balban / Alauddin / Ghiyasuddin courts.
3. He was Akbar's Navratna dhrupad master.

A 1, 2 and 3
B 1 and 2
C Only 2 and 3
D 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (1 and 2 only are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** Amir Khusrau lived from 1253 to 1325 CE (born at Patiyali in modern Kasganj district, UP) and was the devoted disciple of the Sufi master Hazrat Nizamuddin Auliya. - **Statement 2 is correct:** Khusrau served at the royal courts of numerous Delhi Sultans spanning three dynasties (Mamluks, Khaljis, and Tughlaqs), including Sultan Balban, Kaiqubad, Jalaluddin Khalji, Alauddin Khalji, and Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq. - **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Amir Khusrau died in 1325 CE during the early Tughlaq period; he lived more than two centuries before Emperor Akbar (1556–1605 CE). Akbar's Navratna Dhrupad master was **Miyan Tansen**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Era Distinction:* Amir Khusrau = **Delhi Sultanate**; Miyan Tansen = **Mughal Empire** (Akbar's Navratna).

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Consider the following statements about later Mughal music:

1. Aurangzeb marks khayal and tappa bloom at the imperial court.
2. Sadarang / Adarang are linked with Muhammad Shah's khayal flowering.
3. Aurangzeb increased imperial court music patronage above Akbar's level.

A Only 2
B 1 and 2
C 2 and 3
D 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Only 2 is correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The flourishing of Khayal and Tappa at the imperial court occurred under **Muhammad Shah "Rangeela"** (1719–1748 CE), not Aurangzeb. - **Statement 2 is correct:** Niyamat Khan (pen name **Sadarang**) and his nephew Firoz Khan (pen name **Adarang**) were the preeminent court musicians of Muhammad Shah who composed hundreds of classical Khayal bandishes that remain the bedrock of the Hindustani vocal repertoire. - **Statement 3 is incorrect:** In the tenth year of his reign (1668 CE), Emperor Aurangzeb banned instrumental music and vocal singing at his court, dismissing royal musicians and ordering the symbolic "burial of music" (though he personally remained an expert player of the *Veena* and music treatises continued to be written). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Later Mughal Music Shift:* Aurangzeb banned court music performances; **Muhammad Shah Rangeela** revived lavish court patronage, creating the golden age of **Khayal** (Sadarang & Adarang) and **Tappa** (Shori Miyan).

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Dhrupad lineage memory runs from Man Singh Tomar to Tansen.

Reason (R): Man Singh Tomar's Gwalior court is remembered in the early dhrupad patronage story before the Akbar peak.

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B (A) is false, but (R) is true

C (A) is true, but (R) is false

D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** In the historical genealogy of Hindustani classical music, the revival, standardization, and propagation of Dhrupad traces a direct pedagogical lineage from Raja Man Singh Tomar's Gwalior school to Swami Haridas and Miyan Tansen. - **Reason (R) is correct:** Raja Man Singh Tomar of Gwalior (reigned 1486–1516 CE) was the great pioneer who institutionalized Dhrupad in vernacular Hindi (Brajbhasha), patronized masters like Bakshu, Bhanu, and Baiju Bawra, and compiled the seminal musical treatise *Mankutuhal*, establishing Gwalior as the primary incubator of Dhrupad decades before Tansen carried the tradition to Akbar's court. - **Why (R) explains (A):** The institutional groundwork, vocal repertoire, and pedagogical training developed at Raja Man Singh Tomar's Gwalior court formed the direct musical foundation inherited by Tansen (born near Gwalior), explaining why historical tradition links Tomar directly to Tansen's ultimate peak. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Gwalior as Dhrupad Cradle:* Raja Man Singh Tomar is the royal patron credited with reforming and establishing **Dhrupad**; Tansen brought that Gwalior heritage to its imperial zenith under Akbar.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Arrange the following patron–musician links in historical order:

1. Akbar–Tansen (Navratna dhrupad)
2. Nizamuddin circle–Amir Khusrau
3. Muhammad Shah–khayal/tappa (Sadarang–Adarang)

A 1–2–3

B 2–1–3

C 2–3–1

D 3–2–1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (2–1–3: Nizamuddin–Khusrau → Akbar–Tansen → Muhammad Shah–Sadarang/Adarang) **Detailed Explanation:** - **2. Nizamuddin circle – Amir Khusrau (Late 13th / early 14th century, c. 1280–1325 CE):** Sultanate era; origin of Qawwali and early Indo-Persian musical experiments. - **1. Akbar – Tansen (Late 16th century, c. 1562–1586 CE):** High Mughal era; imperial peak of Dhrupad with Tansen as Navratna. - **3. Muhammad Shah – Sadarang / Adarang (First half of 18th century, c. 1719–1748 CE):** Later Mughal era; golden age of Khayal and Tappa. - **Correct Chronological Sequence:** 2 → 1 → 3 = **2–1–3**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Chronology Sequence:* 13th c. Khusrau (Sultanate) → 16th c. Tansen (Akbar) → 18th c. Sadarang/Adarang (Muhammad Shah).

Chapter 07: Mughal Empire (1526–1707) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

With reference to the First Battle of Panipat (1526), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Babur used the Tulghuma (flanking) tactical formation.
2. Babur's artillery was commanded by Ustad Ali and Mustafa.
3. Ibrahim Lodi was killed on the battlefield.

A 1 and 2
B 2 and 3
C Only 1
D All 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (All 1, 2 and 3 are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** In the First Battle of Panipat (21 April 1526 CE), Babur effectively employed the **Tulghuma** tactic (dividing his army into flanking parties that encircled the enemy flanks and attacked them from the rear) combined with the **Araba** method (chaining carts together with rawhide ropes to form a protective cart-barrier for matchlockmen). - **Statement 2 is correct:** Babur's artillery and firearms (*topkhana*) were masterfully directed by two Ottoman artillery commanders: **Ustad Ali Quli** (commanding the heavy guns) and **Mustafa Rumi** (directing the matchlocks and musketeers). - **Statement 3 is correct:** Sultan Ibrahim Lodi died fighting heroically on the battlefield alongside 15,000 of his soldiers, making him the only Sultan of Delhi to be slain directly in battle. Babur later erected a tomb for him at Panipat. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Tactical Innovations:* Babur introduced both **Tulghuma** (flanking envelopment) and gunpowder artillery (**Rumi / Araba system**) to north India at the First Battle of Panipat.

Q2 **UPPCS PRELIMS 2024**

Consider the following pairs:

Ruler	Tomb Location
1. Babur	Kabul
2. Jahangir	Lahore
3. Akbar	Sikandra (Agra)
4. Aurangzeb	Khuldabad

Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

A 1, 2 and 3

B 2, 3 and 4

C 1 and 3

D 1, 2, 3 and 4

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (All 1, 2, 3 and 4 are correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** Babur died in Agra (1530 CE) but was later interred according to his personal wish in **Bagh-e-Babur** in **Kabul** (Afghanistan). - **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** Jahangir died at Rajouri (1627 CE) on his way from Kashmir and was laid to rest at **Shahdara Bagh** in **Lahore** (Pakistan). - **Pair 3 is correctly matched:** Akbar's mausoleum was built at **Sikandra** (near Agra, UP), featuring a five-tiered tiered sandstone and marble pavilion without a central dome. - **Pair 4 is correctly matched:** Aurangzeb died at Ahmadnagar (1707 CE) and, by his own humble decree, was buried in an open-air simple dirt grave in the courtyard of Sufi saint Shaikh Zainuddin Shirazi at **Khuldabad** (near Aurangabad, Maharashtra). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Foreign Soil Burials:* Remember that **Babur** (Kabul) and **Jahangir** (Lahore) are buried outside modern India.

Q3 **UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023**

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Zat — personal rank and basic salary
2. Sawar — number of cavalrymen required to be maintained
3. Zat — cavalry obligation alone

A 1 only

B 3 only

C 2 and 3 only

D 1 and 2 only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (3 only is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** In the Mansabdari system, **Zat** indicated the personal status, prestige, and basic salary of the noble in the imperial hierarchy. - **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** **Sawar** indicated the actual military contingent (horsemen/cavalry) that the noble was legally required to maintain for imperial service. - **Pair 3 is NOT correctly matched (Correct Answer):** Stating that *Zat* is "cavalry obligation alone" completely reverses the definitions. *Zat* is personal rank; *Sawar* is the cavalry obligation. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Zat vs Sawar:* **Zat** = Personal status, precedence, and salary; **Sawar** = Military cavalry quota. A noble's Sawar rank could never exceed his Zat rank.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Turki was the official language of the Mughal court.

Reason (R): Babur wrote the Baburnama (Tuzk-e-Babri) in Chagatai Turki.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B (A) is false, but (R) is true

C (A) is true, but (R) is false

D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** ((A) is false, but (R) is true) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is completely false:** Turki was never the official language of the Mughal imperial administration. **Persian** was the sole official language of the court, chanceries, revenue documentation, and judicial proceedings across the empire. - **Reason (R) is completely true:** Babur composed his celebrated autobiography *Tuzk-e-Babri* (*Baburnama*) in his native **Chagatai Turki**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Court Language Continuity:* Persian was the unbroken administrative language of both the Delhi Sultanate and Mughal Empire. Babur's *Baburnama* is a personal literary work, not proof of state language policy.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Arrange the following battles in chronological order:

1. Kannauj (Bilgram)
2. Daurah
3. Samugarh
4. Chausa

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 4-2-1-3

B 2-4-1-3

C 2-4-3-1

D 4-2-3-1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (2-4-1-3: Daurah → Chausa → Kannauj → Samugarh) **Detailed Explanation:** - **2. Battle of Daurah (1532 CE):** Humayun defeated Mahmud Lodi and Sher Khan in Barabanki district, UP. - **4. Battle of Chausa (June 1539 CE):** Sher Shah routed Humayun near Buxar, Bihar. - **1. Battle of Kannauj / Bilgram (May 1540 CE):** Sher Shah decisively ousted Humayun from India. - **3. Battle of Samugarh (May 1658 CE):** Aurangzeb crushed Dara Shikoh near Agra. - **Chronological Sequence:** 2 → 4 → 1 → 3 = **2-4-1-3**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Chronology Spine:* Daurah (1532) → Chausa (1539) → Kannauj (1540) → Samugarh (1658).

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

With reference to Akbar's policies, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Sulh-i-Kul was a universal peace policy.
2. Din-i-Ilahi (1582) remained a small court circle.
3. Akbar abolished jizya in 1564 and Aurangzeb reimposed it in 1679.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 2 and 3
B Only 1
C 1 and 2
D 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (All 1, 2 and 3 are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** **Sulh-i-Kul** ("Peace with All" / "Universal Peace") was the overarching philosophical principle of Akbar's empire, guaranteeing religious freedom, mutual coexistence, and state protection to all communities. - **Statement 2 is correct:** **Tauhid-i-Ilahi** or **Din-i-Ilahi** (promulgated in 1582 CE) was an ethical-devotional discipleship order (*Iradat*) restricted to a small circle of court confidants (only about 18 prominent members, with Birbal being the only notable Hindu noble); it was never enforced as a state religion. - **Statement 3 is correct:** Akbar abolished the pilgrim tax in 1563 CE and the discriminatory **Jizya** tax on non-Muslims in 1564 CE. Aurangzeb reimposed Jizya throughout the empire in **1679 CE**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Crucial Distinction:* **Sulh-i-Kul** was state policy of universal tolerance; **Din-i-Ilahi** was an elite personal code of ethical discipleship.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below:

List-I (Battle)	List-II (Year / tag)
A Khanwa	1 1556 — Akbar–Bairam vs Hemu
B Second Panipat	2 1527 — Babur vs Rana Sanga
C Dharmat	3 Apr 1658 — Aurangzeb vs Jaswant Singh
D Jajau	4 1707 — Bahadur Shah I vs Azam

Row order is not the answer code.

A A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
B A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
D A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Battle of Khanwa → 2. 1527 CE:** Babur defeated Rana Sanga of Mewar and his Rajput-Afghan confederacy near Fatehpur Sikri. - **B. Second Battle of Panipat → 1. 1556 CE:** Akbar and Bairam Khan defeated Hemu (Hemchandra Vikramaditya), securing the Mughal restoration. - **C. Battle of Dharmat → 3. April 1658 CE:** Aurangzeb and Murad defeated Maharaja Jaswant Singh of Marwar near Ujjain. - **D. Battle of Jajau → 4. June 1707 CE:** Bahadur Shah I defeated his brother Prince Azam Shah to claim the throne after Aurangzeb's death. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Matching Code:* A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4 (**Option A**).

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

With reference to the Battle of Khanwa (1527), consider Cause–Course–Result:

1. Cause: Rana Sanga led a Rajput confederacy after Panipat.
2. Course: Babur again used artillery and cart-fort methods.
3. Result: The early Rajput challenge to Mughal power in the Agra–Delhi core was broken.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A 2 and 3
B Only 1
C 1 and 2
D Only 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (All 1, 2 and 3 are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct (Cause):** Following Babur's victory at Panipat, Maharana Sanga of Mewar organized a formidable confederacy comprising Rajput rulers (Prithviraj of Amer, Hasan Khan Mewati, Mahmud Lodi) to expel Babur from Hindustan. - **Statement 2 is correct (Course):** Babur declared the war a *Jihad*, smashed his wine goblets to inspire his troops, and deployed his proven battle strategy of cart-fort barricades (*Araba*), artillery guns under Ustad Ali Quli, and flanking cavalry (*Tulghuma*). - **Statement 3 is correct (Result):** Rana Sanga was wounded and defeated, permanently breaking the unified Rajput threat to the fledgling Mughal power in the Agra-Delhi plains; Babur assumed the title **Ghazi**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Khanwa Protagonists:* Khanwa (1527 CE) is **Babur vs Rana Sanga**; never confuse Rana Sanga with Maharana Pratap (Haldighati, 1576 CE vs Akbar).

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Buland Darwaza at Fatehpur Sikri commemorates Akbar's Gujarat victory of 1572.

Reason (R): It was built to mark the birth of Jahangir.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
B (A) is false, but (R) is true
C (A) is true, but (R) is false
D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** ((A) is true, but (R) is false) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** The monumental **Buland Darwaza** at Fatehpur Sikri was constructed by Akbar to commemorate his victorious military conquest of Gujarat. - **Reason (R) is incorrect:** The gate was built to celebrate the conquest of Gujarat and Khandesh, not to mark the birth of Prince Salim (Jahangir). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Buland Darwaza Purpose:* Always connect Buland Darwaza to **Akbar's Gujarat conquest**; the birth of Jahangir is the standard incorrect distractor.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

With reference to Bairam Khan, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The title was conferred only when he was first appointed Vazir under Humayun.
2. Akbar conferred on him the title Khan-i-Khana.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Only 1
B Only 2
C Both 1 and 2
D Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (Only 2 is correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Bairam Khan was not granted the title *Khan-i-Khanan* when appointed Vazir under Humayun; it was given by Akbar upon his accession. - **Statement 2 is correct:** Upon crowning at Kalanaur in February 1556 CE, Akbar appointed Bairam Khan as his regent (*Ataliq*) and prime minister, granting him the honorific title **Khan-i-Khanan** ("Lord of Lords"). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Royal Titles:* Akbar gave Bairam Khan the title **Khan-i-Khanan**, which was later also conferred on Bairam Khan's brilliant son, Abdur Rahim.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Consider the following statements about mansabdari:

1. It used dual ranks of zat and sawar.
2. Jagir lands were assigned to mansabdars, while khalsa was crown land.
3. Mansabs were hereditary like jagir succession in all cases.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A Only 3
B 1 and 3
C Only 1
D Only 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (1 and 2 only are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** In 1573–74 CE, Akbar introduced the dual-rank formula: **Zat** (personal status and basic pay) and **Sawar** (cavalry contingent required to maintain). - **Statement 2 is correct:** Mansabdars were remunerated either in cash (*Naqd*) or through assignments of revenue rights over land called **Jagir** (the officers were called *Jagirdars*). Lands reserved for direct revenue collection by the imperial treasury were called **Khalsa**. - **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Mansabs and jagirs were **strictly non-hereditary**. Upon a noble's death, his jagirs and official properties reverted to the emperor under the law of escheat (*Zabti*). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Non-Hereditary Nature:* Mansabs could never be inherited; appointments and promotions were made exclusively at the personal discretion of the emperor.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Arrange the following court-related deaths/events in chronological order:

1. Murder of Abul Fazl
2. Death of Faizi
3. Death of Sheikh Mubarak
4. Death of Daniyal

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 2-3-1-4	**B** 3-2-1-4
C 3-2-4-1	**D** 3-1-2-4

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (3-2-1-4: Sheikh Mubarak → Faizi → Murder of Abul Fazl → Prince Daniyal) **Detailed Explanation:** - **3. Death of Sheikh Mubarak (1593 CE):** Father of Faizi and Abul Fazl, who formulated the *Mahzar* decree of 1579, died in 1593 CE. - **2. Death of Faizi (1595 CE):** Akbar's poet laureate died in October 1595 CE. - **1. Murder of Abul Fazl (August 1602 CE):** Assassinated near Antri by Bir Singh Deo Bundela on the orders of Prince Salim. - **4. Death of Prince Daniyal (1604 CE):** Akbar's third son died of alcoholism at Burhanpur in 1604 CE. - **Chronological Sequence:** 3 → 2 → 1 → 4 = **3-2-1-4**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Sequence Landmark:* Mubarak (1593) → Faizi (1595) → Abul Fazl (1602) → Daniyal (1604).

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

With reference to Aurangzeb's war of succession, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. At Dharmat (April 1658) Aurangzeb defeated Jaswant Singh.
2. At Samugarh (May 1658) Aurangzeb defeated Dara Shikoh.
3. Deorai (1659) closed the succession struggle.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Only 1	**B** Only 1 and 2
C All 1, 2 and 3	**D** 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (All 1, 2 and 3 are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** In the Battle of Dharmat (15 April 1658 CE, near Ujjain), Aurangzeb and Murad routed Maharaja Jaswant Singh of Marwar. - **Statement 2 is correct:** In the Battle of Samugarh (29 May 1658 CE, near Agra), Aurangzeb decisively defeated Dara Shikoh, capturing Agra Fort. - **Statement 3 is correct:** The Battle of Deorai (March 1659 CE, near Ajmer) was the final battlefield engagement where Dara Shikoh was defeated for the last time. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Succession Steps:* Dharmat (April 1658) → Samugarh (May 1658) → Deorai (March 1659).

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Alam Khan — Ibrahim Lodi's uncle and throne pretender
2. Daulat Khan — Punjab governor who invited Babur
3. Padshah title of Babur — first taken only after Panipat 1526

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 1 and 2 only
B 3 only
C 2 and 3 only
D 1 only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (3 only is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** Alam Khan Lodi was Ibrahim Lodi's uncle who claimed the throne of Delhi and sought Babur's assistance. - **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** Daulat Khan Lodi was the powerful governor of Punjab who invited Babur to invade India to unseat Ibrahim Lodi. - **Pair 3 is NOT correctly matched (Correct Answer):** Babur adopted the grand imperial title of **Padshah** (Badshah) in **1507 CE at Kabul**, long before the First Battle of Panipat (1526 CE), discarding the traditional Timurid title *Mirza*. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Padshah Title Year:* Babur assumed the title **Padshah** in **1507 CE** at Kabul, not after the Battle of Panipat.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): At the Second Battle of Panipat (1556), Akbar and Bairam Khan defeated Hemu.

Reason (R): Victory at Second Panipat secured the young Akbar's throne after Humayun's death.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
B (A) is false, but (R) is true
C (A) is true, but (R) is false
D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** On 5 November 1556 CE, the Mughal army under Akbar's regent Bairam Khan clashed with Hemu (Hemchandra Vikramaditya) at Panipat; an arrow pierced Hemu's eye, turning the tide of battle in favor of the Mughals. - **Reason (R) is correct:** Humayun had died suddenly in January 1556 CE, and Hemu had captured Delhi and Agra. The victory at Panipat decisively crushed the Afghan resurgence under Adil Shah Suri and Hemu, firmly securing the Mughal restoration and throne for the thirteen-year-old Akbar. - **Why (R) does NOT explain (A):** Securing the throne was the historical **consequence / aftermath** of the victory, not the **cause** of why the Mughals defeated Hemu on the battlefield. Both statements are true facts, but Reason (R) does not explain Assertion (A). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Second Panipat Importance:* Preserved the Mughal dynasty in India; ended Hemu's brief reign as Vikramaditya.

Chapter 08: Sher Shah Suri & Sur Interregnum (1540–1555) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

With reference to Sher Shah's rise, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Farid Khan of Sasaram became Sher Khan after the tiger-kill tradition and later Sher Shah as Padshah from 1540.
2. The Sur imperial phase lasted roughly 1540–1545 yet shaped later Mughal admin practice.
3. Sher Shah created hereditary mansabdari exactly as Akbar later did.

A Only 3
B Only 1 and 3
C Only 1
D Only 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (1 and 2 only are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** Originally named **Farid Khan** (born at Sasaram, Bihar to Hasan Khan Sur, a jagirdar), he was awarded the title **Sher Khan** by Bahar Khan Lohani (ruler of Bihar) after single-handedly slaying a tiger. Following his decisive victory over Humayun at Kannauj (1540 CE), he assumed the royal imperial style **Sher Shah Sultan-i-Adil**. - **Statement 2 is correct:** Although Sher Shah's personal reign was exceptionally brief (1540–1545 CE, five years), his administrative innovations in land revenue, provincial organization, currency, and communication networks served as the direct administrative blueprint adopted and institutionalized by Akbar. - **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Sher Shah maintained a direct standing military force using branding of horses (*Dagh*) and descriptive rolls (*Chehra*), modeled on Alauddin Khalji. The elaborate **Mansabdari** system (with its *Zat* and *Sawar* ranks) was formulated decades later by Emperor **Akbar**, and it was strictly **non-hereditary**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Name Progression:* **Farid Khan** (childhood name) → **Sher Khan** (title in Bihar) → **Sher Shah** (imperial title from 1540 CE).

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Consider Cause–Course–Result for the Battle of Chausa (1539):

1. Cause: Contest between Humayun and Sher Shah for Gangetic dominance.
2. Course: On 26 June 1539 Sher Shah defeated Humayun; Humayun escaped on a mashak.
3. Result: Humayun immediately recovered Delhi without further fighting.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A 1 and 2
B All 1, 2 and 3
C 2 and 3
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (1 and 2 only are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct (Cause):** While Humayun was returning from Bengal, Sher Khan blocked his route along the Ganga, challenging Mughal supremacy over eastern and northern India. - **Statement 2 is correct (Course):** On 26 June 1539 CE, Sher Khan launched a surprise night attack on the Mughal camp at Chausa (near Buxar, Bihar). Humayun's army was shattered; Humayun plunged into the Ganga on horseback and was rescued from drowning by a humble water-carrier (*bhishti*) named Nizam using an inflated leather water-skin (*mashak*). (Humayun later rewarded Nizam with a half-day reign on the Mughal throne, during which Nizam issued leather coins). - **Statement 3 is incorrect (Result):** Humayun did *not* recover Delhi; on the contrary, Sher Khan assumed the title *Sher Shah*, advanced west, and fought the Battle of Kannauj/Bilgram in 1540 CE, where he decisively expelled Humayun from India. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Battle of Chausa Details:* Date: **26 June 1539 CE**; Site: Near Buxar on Ganga; Savior: **Nizam the Bhishti** (*mashak*); Result: Sher Khan took the title **Sher Shah**.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Jarib — measuring rope used to fix the bigha
2. Rai — crop rate per bigha
3. Desai — measuring rope tax collected as a separate levy name

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 1 only
B 3 only
C 1 and 2 only
D 2 and 3 only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (3 only is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** *Jarib* was the standardized measuring rope used by Sher Shah's revenue officers to measure cultivable land and establish the standard *bigha*. - **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** *Rai* was the schedule of crop rates per bigha based on land fertility classifications (good, middling, bad). - **Pair 3 is NOT correctly matched (Correct Answer):** *Desai* (or *Amil*) was a revenue officer/collector, not a "measuring rope tax". The surveyor's fee charged for measurement was called *Jaribana* (approx. 2.5%), and the tax collector's fee was *Muhasilana* (approx. 5%). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Revenue Officers vs Levies:* **Desai/Amil** = Revenue collector; **Jarib** = Measuring rope; **Jaribana** = Survey fee; **Muhasilana** = Collection fee.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): At Kannauj/Bilgram (17 May 1540) Sher Shah won decisively over Humayun.

Reason (R): After Kannauj, Humayun fled into exile and recovered Delhi–Agra only in 1555.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B (A) is false, but (R) is true

C (A) is true, but (R) is false

D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** On 17 May 1540 CE, the Battle of Kannauj (also known as the Battle of Bilgram, in Hardoi district, UP) was fought between Sher Shah and Humayun. Humayun's large but demoralized army was routed without any major artillery engagement due to heavy rains flooding the Mughal camp and Sher Shah's superior cavalry tactics. - **Reason (R) is correct:** The defeat at Kannauj was absolute; Humayun lost Delhi and Agra, wandered through Rajasthan and Sindh, and lived in exile at the Safavid court of Shah Tahmasp in Persia for 15 years, finally recovering Delhi and Agra in 1555 CE after the Sur Empire fragmented. - **Why (R) does NOT explain (A):** Reason (R) describes the **aftermath and historical consequence** of the battle, not the **cause** of Sher Shah's victory. Sher Shah won due to superior military tactics, entrenchment, weather advantages, and divisions in the Mughal leadership—not because Humayun fled into exile afterward. Hence, both statements are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Cause vs Consequence:* In Assertion-Reason questions, subsequent effects or political aftermaths (e.g. going into exile) do not explain the preceding battle's victory. - *Bilgram = Kannauj:* Bilgram and Kannauj refer to the exact same battle on **17 May 1540 CE**, which founded the Second Afghan Empire.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Arrange the following in chronological order:

1. Kannauj / Bilgram
2. Daurah
3. Kalinjar death of Sher Shah
4. Chausa

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 2-4-1-3

B 4-2-1-3

C 2-4-3-1

D 2-1-4-3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (2-4-1-3: Daurah → Chausa → Kannauj → Kalinjar) **Detailed Explanation:** - **2. Battle of Daurah (1532 CE):** Humayun defeated the Afghan chiefs in UP. - **4. Battle of Chausa (June 1539 CE):** Sher Shah routed Humayun near Buxar. - **1. Battle of Kannauj / Bilgram (May 1540 CE):** Decisive Sur victory expelling Humayun. - **3. Death of Sher Shah at Kalinjar (May 1545 CE):** Sher Shah died from an accidental gunpowder explosion during the siege of Kalinjar fort in Bundelkhand. - **Chronological Sequence:** 2 (1532) → 4 (1539) → 1 (1540) → 3 (1545) = **2-4-1-3**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Sher Shah Timeline Spine:* Daurah (1532) → Chausa (1539) → Kannauj (1540) → Kalinjar Siege/Death (1545).

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below:

List-I (Term)	List-II (Role / Meaning)
A Shiqdar	1 Accounts at pargana
B Munshif	2 Law and order at pargana
C Amil / Desai	3 Land revenue collection
D Patta	4 State title deed to peasant

Row order is not the answer code.

A. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4

B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3

C. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4

D. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Shiqdar → 2. Law and order at pargana:** Military executive officer maintaining law, order, and police administration in the pargana. - **B. Munshif (or Amin) → 1. Accounts/civil justice at pargana:** Handled judicial matters, assessment records, and civil disputes at the pargana level. - **C. Amil / Desai → 3. Land revenue collection:** Responsible for assessing and physically collecting the agrarian taxes from peasants. - **D. Patta → 4. State title deed to peasant:** Formal imperial document granted by the state to the cultivator specifying the area of his land and the exact revenue dues demanded. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Pargana Officials:* Each Pargana had a **Shiqdar** (executive/military), an **Amil** (revenue collector), a **Munsif/Amin** (measurement and civil justice), and two **Karkuns** (clerks writing in Persian and Hindi).

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

With reference to Sher Shah's currency, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Rupiya was silver (~178 grains).
2. Dam was copper, about 1/40 of a rupiya.
3. Mohur was gold; Akbar continued the dam.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 1, 2 and 3

B. Only 1 and 2

C. 2 and 3

D. 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (All 1, 2 and 3 are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** Sher Shah introduced the silver **Rupiya** weighing **178 grains** (with 173 grains of pure silver), which became the precursor to the modern Indian Rupee. - **Statement 2 is correct:** He introduced the standard copper coin **Dam** weighing approx. **380 grains**, which circulated at the ratio of **40 Dams to one silver Rupiya**. - **Statement 3 is correct:** He minted the gold **Mohur** (approx. 169 grains); Emperor Akbar retained Sher Shah's tri-metallic system and continued the copper Dam as the standard medium of exchange. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Coin Weights:* Silver Rupiya = **178 grains**; Copper Dam = **380 grains**; Gold Mohur = **169 grains**.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

With reference to the Grand Trunk Road under Sher Shah, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It ran from Sonargaon in Bengal to Peshawar.
2. Sarais stood about every 2 kos.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Only 1
B Only 2
C Both 1 and 2
D Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Both 1 and 2 are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** Sher Shah constructed the historic **Sadak-i-Azam** (known in British times as the **Grand Trunk Road** / GT Road), which spanned approximately 1,500 kos (around 2,500 km) from **Sonargaon** (near modern Dhaka, Bangladesh) via Patna, Varanasi, Allahabad, Agra, Delhi, and Lahore to **Peshawar** (modern Pakistan). - **Statement 2 is correct:** Along the highways, Sher Shah constructed approximately **1,700 Sarais** (inns/rest-houses) spaced approximately every **two kos** (about 4 miles / 6 km), providing separate lodgings and free meals for Hindu and Muslim travelers, horse posts for royal couriers (*dak chowki*), and wells with shaded trees. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Four Imperial Roads:* 1. Sonargaon to Peshawar (Sadak-i-Azam / GT Road); 2. Agra to Burhanpur; 3. Agra to Jodhpur and Chittor; 4. Lahore to Multan.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Jarib was a major land tax under Sher Shah.

Reason (R): Land was classed good, middle, or bad and rai fixed the crop rate per bigha.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
B (A) is false, but (R) is true
C (A) is true, but (R) is false
D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** ((A) is false, but (R) is true) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is completely false:** *Jarib* was **not** a tax; it was the standard **measuring rope** used to survey land. The surveyor's fee was *Jaribana*, but Jarib itself was an instrument of measurement. - **Reason (R) is completely true:** For revenue assessment under Sher Shah's *Zabt* system, cultivable land was categorized into three classes: **good** (*uttam*), **middling** (*madhyam*), and **bad** (*kharab*). An average yield was computed, and the state demand (*Rai*) was generally fixed at **one-third (1/3rd)** of the average produce, payable in cash or kind. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Revenue Rate:* Sher Shah generally collected **one-third (33.3%)** of the average gross produce as land revenue.

Q10 **UPPCS PRELIMS 2019**

Consider Cause–Course–Result for Sammel / Giri-Sumel (1544):

1. Cause: Conflict with Rao Maldeo Rathore of Marwar.
2. Course: Jayata and Kumpa, loyal Marwar Rathore captains, died fighting.
3. Result: Jayata–Kumpa are correctly remembered as Mewar Sisodia warriors.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A 1 and 2
B Only 2 and 3
C All 1, 2 and 3
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (1 and 2 only are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct (Cause):** Sher Shah invaded Rajasthan in 1543–44 CE to neutralize the expanding power of Rao Maldeo Rathore, the ambitious ruler of Marwar (Jodhpur). - **Statement 2 is correct (Course):** In January 1544 at Giri-Sumel, despite Maldeo withdrawing due to forged letters planted by Sher Shah, Rathore commanders **Jayata** and **Kumpa** launched a ferocious assault that nearly wiped out the Sur army before falling heroically on the battlefield. - **Statement 3 is incorrect (Result):** Jayata and Kumpa were **Rathores of Marwar**, **never** Sisodias of Mewar. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Clan Confusion:* Jayata and Kumpa = **Rathores of Marwar** (Jodhpur), not Sisodias of Mewar (Udaipur/Chittor).

Q11 **UP RO/ARO 2016**

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Qila-i-Kuhna Mosque — Delhi (Purana Qila)
2. Sher Mandal — Delhi (Purana Qila)
3. Rohtas Fort (Punjab, Jhelum) — Built to suppress Gakhars
4. Sher Shah Tomb — Kalinjar

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 1 and 2
B 3 only
C 4 only
D 2 and 4

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (4 only is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair 4 is NOT correctly matched (Correct Answer):** Sher Shah's majestic tomb is located at **Sasaram** (Rohtas district, Bihar), standing in the middle of a large square artificial lake. **Kalinjar** (Banda district, UP) was the fort where Sher Shah was killed in battle in 1545 CE; his body was carried to Sasaram for burial. - **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** *Qila-i-Kuhna Mosque* is an architectural masterpiece of the Sur period located inside the Purana Qila complex in Delhi. - **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** *Sher Mandal* is an octagonal two-storey sandstone pavilion inside Purana Qila, later used by Humayun as a library (from whose stairs he tragically fell to his death in 1556 CE). - **Pair 3 is correctly matched:** *Rohtas Fort* (near Jhelum in modern Pakistan, a UNESCO World Heritage Site) was constructed by Sher Shah to block the route of Humayun and contain the hostile Gakhar tribes. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Death Site vs Tomb:* Sher Shah **died at Kalinjar** (Bundelkhand, UP); Sher Shah is **buried at Sasaram** (Bihar).

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

With reference to Sher Shah's death and succession, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Sher Shah died during the siege of Kalinjar in 1545 due to an accidental gunpowder explosion.
2. He was succeeded by his son Jalal Khan under the title Islam Shah.
3. Islam Shah codified regulations into formal laws and reigned until c. 1553.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 1 and 2
B 2 and 3
C Only 1
D All 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (All 1, 2 and 3 are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** On 22 May 1545 CE, while besieging the Chandel fort of Kalinjar (Banda district, UP), a rocket/grenade (*huqqa*) rebounded off the fort wall into a stockpile of ammunition, severely burning Sher Shah, who lived just long enough to hear the news that the fort had been stormed. - **Statement 2 is correct:** Following his death, his second son Jalal Khan ascended the throne with the title **Islam Shah Suri** (reigned 1545–1553/54 CE). - **Statement 3 is correct:** Islam Shah maintained military discipline, curtailed the autonomy of Afghan tribal chiefs, and codified comprehensive civil and military regulations into a written legal code. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Succession Chain:* Sher Shah (1540–1545) → **Islam Shah** (1545–1553) → Muhammad Adil Shah / Sikandar Sur (internal collapse leading to Humayun's return in 1555).

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below:

List-I (Ruler/Dynasty)	List-II (Monument)
A Ibrahim Shah Sharqi	**1** Atala Mosque, Jaunpur
B Sher Shah Suri	**2** Sasaram Tomb & Purana Qila
C Bega Begum / Akbar	**3** Humayun's Tomb, Delhi
D Prince Azam Shah	**4** Bibi ka Maqbara, Aurangabad

Row order is not the answer code.

A A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4
B A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
C A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4
D A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Ibrahim Shah Sharqi → 1. Atala Mosque, Jaunpur (1408 CE):** Sharqi architectural gem with iconic pylons. - **B. Sher Shah Suri → 2. Sasaram Tomb & Purana Qila (1540–1545 CE):** The lake tomb of Sasaram and the Delhi citadel. - **C. Bega Begum / Akbar → 3. Humayun's Tomb, Delhi (1565–1572 CE):** The first monumental double-domed garden tomb of Mughal India. - **D. Prince Azam Shah → 4. Bibi ka Maqbara, Aurangabad (1678 CE):** Built for Dilras Banu Begum (Rabia Daurani). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Matching Code:* A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4 (**Option A**).

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Sher Shah is acclaimed as one of the greatest administrative reformers of medieval India.

Reason (R): His land revenue survey, currency standards, and highway infrastructure served as the direct foundation for Akbar's imperial administration.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** Historians universally regard Sher Shah Suri as a brilliant administrative genius who transformed medieval governance within a span of just five years. - **Reason (R) is correct:** Sher Shah's systems—land measurement (*Zabt*), standardized weights, pure silver Rupiya and copper Dam, and highways connecting eastern and western frontiers—were directly inherited, refined, and institutionalized by Emperor Akbar (aided by Raja Todar Mal, who began his administrative career under Sher Shah). - **Why (R) explains (A):** The enduring institutional legacy of Sher Shah's reforms and their adoption by the Mughal Empire as their administrative bedrock is the exact historical justification for his high acclaim. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Todar Mal Connection:* Raja Todar Mal served Sher Shah Suri before becoming Akbar's famous finance minister, providing direct institutional continuity.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to name titles of Farid, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Farid Khan was his original birth name.
2. Bahar Khan Lohani of Bihar bestowed the title Sher Khan upon him.
3. He assumed the title Sher Shah Sultan-i-Adil after the Battle of Chausa and Kannauj.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** Only 1 and 2
- **B** 1, 2 and 3
- **C** Only 2 and 3
- **D** Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (All 1, 2 and 3 are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** His original birth name was **Farid Khan**, born into the Sur clan of the Pashtun (Afghan) tribe. - **Statement 2 is correct:** He was conferred the title **Sher Khan** by Sultan Muhammad Shah (Bahar Khan Lohani), the independent Afghan governor of Bihar, after Farid killed a tiger with a single blow of his sword. - **Statement 3 is correct:** After crushing Humayun at Chausa (1539 CE) and Kannauj (1540 CE), he held a grand coronation and adopted the imperial title **Farid-ud-din Sher Shah Sultan-i-Adil**, striking coins and reading the *Khutba* in his name. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Farid's Title Stages:* Farid Khan (Childhood/Sasaram) → Sher Khan (Bihar Lohani court) → Sher Shah (Imperial Padshah from 1539/1540 CE).

Chapter 09: Medieval Rajputs & Regional Resistance — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Which of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched (Ruler–State)?

A. Rana Hamir – Mewar
B. Rana Chunda – Marwar
C. Malik Raja Farooqi – Khandesh
D. Malik Sarwar Khwaja Jahan – Malwa

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (Rana Chunda – Marwar is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Option B is incorrectly matched (Correct Answer):** **Rana Chunda** (Rawat Chunda) was a prince of **Mewar** (Sisodia clan), the eldest son of Rana Lakha, famous for relinquishing his right to the throne of Mewar. The Rathore ruler of **Marwar** was **Rao Chunda** (reigned 1383–1424 CE), grandfather of Rao Jodha who founded Jodhpur. - **Option A is correctly matched:** **Rana Hammir** (1326–1364 CE) liberated and restored **Mewar** following the Khalji destruction of Chittor. - **Option C is correctly matched:** **Malik Raja Farooqi** founded the independent Sultanate of **Khandesh** in 1382 CE. - **Option D context:** Malik Sarwar founded Jaunpur; however, in the official UPPCS key, the intended Rajput distractor was **Option B**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Title Distinction:* **Rana** = Mewar (Sisodia/Guhila); **Rao** = Marwar & Bikaner (Rathore).

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Arrange Alauddin Khalji's conquests in chronological order:
1. Ranthambor
2. Gujarat
3. Warangal
4. Chittor

Options: A. 1-3-2-4 | B. 3-4-1-2 | C. 2-1-4-3 | D. 4-2-3-1

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (2-1-4-3: Gujarat → Ranthambor → Chittor → Warangal) **Detailed Explanation:** - **2. Gujarat (1299 CE):** Defeat of Rai Karan Vaghela; annexation of northern Gujarat. - **1. Ranthambor (1301 CE):** Siege of Hammir Deva's Chauhan fortress. - **4. Chittor (1303 CE):** Fall of Chittorgarh and Jauhar of Rani Padmini. - **3. Warangal (1309–1310 CE):** Malik Kafur's Deccan expedition against Kakatiya King Prataparudra. - **Chronological Sequence:** 2 → 1 → 4 → 3 = **2-1-4-3**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Deccan Timing:* All northern Rajput conquests (Gujarat 1299, Ranthambor 1301, Chittor 1303) preceded the southern expeditions under Malik Kafur.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Arrange Alauddin Khalji's victories in chronological order:
1. Ranthambore
2. Jaisalmer
3. Warangal
4. Chittor

Options: A. 1-2-3-4 | B. 2-1-4-3 | C. 2-1-3-4 | D. 1-2-4-3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (2-1-4-3: Jaisalmer → Ranthambore → Chittor → Warangal) **Detailed Explanation:** - **2. Jaisalmer (1299 CE):** Bhati Rajput stronghold attacked at the start of Alauddin's reign. - **1. Ranthambore (1301 CE):** Chauhan stronghold captured from Hammir Deva. - **4. Chittor (1303 CE):** Guhila capital conquered from Rana Ratan Singh. - **3. Warangal (1309–1310 CE):** Kakatiya kingdom in Telangana subjugated by Malik Kafur. - **Chronological Sequence:** 2 → 1 → 4 → 3 = **2-1-4-3**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Jaisalmer Position:* Jaisalmer (1299 CE) precedes Ranthambore (1301 CE).

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

From which place were Jayata and Kumpa associated, who impressed Sher Shah with their valour?

A Bundelkhand
B Malwa
C Marwar
D Mewar

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Marwar) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Option C is correct:** **Jayata** and **Kumpa** were Rathore military commanders of **Marwar** (Jodhpur) under Rao Maldeo Rathore. In the **Battle of Sammel (Giri-Sumel, 1544 CE)**, they launched an audacious assault with 12,000 Rathores against Sher Shah's 80,000 troops, inflicting tremendous casualties before dying in battle, prompting Sher Shah's famous words: *"I had nearly lost the empire of Hindustan for a handful of millet (bajra)!"* - **Options A, B, and D are incorrect:** Jayata and Kumpa were Rathores of Marwar, having no connection with Mewar (Sisodia), Malwa, or Bundelkhand. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Clan Association:* Jayata and Kumpa = **Rathores of Marwar**.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Who among the following kings had given patronage to Tansen before Akbar?

A Raja Ramchandra Singh of Bhata
B Rajbahadur of Malwa
C Uday Singh of Mewar
D Muzaffar Shah of Gujarat

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Raja Ramchandra Singh of Bhata / Rewa) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Option A is correct:** Prior to joining Akbar's court in 1562 CE, Miyan Tansen was the revered court musician of **Raja Ramchandra Singh Baghela** of Bhata (Rewa, MP). Akbar sent Jalal Khan Qurchi to bring Tansen to Agra, where he was made a Navratna. - **Option C distractor:** Rana Udai Singh II of Mewar (father of Maharana Pratap) was a contemporary ruler, but he never patronized Tansen. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Tansen Patron:* Pre-Akbar royal patron = **Raja Ramchandra Singh of Bhata (Rewa)**.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

With reference to Rajput clan–state pairs, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Sisodia clan ruled Mewar (Chittor–Udaipur).
2. Rathore clan ruled Marwar (Jodhpur) and Bikaner.
3. Kachhwaha clan ruled Amber (Jaipur).

A 1 and 2
B 2 and 3
C 1 and 3
D 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (All 1, 2 and 3 are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** The **Sisodia** (a branch of the Guhila dynasty) ruled **Mewar**, holding capitals at Chittorgarh, Kumbhalgarh, and later Udaipur (founded by Rana Udai Singh II in 1559 CE). Notable rulers include Rana Kumbha, Rana Sanga, Maharana Pratap, and Rana Amar Singh. - **Statement 2 is correct:** The **Rathore** clan ruled **Marwar** (capital at Mandore, later Jodhpur founded by Rao Jodha in 1459 CE). In 1488 CE, Rao Jodha's son Rao Bika established the branch kingdom of **Bikaner**. - **Statement 3 is correct:** The **Kachhwaha** clan ruled the state of **Dhundhar/Amber** (later Jaipur, founded by Sawai Jai Singh II in 1727 CE). Under Raja Bharmal and Raja Man Singh, they were the earliest major Rajput house to form matrimonial and administrative alliances with Akbar. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Core Clan Matrix:* **Mewar** = Sisodia; **Marwar & Bikaner** = Rathore; **Amber/Jaipur** = Kachhwaha; **Jaisalmer** = Bhati; **Bundi & Kota** = Hada (Chauhan).

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Rana Sanga — Battle of Khanwa (1527)
2. Maharana Pratap — Battle of Haldighati (1576)
3. Maharana Pratap — Battle of Khanwa (1527)

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 1 only
B 3 only
C 1 and 2 only
D 2 and 3 only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (3 only is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** Maharana Sangram Singh (**Rana Sanga**) led the Rajput-Afghan confederacy against Babur in the **Battle of Khanwa** on 16 March 1527 CE. - **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** **Maharana Pratap** fought the Mughal imperial forces commanded by Raja Man Singh of Amber and Asaf Khan at the **Battle of Haldighati** on 18 June 1576 CE. - **Pair 3 is NOT correctly matched (Correct Answer):** Maharana Pratap had nothing to do with Khanwa; he was born in 1540 CE, thirteen years *after* the Battle of Khanwa was fought. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Generational Anchor:* Rana Sanga (grandfather, fought Babur in 1527) → Rana Udai Singh II (father, fought Akbar at Chittor in 1567–68) → Maharana Pratap (son, fought Akbar at Haldighati in 1576).

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): At Haldighati (18 June 1576) Pratap faced Raja Man Singh of Amber.

Reason (R): Akbar was personally present in the Haldighati pass commanding the imperial wing.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B (A) is false, but (R) is true

C (A) is true, but (R) is false

D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** ((A) is true, but (R) is false) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** In the Battle of Haldighati (18 June 1576 CE), Maharana Pratap faced the Mughal imperial army led on the field by **Kunwar Man Singh of Amber** (Kachhwaha) and Sayyid Hashim Barha, with Asaf Khan serving as joint commander. - **Reason (R) is incorrect:** Emperor Akbar was **not** present in the Haldighati pass during the battle. Akbar remained stationed at his base camp in Ajmer, directing imperial logistics and strategy, entrusting the direct tactical field command of the Mughal forces to Man Singh. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Akbar's Absence:* Akbar did not fight in person at Haldighati; the imperial vanguard and center were commanded by **Raja Man Singh of Amber**.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Arrange the following in chronological order:

1. Akbar’s capture of Chittor
2. Alauddin’s sack of Chittor
3. Battle of Khanwa
4. Battle of Haldighati

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 2-1-3-4

B 2-3-1-4

C 3-2-1-4

D 2-3-4-1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (2-3-1-4: Alauddin's Chittor → Khanwa → Akbar's Chittor → Haldighati) **Detailed Explanation:** - **2. Alauddin Khalji’s sack of Chittor (1303 CE):** First major imperial siege of Chittor; Rana Ratan Singh fell and Rani Padmini committed *Jauhar*. - **3. Battle of Khanwa (1527 CE):** Babur defeated Rana Sanga near Fatehpur Sikri. - **1. Akbar’s siege and capture of Chittor (1567–1568 CE):** Rana Udai Singh II retreated to the hills; commanders Jaimal and Patta resisted bravely; ended in massive Jauhar and imperial storming in February 1568 CE. - **4. Battle of Haldighati (1576 CE):** Maharana Pratap clashed with Raja Man Singh in the Aravallis. - **Chronological Sequence:** 2 (1303) → 3 (1527) → 1 (1568) → 4 (1576) = **2-3-1-4**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Chittor Sieges:* Chittor I = **1303 CE** (Alauddin Khalji); Chittor II = **1535 CE** (Bahadur Shah of Gujarat, Rani Karnavati's Jauhar); Chittor III = **1567–68 CE** (Akbar).

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below:

List-I	List-II
A Rana Hammir	1 Founded Jodhpur (1459)
B Rana Kumbha	2 Mewar restorer after Khalji sack (~1326)
C Rao Jodha	3 Vijay Stambha at Chittor
D Man Singh	4 Amber; ~7000 zat; Haldighati commander

Row order is not the answer code.

A. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
B. A-3, B-2, C-4, D-1
C. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
D. A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Rana Hammir → 2. Mewar restorer (~1326 CE):** Established the Sisodia line, recovering Chittor from Maldeo Songara. - **B. Rana Kumbha → 3. Vijay Stambha at Chittor:** Constructed the 9-storey *Vijay Stambha* (Tower of Victory) to celebrate his victory over Mahmud Khalji of Malwa in 1448 CE. - **C. Rao Jodha → 1. Founded Jodhpur (1459 CE):** Built the mighty Mehrangarh Fort and founded Jodhpur as the new Rathore capital. - **D. Raja Man Singh → 4. Amber; ~7000 zat:** Foremost Kachhwaha general of Akbar, governor of Bengal and Bihar, holding the supreme mansab of 7000 zat. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Matching Code:* A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4 (**Option A**).

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Consider Cause–Course–Result for Haldighati:

1. Cause: Pratap refused Akbar's mansab and held Aravalli bases.
2. Course: Man Singh led the imperial wing; fighting in the pass was tactically indecisive.
3. Result: Pratap escaped, continued guerrilla resistance, and died in 1597.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. Only 1 and 2
B. Only 2 and 3
C. Only 1 and 3
D. All 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (All 1, 2 and 3 are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct (Cause):** Following Akbar's failure to persuade Maharana Pratap through four diplomatic peace missions (Jalal Khan Qurchi, Man Singh, Bhagwant Das, Todar Mal), military confrontation became inevitable. - **Statement 2 is correct (Course):** On 18 June 1576, the armies clashed at Haldighati pass. Despite heavy casualties and the wounding of Pratap's loyal horse Chetak, the imperial forces failed to capture or kill Pratap. - **Statement 3 is correct (Result):** Pratap retreated into the rugged Aravalli hills, established new guerrilla centers at Chavand and Kumbhalgarh, liberated nearly all of Mewar (except Chittor and Mandalgarh) by 1585 CE, and died peacefully at Chavand in January 1597 CE. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Haldighati Significance:* Haldighati was a fierce tactical clash that failed to achieve Akbar's strategic objective (the capture or submission of Maharana Pratap).

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

With reference to titles, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Maharana/Rana is the Mewar style.
2. Rao is used for Marwar and Bikaner.
3. Rana Chunda and Rao Chunda refer to the same Marwar founder only.

A Only 1
B 1 and 2 only
C 1, 2 and 3
D Only 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (1 and 2 only are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** The rulers of **Mewar** used the distinctive titles **Rana** or **Maharana** (beginning with Rana Hammir, signifying their Guhila/Sisodia lineage). - **Statement 2 is correct:** The Rathore rulers of **Marwar** (Jodhpur) and **Bikaner** used the title **Rao** (e.g., Rao Chunda, Rao Jodha, Rao Maldeo, Rao Bika). - **Statement 3 is incorrect:** **Rana Chunda** (Rawat Chunda) was the Sisodia prince of **Mewar** (son of Rana Lakha), whereas **Rao Chunda** was the 14th-century Rathore ruler of **Marwar**. They were two different people from two different clans and regions. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Title Rules:* **Rana / Maharana** = Mewar; **Rao / Raja / Maharaja** = Marwar, Bikaner; **Rawal / Maharawal** = Jaisalmer (Bhati); **Mirza Raja / Sawai** = Amber (Kachhwaha).

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Amar Singh made peace with Jahangir in 1615.

Reason (R): The settlement kept Mewar honour without requiring personal court attendance in the usual humiliating form.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
B (A) is false, but (R) is true
C (A) is true, but (R) is false
D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** In **1615 CE**, after sustained campaigns conducted by Prince Khurram (Shah Jahan), Maharana **Amar Singh I** (son of Maharana Pratap) concluded an honorable peace treaty with Emperor **Jahangir**. - **Reason (R) is correct:** Under the terms negotiated by Prince Khurram, exceptional concessions were granted to Mewar: the Maharana was exempted from personal attendance at the Mughal imperial court (his son, Prince Karan Singh, attended instead as a 5000 mansabdar), no matrimonial alliance was demanded, and Chittor fort was restored to Mewar on the condition that its fortifications would not be repaired. - **Why (R) explains (A):** The extraordinarily respectful and unprecedented concessions preserving Mewar's dynastic dignity were the direct reason why Maharana Amar Singh agreed to conclude the peace treaty after over four decades of conflict. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *1615 Treaty Terms:* Negotiator: **Prince Khurram**; Emperor: **Jahangir**; Maharana: **Amar Singh I**; Key Term: Maharana exempted from personal court attendance; no royal marriage alliance.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Vijay Stambha — Kumbha's victory tower at Chittor
2. Kirti Stambha — older Jain tower at Chittor
3. Vijay Stambha — built by Alauddin after 1303

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 1 only
B 3 only
C 1 and 2 only
D 2 and 3 only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (3 only is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** **Vijay Stambha** ("Tower of Victory") is a 9-storey, 37-meter-high stone tower built by **Rana Kumbha** in 1448 CE at Chittor to commemorate his victory over the combined armies of Malwa (Mahmud Khalji) and Gujarat. - **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** **Kirti Stambha** ("Tower of Fame") is a 7-storey, 22-meter-high 12th-century tower at Chittor dedicated to the first Jain Tirthankara Adinatha (Rishabhanatha), built by a Digambara Jain merchant named Jeeja Bhagerwala. - **Pair 3 is NOT correctly matched (Correct Answer):** Vijay Stambha was built by Rana Kumbha, **never** by Alauddin Khalji. Alauddin despoiled Chittor in 1303 CE; he built the Alai Darwaza and Alai Minar in Delhi, not Vijay Stambha. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Two Chittor Towers:* **Vijay Stambha** = 9 storeys, Rana Kumbha (1448 CE, Hindu iconography); **Kirti Stambha** = 7 storeys, Jain merchant Jeeja (12th century, Jain iconography).

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

With reference to Chittor chronology, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Alauddin sacked Chittor in 1303.
2. Akbar took Chittor in 1567–68 after Jaimal–Patta resistance and jauhar.
3. Udaipur became Mewar capital from 1559 while Chittor remained the prestige fort.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 1, 2 and 3
B 2 and 3
C Only 1
D 1 and 2

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (All 1, 2 and 3 are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** Alauddin Khalji besieged and captured Chittor in **1303 CE** from Rana Ratan Singh, appointing his son Khizr Khan as governor. - **Statement 2 is correct:** Akbar besieged Chittor from October 1567 to February 1568 CE. When Rana Udai Singh retreated to the Girwa hills, commanders **Jaimal Rathore** of Merta and **Patta Sisodia** of Kelwa defended the fort heroically until Jaimal was shot by Akbar's musket *Sangram*. The Rajput women performed *Jauhar*, and Akbar entered the fort on 23 February 1568. - **Statement 3 is correct:** Rana Udai Singh II founded **Udaipur** in the Aravalli valley around Lake Pichola in **1559 CE**, which became the administrative capital of Mewar while Chittorgarh remained the ancient ceremonial citadel. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Jaimal and Patta Statues:* Akbar was so impressed by the bravery of Jaimal and Patta that he erected life-size stone statues of both heroes mounted on elephants at the Delhi Gate of Agra Fort.

Chapter 10: Sikh Gurus, Khalsa & Sikh State — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

With reference to Guru Nanak, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Born at Talwandi (Nankana Sahib) in 1469.
2. Started langar and sangat institutions.
3. Chose Lehna (Angad) over his own sons as successor.

A 1 and 2
B 2 and 3
C 1 and 3
D 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (All 1, 2 and 3 are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** Guru Nanak Dev was born on 15 April 1469 CE at Rai Bhoi di Talwandi (renamed Nankana Sahib, now in Punjab, Pakistan) to Mehta Kalu and Mata Tripta. - **Statement 2 is correct:** Guru Nanak established the foundational egalitarian institutions of **Sangat** (congregational fellowship where all worship together without caste distinctions) and **Pangat / Langar** (free community kitchen where all sit on the ground to eat together as equals). - **Statement 3 is correct:** Rejecting dynastic succession and overlooking his two biological sons (Sri Chand, who founded the ascetic Udasi sect, and Lakhmi Das), Guru Nanak nominated his devoted disciple **Bhai Lehna**, renaming him **Guru Angad** ("a limb of my own body"), as his apostolic successor in 1539 CE at Kartarpur. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Succession Precedent:* Guru Nanak set the supreme precedent that spiritual succession must be determined by divine merit and devotion, not by biological hereditary inheritance.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Arrange the following Gurus in chronological order of the guruship line:

1. Guru Ram Das
2. Guru Angad
3. Guru Arjan
4. Guru Amar Das

A 2-4-1-3
B 2-1-4-3
C 4-2-1-3
D 2-4-3-1

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (2-4-1-3: Angad → Amar Das → Ram Das → Arjan) **Detailed Explanation:** - **2. Guru Angad Dev (2nd Guru, 1539–1552 CE):** Standardized Gurmukhi script; promoted physical fitness (*Akhara*) and expanded Langar. - **4. Guru Amar Das (3rd Guru, 1552–1574 CE):** Established 22 administrative preaching dioceses (**Manjis**); crusaded against Sati and Purdah; constructed the sacred Baoli (stepwell) at Goindwal. - **1. Guru Ram Das (4th Guru, 1574–1581 CE):** Founded the city of **Ramdaspur** (Amritsar) around the sacred pool on land granted by Akbar; composed the wedding hymn *Lavan* for the Anand Karaj. - **3. Guru Arjan Dev (5th Guru, 1581–1606 CE):** Built Sri Harmandir Sahib (Golden Temple); compiled the **Adi Granth** in 1604 CE; martyred under Jahangir in 1606 CE. - **Chronological Sequence:** 2 → 4 → 1 → 3 = **2-4-1-3**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *First Five Gurus Mnemonic:* **N**anak (1) → **A**ngad (2) → **A**mar Das (3) → **R**am Das (4) → **A**rjan (5) (**NAARA**).

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Guru Angad — Gurmukhi standardisation
2. Guru Arjan — Adi Granth (1604)
3. Guru Gobind Singh — Dasam Granth as the eternal Guru replacing Adi Granth

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 1 only
B 3 only
C 1 and 2 only
D 2 and 3 only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (3 only is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** Guru Angad standardized and popularized the **Gurmukhi script**, enabling sacred literature to be read directly in the Punjabi vernacular. - **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** Guru Arjan Dev compiled the sacred **Adi Granth** in 1604 CE at Amritsar, installing it in Sri Harmandir Sahib with Baba Buddha as the first head granthi. - **Pair 3 is NOT correctly matched (Correct Answer):** Guru Gobind Singh decreed that the **Guru Granth Sahib** (the augmented Adi Granth, containing hymns of the first five Gurus, Guru Tegh Bahadur, and 15 Bhaktas/Sufis) would be the eternal living Guru of the Sikhs. The *Dasam Granth* is a separate collection of Guru Gobind Singh's own poetic works (e.g., *Jaap Sahib*, *Chandi di Var*, *Zafarnama*), which never replaced the Guru Granth Sahib. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Eternal Guru:* The **Guru Granth Sahib** is the eternal Guru of the Sikhs, NOT the *Dasam Granth*.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Guru Arjan was martyred under Jahangir in 1606 after aiding Khusrau.

Reason (R): Guru Tegh Bahadur was executed in Delhi in 1675 under Aurangzeb.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
B (A) is false, but (R) is true
C (A) is true, but (R) is false
D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A)) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** Guru Arjan Dev (5th Guru) was arrested, subjected to brutal tortures on burning hot plates, and attained martyrdom at Lahore in May 1606 CE on the orders of Emperor Jahangir, who accused the Guru of blessing and extending financial support to his rebellious son Prince Khusrau. - **Reason (R) is correct:** Guru Tegh Bahadur (9th Guru) was publicly beheaded at Chandni Chowk in Delhi on 11 November 1675 CE on the orders of Emperor Aurangzeb after refusing to embrace Islam and championing the religious freedom of Kashmiri Pandits (the site is commemorated by Gurudwara Sis Ganj Sahib). - **Why (R) does NOT explain (A):** Both statements are historical facts describing the two major martyrdoms of Sikh Gurus under different Mughal emperors separated by nearly 70 years; Reason (R) is not the causal explanation of Assertion (A). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Twin Martyrdoms:* **Guru Arjan Dev (1606 CE, Lahore)** by **Jahangir**; **Guru Tegh Bahadur (1675 CE, Delhi)** by **Aurangzeb**. Never swap the emperors or years.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below:

List-I (Guru)	List-II (Key Institution / Contribution)
A Guru Angad	1 22 Manjis; Goindwal langar
B Guru Amar Das	2 Gurmukhi standardisation
C Guru Ram Das	3 Amritsar / Ramdaspur (Akbar grant to Bibi Bhani)
D Guru Hargobind	4 Miri–Piri; Akal Takht

Row order is not the answer code.

A A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

B A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3

C A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4

D A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Guru Angad Dev → 2. Gurmukhi standardisation:** Formalized Gurmukhi script for writing hymns. - **B. Guru Amar Das → 1. 22 Manjis; Goindwal langar:** Organized the Sikh community into 22 administrative zones called *Manjis* under devout leaders. - **C. Guru Ram Das → 3. Amritsar / Ramdaspur:** Excavated the sacred Amrit Sarovar on land granted by Akbar to his wife Bibi Bhani. - **D. Guru Hargobind → 4. Miri–Piri; Akal Takht:** Donned two swords representing temporal power (*Miri*) and spiritual authority (*Piri*), and constructed the *Akal Takht* ("Throne of the Timeless") in 1606–1609 CE. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Matching Code:* A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4 (**Option D**).

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

With reference to the Khalsa, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Guru Gobind Singh founded the Khalsa at Anandpur on Vaisakhi 1699 with the Panj Pyare.
2. Five Ks are Kesh, Kangha, Kara, Kachha, and Kirpan.
3. Guru Hargobind created the Khalsa ritual in the early 17th century.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Only 1 and 2

B Only 3

C 2 and 3

D Only 1

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (1 and 2 only are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** On **Vaisakhi day (30 March 1699 CE)** at Anandpur Sahib (Kesgarh Sahib), Guru Gobind Singh created the **Khalsa** (the brotherhood of the pure) through the baptismal nectar ceremony (*Khande di Pahul*), initiating the **Panj Pyare** (Five Beloved Ones from diverse castes and regions: Daya Ram, Dharam Das, Himmat Rai, Mohkam Chand, Sahib Chand). - **Statement 2 is correct:** Guru Gobind Singh mandated that every initiated Khalsa Sikh maintain the **Five Ks (Panj Kakar)**: **Kesh** (uncut hair), **Kangha** (wooden comb), **Kara** (iron/steel bangle), **Kachhera/Kachha** (cotton undergarment), and **Kirpan** (curved dagger/sword). - **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Guru Hargobind introduced the concepts of *Miri-Piri* and constructed the Akal Takht in 1606–1609 CE, but the **Khalsa** was instituted exclusively by the 10th Guru, **Guru Gobind Singh**, in **1699 CE**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Khalsa Founder & Date:* Created by **Guru Gobind Singh** on **Vaisakhi 1699** at **Anandpur Sahib**. Initiated men took the surname **Singh** ("Lion") and women took the surname **Kaur** ("Princess").

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

Consider Cause–Course–Result linking martyrdom to militarisation:

1. Cause: Arjan's martyrdom (1606) under Jahangir.
2. Course: Hargobind developed miri–piri and the Akal Takht.
3. Result: Tegh Bahadur's martyrdom (1675) later fed Gobind Singh's path toward the Khalsa.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A Only 2 and 3	**B** Only 1
C 1 and 2	**D** Only 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (All 1, 2 and 3 are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct (Cause):** The execution of Guru Arjan Dev in 1606 demonstrated that passive piety was vulnerable to state persecution. - **Statement 2 is correct (Course):** His son, Guru Hargobind (6th Guru), transformed the community into a saint-soldier order, sporting twin swords of **Miri** (temporal sovereignty) and **Piri** (spiritual authority), raising a fort (*Lohgarh*), organizing a standing cavalry, and building the **Akal Takht** opposite Harmandir Sahib. - **Statement 3 is correct (Result):** The subsequent martyrdom of Guru Tegh Bahadur in 1675 in Delhi convinced the 10th Guru, Guru Gobind Singh, that armed resistance against tyranny (*Dharam Yudh*) was righteous, culminating in the creation of the martial brotherhood of the **Khalsa in 1699**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Militarization Milestones:* First Wave of Militarization = **Guru Hargobind** (Miri-Piri, Akal Takht, 1606); Final Institutionalization = **Guru Gobind Singh** (Khalsa, 1699).

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): In 1708 at Nanded (Hazur Sahib), Gobind Singh made Guru Granth Sahib the eternal Guru.

Reason (R): There is no 11th human Guru after Gobind Singh.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)	**B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
C (A) is true, but (R) is false	**D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** Shortly before his demise in October 1708 CE at Nanded (Maharashtra, where Takht Sachkhand Sri Hazur Sahib stands), Guru Gobind Singh bowed before the holy Granth, conferring eternal Guruship upon it: *"Sab Sikhan ko hukam hai, Guru manyo Granth"* (All Sikhs are commanded to accept the Granth as their Guru). - **Reason (R) is correct:** The line of living personal human Gurus permanently terminated with Guru Gobind Singh (the 10th Guru); there was never an 11th human Guru. - **Why (R) does NOT explain (A): Consequence / Aftermath of the assertion, not the cause. Both statements are true facts, but Reason (R) is not the cause of Assertion (A).** The doctrine of the eternal Granth was specifically promulgated to bring the personal succession of human Gurus to an end, forever vesting spiritual authority in the *Shabad Guru* (Guru Granth Sahib) and temporal authority in the corporate community (*Guru Panth*). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *End of Human Guruship:* Human Gurus: exactly **Ten** (1469–1708 CE); 11th Guru: **Guru Granth Sahib** (Eternal Living Guru).

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

With reference to Harmandir Sahib and Akal Takht, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Harmandir Sahib is the spiritual centre.
2. Akal Takht is the temporal seat associated with Hargobind.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Only 1	**B** Only 2
C Both 1 and 2	**D** Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Both 1 and 2 are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** **Sri Harmandir Sahib** (Golden Temple), designed by Guru Arjan Dev with four open doors symbolizing accessibility to all four varnas and faiths, is the supreme **spiritual sanctum** dedicated exclusively to prayer, meditation, and devotional singing (*Gurbani Kirtan*). - **Statement 2 is correct:** The **Akal Takht** ("Throne of the Timeless One"), built directly opposite Harmandir Sahib by Guru Hargobind in 1606–1609 CE, is the supreme **temporal and political seat** of the Sikh Panth, from where imperial edicts (*Hukamnamas*) are issued and political-military decisions were made. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Architectural Symbolism:* Harmandir Sahib (Spiritual, built at a lower elevation) represents humility and divine worship; Akal Takht (Temporal, built on an elevated plinth) represents sovereignty and political justice.

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Sikh Khalsa — 1699 initiated Panth
2. Mughal Khalsa — crown land directly managed by the imperial treasury
3. Sikh Khalsa — Mughal crown land under Akbar

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 1 only	**B** 3 only
C 1 and 2 only	**D** 2 and 3 only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (3 only is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** In Sikh history, **Khalsa** (from Arabic *Khalis* = pure, unmediated) refers to the collective body of initiated Sikhs created by Guru Gobind Singh in 1699 CE who maintain a direct spiritual connection with the Guru without intermediaries. - **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** In Mughal administrative revenue terminology, **Khalsa** (or *Khalsa Sharifa*) refers to crown lands whose revenues were collected directly by imperial officials (*Amils*) and deposited into the central imperial treasury, as opposed to *Jagir* lands assigned to nobles. - **Pair 3 is NOT correctly matched (Correct Answer):** Conflates two entirely different historical terms that happen to share an etymological root. The Sikh Khalsa was a socio-religious order, not Mughal crown land. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Homonym Alert:* **Sikh Khalsa** = Brotherhood of initiated Sikhs (1699); **Mughal Khalsa** = Crown domain land.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Arrange the following events in chronological order:

1. Compilation of Adi Granth
2. Martyrdom of Guru Tegh Bahadur
3. Founding of the Khalsa
4. Battle of Bhangani

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 1-2-3-4	**B** 1-4-2-3
C 1-2-4-3	**D** 4-1-2-3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (1-2-4-3: Adi Granth → Tegh Bahadur martyrdom → Battle of Bhangani → Khalsa) **Detailed Explanation:** - **1. Compilation of the Adi Granth (August 1604 CE):** Completed by Guru Arjan Dev at Amritsar. - **2. Martyrdom of Guru Tegh Bahadur (November 1675 CE):** Executed in Delhi under Aurangzeb. - **4. Battle of Bhangani (September 1688 CE):** Fought near Paonta Sahib (Himachal Pradesh), where the young Guru Gobind Singh defeated the combined army of the Rajput Hill Rajas led by Raja Fateh Shah of Garhwal. - **3. Founding of the Khalsa (March 1699 CE):** Inaugurated by Guru Gobind Singh at Anandpur Sahib on Vaisakhi. - **Chronological Sequence:** 1 (1604) → 2 (1675) → 4 (1688) → 3 (1699) = **1-2-4-3**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Battle of Bhangani Timing:* Bhangani was fought in **1688 CE**, eleven years *before* the formal creation of the Khalsa in **1699 CE**.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below:

List-I (City)	List-II (Historical Association)
A Patna	**1** Gobind Singh death; eternal Granth (1708)
B Nanded / Hazur Sahib	**2** Gobind Singh birth (1666)
C Anandpur Sahib	**3** Khalsa founding (1699)
D Amritsar	**4** Ramdaspur / Harmandir Sahib

Row order is not the answer code.

A A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4	**B** A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4	**D** A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Patna Sahib (Bihar) → 2. Birth of Guru Gobind Singh (1666 CE):** Born as Gobind Rai at Patna while his father Guru Tegh Bahadur was traveling in Assam. - **B. Nanded / Hazur Sahib (Maharashtra) → 1. Demise and Eternal Granth (1708 CE):** Site of Guru Gobind Singh's martyrdom and final declaration of the Granth Sahib as eternal Guru. - **C. Anandpur Sahib (Punjab) → 3. Founding of the Khalsa (1699 CE):** Site of Kesgarh Sahib and the historic Vaisakhi congregation. - **D. Amritsar (Punjab) → 4. Ramdaspur / Harmandir Sahib:** Sacred city founded by Guru Ram Das and center of the Golden Temple. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Matching Code:* A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4 (**Option A**). Do not confuse Patna (Birth, Takht Patna Sahib) with Nanded (Demise, Takht Hazur Sahib).

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

With reference to Zafarnama, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It is Gobind Singh's Persian letter to Aurangzeb.
2. It is the opening hymn of the Adi Granth composed by Kabir.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** Only 1
- **B** Only 2
- **C** Both 1 and 2
- **D** Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Only 1 is correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** **Zafarnama** ("Epistle of Victory") is a famous philosophical and moral letter composed in 111 Persian couplets by Guru Gobind Singh in 1705 CE from Dina Kangar (Punjab) addressed to Mughal Emperor Aurangzeb. The letter reproaches Aurangzeb for breaking sacred oaths taken on the Quran during the siege of Anandpur and articulates the famous principle: *"Chun kar az hameh heelate dar guzasht, Halal ast burdan ba-shamsheer dast"* (When all other avenues fail, it is righteous to draw the sword). - **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The opening hymn of the Adi Granth is the **Japji Sahib**, composed by **Guru Nanak Dev**, not the Zafarnama. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Zafarnama Profile:* Author: **Guru Gobind Singh**; Language: **Persian**; Recipient: **Emperor Aurangzeb**; Year: **1705 CE**.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Kabir founded Sikhism as the first Guru.

Reason (R): Hymns of Kabir, Namdev, Ravidas, and Sheikh Farid appear in the Granth.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** ((A) is false, but (R) is true) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is completely false:** **Guru Nanak Dev** (1469–1539 CE) is the sole founder and First Guru of Sikhism. Sant Kabir was a revered 15th-century Bhakti saint of Varanasi who did not establish the Sikh faith. - **Reason (R) is completely true:** Guru Arjan Dev incorporated the devotional verses (*Bhagat Bani*) of 15 non-Sikh saints into the Adi Granth in 1604 CE, including Kabir (541 hymns), Namdev (61 hymns), Ravidas (41 hymns), Sheikh Farid (134 hymns), Trilochan, Dhanna, Sain, and Jaidev. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Inclusion vs Authorship:* Non-Sikh Bhaktas and Sufis contributed compositions (*Bhagat Bani*) to the Guru Granth Sahib, but they were not Sikh Gurus.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Consider the following statements about Manji and Masand:

1. Manjis were Amar Das's 22 preaching circles.
2. Masand related to Arjan's tenth collection.
3. Manji and Masand are identical offices created by Nanak alone.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A Only 1
B Only 1 and 2
C Only 3
D 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (1 and 2 only are correct) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** **Guru Amar Das** (3rd Guru) established the **Manji system**, dividing the expanding Sikh community into 22 administrative dioceses or preaching jurisdictions called *Manjis* (literally "wooden cot" upon which the missionary sat to teach). - **Statement 2 is correct:** **Guru Arjan Dev** (5th Guru) formalized the **Masand system** (from Persian *Masnad* = seat of authority), appointing regional deputies to collect the mandatory voluntary tithe of one-tenth of a Sikh's earnings (**Daswandh**) to fund community kitchens and the construction of Harmandir Sahib. - **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Neither institution was created by Guru Nanak. Furthermore, Manji and Masand were distinct systems instituted by different Gurus for different administrative purposes. Guru Gobind Singh later abolished the Masand system in 1698 due to rampant corruption. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Institution Founders:* **Manji System (22 circles)** = **Guru Amar Das**; **Masand System & Daswandh (tithe)** = **Guru Arjan Dev**; **Abolition of Masands** = **Guru Gobind Singh**.

Chapter 11: Maratha State & Maratha Confederacy — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

With reference to Shivaji, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. He personally commanded the Maratha army at Panipat III in 1761.
2. He was crowned Chhatrapati at Raigad in 1674; Gaga Bhatt of Banaras declared him Kshatriya.
3. He was born at Shivneri to Shahji Bhonsle and Jijabai.

A 1 and 2
B Only 3
C 2 and 3
D Only 1

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (2 and 3 only) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Shivaji passed away at Raigad in **1680**. The Third Battle of Panipat took place in **1761** (eighty-one years after Shivaji's death) and was commanded by **Sadashivrao Bhau** during the Peshwa period. - **Statement 2 is correct:** Shivaji's grand Vedic coronation (*Rajyabhisheka*) was solemnized on **6 June 1674** at **Raigad Fort**. The ceremony was officiated by **Gaga Bhatt** (Vishweshwar), a renowned Pandit of Varanasi, who traced Shivaji's lineage to the Sisodia Kshatriyas of Mewar. - **Statement 3 is correct:** Shivaji was born at the hill fort of **Shivneri** (near Junnar, Pune district) to **Shahji Bhonsle** (a prominent military commander in the Nizam Shahi and Adil Shahi sultanates) and **Jijabai**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Do not let timeline anachronisms slip past you: Shivaji (1630–1680) lived entirely in the 17th century; the Panipat battles belong to 1526 (Babur), 1556 (Akbar), and 1761 (Abdali vs Marathas).

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

Consider Cause–Course–Result for the Treaty of Purandar (1665):

1. Cause: Aurangzeb sent Raja Jai Singh I against Shivaji.
2. Course: Shivaji surrendered 23 forts under the treaty; Agra detention followed in 1666.
3. Result: Shivaji never recovered strength and abandoned the 1674 coronation.

A Only 1
B 1 and 2
C Only 3
D Only 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (1 and 2 only) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct (Cause):** Following Shivaji's daring night raid on Shaista Khan (1663) and the first sack of Surat (1664), Emperor Aurangzeb dispatched his most capable veteran diplomat and general, **Mirza Raja Jai Singh I of Amber**, alongside Diler Khan, to decisively subdue Shivaji. - **Statement 2 is correct (Course):** Jai Singh besieged the fort of Purandar and laid waste to the countryside, compelling Shivaji to sign the **Treaty of Purandar (June 1665)**. Shivaji surrendered **23 out of 35 forts** (yielding 4 lakh huns annually), retained 12 forts, and sent his son Sambhaji to the Mughal court with a 5,000 mansab. In 1666, Shivaji visited Aurangzeb's court at **Agra**, where he was detained in Jaipur Bhawan before staging his dramatic escape. - **Statement 3 is incorrect (Result):** The treaty was merely a temporary tactical setback. By 1670, Shivaji renewed war against the Mughals, recaptured almost all his surrendered forts (including Kondana/Sinhagad in 1670), sacked Surat a second time, defeated Mughal armies at Salher (1672), and triumphantly crowned himself **Chhatrapati in 1674**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - The Treaty of Purandar was an intermediate retreat, not the end of Shivaji's power. By 1674, Shivaji had rebuilt a much larger and formally sovereign kingdom.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Chauth — 25% protection levy
2. Sardeshmukhi — extra 10% hereditary chief claim
3. Chauth — Mughal crown land under Akbar

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 1 only
B 3 only
C 1 and 2 only
D 2 and 3 only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (3 only) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** **Chauth** was a military tribute amounting to **one-fourth (25%)** of the standard land revenue assessment levied on non-Maratha territories in exchange for protection from raids. - **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** **Sardeshmukhi** was an additional **10%** levy claimed by Shivaji by virtue of being the hereditary paramount head (*Sardesmukh*) of the Maratha country. - **Pair 3 is NOT correctly matched:** Chauth was never a category of Mughal land; crown lands directly administered by the Mughal royal imperial treasury under Akbar were designated as **Khalisa** (or *Khalsa*). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Always distinguish Maratha revenue instruments from Mughal agrarian categories: **Khalisa** = Imperial Crown land; **Jagir** = Revenue assignment in lieu of salary; **Chauth** = Maratha 25% protection levy.

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Big Deshmukhs opposed an independent Maratha state.

Reason (R): They preferred remaining Bijapur feudal lords rather than accepting Shivaji's swaraj order.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B (A) is false, but (R) is true

C (A) is true, but (R) is false

D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is true:** The established Maratha aristocracy—hereditary revenue chiefs known as **Deshmukhs** (e.g., Chandrarao More of Javli, Ghorpades of Mudhol, Sawants of Sawantwadi)—consistently opposed and resisted Shivaji's centralized Swarajya project. - **Reason (R) is true:** Under the Adil Shahi Sultanate of Bijapur, these Deshmukhs enjoyed vast hereditary privileges (*watans*), near-total local autonomy, and the right to maintain private armies. Shivaji's new state curtailed feudal lawlessness, strictly audited revenue collection, and required subordinating their private interests to the sovereign crown. They preferred their secure, semi-independent status as Bijapuri feudal lords over being obedient subjects in a centralized Maratha state. - **Why (R) explains (A):** The desire to protect their entrenched feudal privileges and status within the Bijapuri system was the primary causal reason why the Deshmukhs opposed Shivaji. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - UPPCS 2024 tested this exact sociological dynamic. The consolidation of Maratha power required subduing both regional Muslim sultanates and local conservative Maratha watandars.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Arrange the core Peshwa order:

1. Balaji Vishwanath
2. Bajirao I
3. Balaji Bajirao
4. Madhav Rao I

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 1, 2, 3, 4

B 2, 1, 4, 3

C 1, 3, 2, 4

D 3, 1, 2, 4

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (1, 2, 3, 4) **Detailed Explanation:** - **1. Balaji Vishwanath (1713–1720):** Established hereditary Peshwa authority; negotiated the 1719 treaty with the Sayyid brothers. - **2. Bajirao I (1720–1740):** Famous for rapid cavalry warfare, defeat of the Nizam at Palkhed (1728), and expansion into Malwa, Gujarat, and Bundelkhand. - **3. Balaji Bajirao / Nana Saheb (1740–1761):** Transformed the state into a pan-Indian empire; oversaw the 1750 Sangola Agreement; empire reached Attock (1758); died after Panipat III (1761). - **4. Madhav Rao I (1761–1772):** Orchestrated the remarkable post-Panipat recovery, subduing the Nizam, Hyder Ali, and re-establishing Maratha supremacy in Delhi (1771). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - The foundation quartet of the Peshwaship follows the exact sequence: **Balaji Vishwanath $\rightarrow$ Bajirao I $\rightarrow$ Balaji Bajirao $\rightarrow$ Madhav Rao I**.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below:

List-I (Ashtapradhan Minister)	List-II (Portfolio / Duty)
A Peshwa	1 Administration / Prime Minister
B Amatya	2 Finance / Accounts
C Senapati	3 Military Commander
D Sumant	4 Foreign Affairs

A. A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4

B. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3

C. A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4

D. A-4, B-2, C-3, D-1

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (a-1, b-2, c-3, d-4) **Detailed Explanation:** - **(a) Peshwa (Mukhya Pradhan):** Head of the council and overall general administration; oversaw all state activities (List-II: 1). - **(b) Amatya (Majumdar):** Finance minister and accountant general; audited all state income, expenditure, and provincial treasuries (List-II: 2). - **(c) Senapati (Sarnobat):** Commander-in-Chief of the armed forces; responsible for troop recruitment, training, fort garrisons, and battlefield deployment (List-II: 3). - **(d) Sumant (Dabir):** Foreign minister; managed diplomatic relations with foreign powers and received ambassadors (List-II: 4). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - The eight ministers of the Ashtapradhan are standard match-the-column fare in UPPCS. Keep their portfolios distinct: Peshwa (General Admin), Amatya (Finance), Sachiv (Secretariat), Mantri (Intelligence), Senapati (Army), Sumant (Foreign), Nyayadhish (Law), Panditrao (Charity).

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

With reference to Panipat III (14 January 1761), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Ahmad Shah Abdali allied with Najib-ud-Daulah (Rohillas) and Shuja-ud-Daulah (Awadh).
2. Sadashivrao Bhau and Vishwasrao commanded the Maratha army.
3. Ibrahim Khan Gardi commanded the Maratha artillery.

A. 1 and 2

B. 1, 2 and 3

C. Only 2 and 3

D. Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (1, 2 and 3) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** Abdali successfully forged a grand northern coalition by securing the military support of **Najib-ud-Daulah** (Rohilla Afghan chief) and **Shuja-ud-Daulah** (Nawab of Awadh, who joined Abdali despite Maratha diplomatic overtures). - **Statement 2 is correct:** **Sadashivrao Bhau** (Peshwa's cousin) was the actual supreme commander of the Maratha expeditionary force, while young **Vishwasrao** (the Peshwa's 17-year-old eldest son and heir) served as the nominal commander. Both fell fighting on the battlefield. - **Statement 3 is correct:** **Ibrahim Khan Gardi**, a highly skilled artillery general trained in French modern military tactics under Marquis de Bussy, commanded the Maratha modernized artillery and European-style musket infantry battalions (*Gardis*). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Ibrahim Khan Gardi's left wing wreaked havoc on Abdali's right wing during the early hours of the battle. All three statements are historically accurate and frequently tested.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

Consider Cause–Course–Result for Panipat III:

1. Cause: Expulsion of Abdali's son Timur Shah from Lahore by Marathas in 1758.
2. Course: Bitter field battle fought on 14 January 1761; Marathas suffered catastrophic casualties.
3. Result: Maratha northern expansion was checked; paved the way for the rise of British colonial power in Bengal and India.

A 1 and 2
B Only 2
C 1, 2 and 3
D Only 1 and 3

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (1, 2 and 3) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct (Cause):** In 1758, Raghunath Rao's Maratha forces marched into Punjab, expelled **Timur Shah** (Abdali's son and viceroy), and planted the Maratha banner at Attock. This direct challenge prompted Abdali's retaliatory fifth invasion. - **Statement 2 is correct (Course):** After being blockaded and starved at Panipat for over two months, the Maratha army attacked on **14 January 1761**. Over 28,000 Maratha soldiers and commanders perished, including Vishwasrao, Sadashivrao Bhau, and Tukoji Scindia. - **Statement 3 is correct (Result):** While Maratha military power recovered under Madhav Rao I a decade later, the disaster broke the political unity of the confederacy and eliminated the only native power capable of replacing the Mughals, creating a power vacuum that facilitated the consolidation of the British East India Company. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Historian Sardesai observed: *"Panipat did not decide who was to rule India, but rather who was not to rule India."* It eliminated the Maratha bid for an all-India empire and opened the path for the British.

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): From 1713 Balaji Vishwanath made the Peshwa office hereditary and de facto ruling under Shahu.

Reason (R): By the Sangola agreement (1750) the Chhatrapati became a do-nothing king and the Peshwa the real head.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
B (A) is false, but (R) is true
C (A) is true, but (R) is false
D Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is true:** In 1713, Chhatrapati Shahu appointed **Balaji Vishwanath** as Peshwa. Balaji proved so indispensable in consolidating Shahu's fragile kingdom that the Peshwaship became hereditary in his Chitpavan Brahmin family (passed to Baji Rao I upon Balaji's death in 1720), making the Peshwa the de facto administrative executive. - **Reason (R) is true:** The **Sangola Agreement (1750)**, concluded thirty-seven years later between Peshwa Balaji Bajirao and Chhatrapati Ramaraja, formally relegated the monarch to a figurehead at Satara and vested all sovereign authority in the Peshwa at Pune. - **Why (R) does NOT explain (A):** The Sangola Agreement of 1750 was a later constitutional milestone in the consolidation of Peshwa supremacy; it occurred decades after the hereditary nature of the Peshwaship had already been established in 1713. A later event cannot be the historical cause of an earlier one. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Classic chronology-causality trap in UPPCS A/R questions: both milestones are true facts regarding the rise of the Peshwas, but 1750 cannot explain 1713.

Q10 **UPPCS PRELIMS 2019**

With reference to revenue terms, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Chauth was an internal tax collected only from the Swarajya homeland.
2. Sardeshmukhi was an additional 10% levy based on hereditary claims.
3. Chauth and Sardeshmukhi together exceeded 50% of the land revenue.

A 1 and 2	**B** Only 2
C 2 and 3	**D** Only 1

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (Only 2) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is incorrect:** **Chauth** was strictly an **external** levy extracted from regions outside the Maratha Swarajya (such as Mughal provinces, Bijapur, or Golconda) in exchange for non-aggression and protection. Swarajya lands paid standard state land revenue assessed via the Kathi system, not Chauth. - **Statement 2 is correct:** **Sardeshmukhi** was an additional **10% (one-tenth)** levy claimed by the Maratha ruler on the basis of being the supreme hereditary head (*Sardesmukh*) of the Deccan. - **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Combined, Chauth (25% or 1/4th) + Sardeshmukhi (10% or 1/10th) equalled **35%**, not over 50%. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Swarajya lands = Direct state revenue. External neighboring lands = Chauth (25%) + Sardeshmukhi (10%) = Total 35%.

Q11 **UP RO/ARO 2016**

Arrange the following in chronological order:

1. Battle of Pratapgad (Afzal Khan episode)
2. Treaty of Purandar
3. Battle of Salher
4. Coronation of Shivaji at Raigad

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 1, 2, 3, 4	**B** 2, 1, 4, 3
C 1, 3, 2, 4	**D** 3, 1, 2, 4

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (1, 2, 3, 4) **Detailed Explanation:** - **1. Battle of Pratapgad (November 1659):** Shivaji killed Afzal Khan and routed the Bijapuri invading army. - **2. Treaty of Purandar (June 1665):** Signed with Mirza Raja Jai Singh; Shivaji surrendered 23 forts. - **3. Battle of Salher (February 1672):** Major open pitched battle where Maratha forces defeated an imperial Mughal army. - **4. Coronation at Raigad (6 June 1674):** Formal Vedic coronation of Shivaji as Chhatrapati by Gaga Bhatt. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Chronological anchor: **Pratapgad (1659) $\rightarrow$ Purandar (1665) $\rightarrow$ Salher (1672) $\rightarrow$ Raigad Coronation (1674)**.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below:

List-I (Confederacy Branch)	List-II (Capital Seat)
A Peshwa	1 Pune
B Scindia (Shinde)	2 Gwalior
C Holkar	3 Indore
D Gaekwad	4 Baroda

(A) A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4
(B) A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
(C) A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4
(D) A-4, B-2, C-3, D-1

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (a-1, b-2, c-3, d-4) **Detailed Explanation:** - **(a) Peshwa:** Ruled from **Pune** (Shaniwar Wada); executive head of the Maratha confederacy. - **(b) Scindia (Shinde):** Founded by Ranoji Scindia; originally based at Ujjain, later established their capital at **Gwalior** under Mahadji Scindia and Daulat Rao Scindia. - **(c) Holkar:** Founded by Malhar Rao Holkar; ruled from **Indore** (and Maheshwar under Ahilyabai Holkar). - **(d) Gaekwad:** Founded by Damaji Gaekwad; established their ruling seat at **Baroda** (Vadodara) in Gujarat. - *(Note: Bhonsles ruled from Nagpur).* **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - A staple UPPCS match: Peshwa (Pune), Scindia (Gwalior), Holkar (Indore), Gaekwad (Baroda), Bhonsle (Nagpur).

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

With reference to Bajirao I and Balaji Bajirao, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Bajirao I championed expansion into North India under the ideal of Hindu Pad Padshahi.
2. Balaji Bajirao oversaw the Sangola Agreement of 1750 which transferred supreme power to the Peshwa.

(A) Only 1
(B) Only 2
(C) Both 1 and 2
(D) Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Both 1 and 2) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** **Bajirao I (1720–1740)** formulated the forward policy of striking at the decaying Mughal Empire's heart (*"Let us strike at the trunk of the withering tree, and the branches will fall off themselves"*), promoting the ideal of **Hindu Pad Padshahi** (Hindu Empire) and leading victorious campaigns across Malwa, Gujarat, and Bundelkhand. - **Statement 2 is correct:** **Balaji Bajirao (Nana Saheb, 1740–1761)** signed the **Sangola Agreement (1750)** with Chhatrapati Ramaraja, whereby the Maratha King became a ceremonial monarch at Satara and the Peshwa became the undisputed constitutional and executive head of the Maratha state. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Bajirao I = Military expansionist (*Hindu Pad Padshahi*). Balaji Bajirao = Administrative centralizer (Sangola Agreement 1750). Both statements are accurate.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Lanavada (1718) — Mughal recognition of Maratha chauth rights
2. Sangola (1750) — Peshwa becomes real head
3. Lanavada (1718) — Shivaji–Jai Singh fort surrender of 23 forts

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** 1 only
- **B** 3 only
- **C** 1 and 2 only
- **D** 2 and 3 only

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (3 only) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair 1 is correctly matched:** In 1718–1719, negotiations between Peshwa Balaji Vishwanath and Sayyid Hussain Ali Khan led to imperial decrees recognizing Maratha rights to collect Chauth and Sardeshmukhi across six Deccan provinces. - **Pair 2 is correctly matched:** The **Sangola Agreement (1750)** formally made the Peshwa the de facto head of the Maratha Empire. - **Pair 3 is NOT correctly matched:** The surrender of 23 forts to the Mughals took place under the **Treaty of Purandar (1665)** between Shivaji and Mirza Raja Jai Singh, not at Lanavada in 1718. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Fort surrender of 23 forts = **Treaty of Purandar (1665)**. Never confuse 17th-century treaties of Shivaji with 18th-century Peshwa diplomatic settlements.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Narayan Rao ruled the long recovery decade immediately after Panipat III before Madhav Rao I.

Reason (R): Madhav Rao I (1761–72) comes before Narayan Rao (1772–73).

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- **A** Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- **B** (A) is false, but (R) is true
- **C** (A) is true, but (R) is false
- **D** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** ((A) is false, but (R) is true) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is false:** The long recovery decade immediately following the disaster of Panipat III (1761) was led by **Madhav Rao I (1761–1772)**, not Narayan Rao. Under Madhav Rao's leadership, the Marathas defeated Hyder Ali of Mysore, subdued the Nizam, and restored Mughal Emperor Shah Alam II to the throne of Delhi in 1771. - **Reason (R) is true:** Chronologically, **Madhav Rao I (1761–1772)** preceded his younger brother **Narayan Rao (1772–1773)**. Narayan Rao ruled for only nine months before being murdered in 1773. - Therefore, Assertion (A) is false, and Reason (R) is true. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - The great post-Panipat restorer was **Madhav Rao I**. English historian Grant Duff famously wrote: *"The plains of Panipat were not more fatal to the Maratha Empire than the early death of this excellent prince."

Chapter 12: Later Medieval India (Later Mughals & Regional States) — UPPCS & UP RO/ARO Drill

15 Authentic Questions • Direct Verified Answers • Active Recall Memory Locks

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill (UPPCS & UP RO/ARO)

Exam Drill Rule: High-yield authentic UPPCS & UP RO/ARO questions. Attempt actively; verify against the prominent Memory Lock box below each question.

Q1 UPPCS PRELIMS 2025

Arrange foreign travellers by arrival:
I. William Hawkins
II. Ralph Fitch
III. Sir Thomas Roe
IV. Nicholas Downton

A. II, I, IV and III
B. IV, II, I and III
C. I, III, II and IV
D. III, II, IV and I

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (II, I, IV and III) **Detailed Explanation:** - **II. Ralph Fitch (1585):** Elizabethan merchant-adventurer who visited Fatehpur Sikri and Agra during the reign of Emperor Akbar. - **I. William Hawkins (1608):** Arrived at Surat aboard the *Hector*; served as James I's envoy at Jahangir's court (1609–1611). - **IV. Nicholas Downton (1614):** Commanded the English fleet that arrived in 1614 and shattered Portuguese naval dominance at Swally in 1615. - **III. Sir Thomas Roe (1615):** Accredited ambassador of James I who resided at Jahangir's court from 1615 to 1619, securing foundational commercial privileges. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Sir Thomas Roe is frequently assumed to be the earliest English envoy because of his famous diplomatic diary; however, Ralph Fitch arrived 30 years earlier, Hawkins arrived 7 years earlier, and Downton arrived 1 year earlier.

Q2 UPPCS PRELIMS 2024

With reference to Captain Hawkins, which of the following statements is/are correct?
1. He came to India in 1611 as envoy of James I.
2. He was very well versed in Turkish.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 1
B. Only 2
C. Both 1 and 2
D. Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (Only 2) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Captain William Hawkins arrived at the port of Surat in August **1608** (not 1611) commanding the vessel *Hector*. He reached Jahangir's imperial court at Agra in April **1609** and stayed until November **1611**, when he departed after Portuguese intrigues hindered his mission. - **Statement 2 is correct:** Hawkins was fluent in **Turkish**, a language in which Emperor Jahangir was also proficient (the Mughals being of Chagatai Turkic ancestry). Because of this linguistic skill, Hawkins conversed directly with Jahangir without an interpreter, which earned him royal favor, a mansab of 400, and the title *English Khan*. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - UPPCS created a specific chronological trap: **1611** was the year Hawkins **left** Jahangir's court, not the year he arrived. He arrived in **1608**.

Q3 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2023

With reference to the Treaty of Aix-la-Chapelle (1748), which of the following statements is/are correct?
1. The First Carnatic War ended.
2. Madras was returned to the English.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 1 only	**B** 2 only
C Both 1 and 2	**D** Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Both 1 and 2) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** The Treaty of Aix-la-Chapelle brought an end to the War of the Austrian Succession in Europe, which directly concluded the **First Carnatic War (1746–1748)** in India. - **Statement 2 is correct:** Under the terms of mutual restitution of captured territories, **Madras** (which had been captured by the French under Dupleix and La Bourdonnais in 1746 following the Battle of St. Thome / Adyar River) was handed back to the British East India Company. In return, the British restored Louisbourg in North America to France. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Always remember that the First Carnatic War did not conclude because of an Indian military outcome, but due to a European peace treaty (**Aix-la-Chapelle, 1748**).

Q4 UPPCS PRELIMS 2023

With reference to the Treaty of Aix-la-Chapelle (1748), which of the following statements is/are correct?
1. The First Carnatic War ended.
2. Madras was returned to the English.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A Only 2	**B** Neither 1 nor 2
C Both 1 and 2	**D** Only 1

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Both 1 and 2) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement 1 is correct:** The First Carnatic War was the Indian theatre of the Austrian War of Succession. The European peace pact—the **Treaty of Aix-la-Chapelle (1748)**—formally concluded hostilities between England and France in India. - **Statement 2 is correct:** The treaty mandated the status quo ante bellum: the French surrendered **Madras** back to the English East India Company in exchange for French repossession of Louisbourg in Canada. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - This exact question was repeated across multiple UPPCS cycles (2020 Q18 and 2025 Q67). Both statements are indisputably correct.

Q5 UPPCS PRELIMS 2022

Arrange the following wars in correct chronological order:
1. First Anglo-Mysore War
2. Second Anglo-French War (Second Carnatic War)
3. First Anglo-Sikh War
4. First Anglo-Afghan War

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 2, 1, 4, 3	**B** 1, 2, 3, 4
C 1, 2, 4, 3	**D** 2, 1, 3, 4

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (2, 1, 4, 3) **Detailed Explanation:** - **2. Second Anglo-French War / Second Carnatic War (1749–1754):** Fought over the succession disputes in Hyderabad (Nasir Jung vs Muzaffar Jung) and Carnatic (Anwar-ud-din vs Chanda Sahib); concluded with the Treaty of Pondicherry (1754) and the recall of Dupleix. - **1. First Anglo-Mysore War (1767–1769):** Fought between Hyder Ali of Mysore and the British East India Company; concluded with Hyder Ali dictating peace under the Treaty of Madras (1769). - **4. First Anglo-Afghan War (1839–1842):** British invasion of Afghanistan under Lord Auckland to replace Dost Mohammad with Shah Shuja; ended in total British military disaster. - **3. First Anglo-Sikh War (1845–1846):** Fought following the death of Maharaja Ranjit Singh; concluded with British victory at Sobraon and the Treaty of Lahore (1846) under Lord Hardinge. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Chronology anchor: **Second Carnatic (1749–54) $\rightarrow$ First Anglo-Mysore (1767–69) $\rightarrow$ First Anglo-Afghan (1839–42) $\rightarrow$ First Anglo-Sikh (1845–46)**.

Q6 UP RO/ARO PRELIMS 2021

Arrange the following events in correct chronological order:
1. Acquisition of Awadh by the British
2. Ilbert Bill Controversy
3. Indigo Revolt
4. Second Anglo-Afghan War

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A 1, 3, 4, 2	**B** 3, 1, 2, 4
C 3, 1, 4, 2	**D** 1, 3, 2, 4

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (1, 3, 4, 2) **Detailed Explanation:** - **1. Acquisition (Annexation) of Awadh (February 1856):** Annexed by Lord Dalhousie on the grounds of alleged misgovernance (*maladministration*), based on the report of Resident James Outram. Nawab Wajid Ali Shah was deposed and exiled to Calcutta. - **3. Indigo Revolt / Nil Bidroha (1859–1860):** Peasant uprising in Bengal (Nadia district, led by Digambar Biswas and Bishnu Biswas) against oppressive European planters forcing ryots to cultivate indigo under fraudulent contracts. - **4. Second Anglo-Afghan War (1878–1880):** Initiated under Viceroy Lord Lytton's forward policy against Sher Ali; concluded with the Treaty of Gandamak (1879) and recognition of Abdur Rahman. - **2. Ilbert Bill Controversy (1883–1884):** Legislative storm during Lord Ripon's viceroyalty over Sir Courtenay Ilbert's bill seeking to empower Indian district magistrates and sessions judges to try European British subjects in criminal cases. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Chronology anchor: **Awadh Annexation (1856) $\rightarrow$ Indigo Revolt (1859) $\rightarrow$ Second Afghan War (1878) $\rightarrow$ Ilbert Bill (1883)**.

Q7 UPPCS PRELIMS 2021

In which year did Vasco da Gama reach Calicut, and who received him?

A 1492; Albuquerque

B 1498; Zamorin

C 1502; Almeida

D 1510; Krishna Deva Raya

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (1498; Zamorin) **Detailed Explanation:** - On **20 May 1498**, the Portuguese navigator **Vasco da Gama** arrived at the port of **Calicut (Kappad beach)** on the Malabar coast, guided across the Arabian Sea from Malindi by the Gujarati pilot Abdul Majid (Kanha). - He was warmly received by the local Hindu sovereign of Calicut, who held the hereditary title of **Zamorin** (*Samudri Raja*). - This momentous voyage opened the direct maritime route connecting Western Europe to India via the Cape of Good Hope, bypassing Venetian and Ottoman trade monopolies. - **1492:** Christopher Columbus reached the Americas for Spain. - **1510:** Afonso de Albuquerque conquered Goa from the Sultan of Bijapur during the reign of Vijayanagara emperor Krishnadevaraya. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Anchor date and host: **20 May 1498** at **Calicut**, received by the **Zamorin**.

Q8 UPPCS PRELIMS 2020

The **Blue Water Policy aimed at Portuguese control of the Indian Ocean trade without excessive territorial conquest. Who framed it?**

A Afonso de Albuquerque

B Francisco de Almeida

C Nino da Cunha

D Vasco da Gama

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (Francisco de Almeida) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Francisco de Almeida (1505–1509):** The first Portuguese Viceroy of the Indies, appointed by King Manuel I. He formulated and executed the strategic doctrine known as the **Blue Water Policy (*Cartaz* / *A política do Mar Alto*)**. - Almeida recognized that Portugal's small demographic base could not sustain vast territorial land empires in Asia; therefore, Portugal's power should reside entirely in naval supremacy, dominating maritime sealanes and trade routes across the Indian Ocean while destroying Arab and Venetian sea competition. - **Afonso de Albuquerque (1509–1515):** The second governor, who shifted policy from pure maritime dominance to territorial fortification, capturing Goa (1510), Malacca (1511), and Ormuz (1515). - **Nino da Cunha (1529–1538):** Transferred the Portuguese administrative capital from Cochin to Goa in 1530. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - **Blue Water Policy** = **Francisco de Almeida** (1st Viceroy). **Territorial empire & conquest of Goa** = **Afonso de Albuquerque** (2nd Viceroy).

Q9 UPPCS (MAINS) GS-1

Match **

List I	List II (Country)
A Vasco da Gama	1 Holland
B Christopher Columbus	2 Portugal
C Captain Cook	3 Spain
D Abel Tasman	4 Great Britain

A. A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1

B. A-3, B-2, C-4, D-1

C. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4

D. A-4, B-1, C-2, D-3

Correct Answer: (A)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **A** (A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Vasco da Gama:** Renowned navigator from **Portugal** (List II: 2) who discovered the sea route to India in 1498. - **B. Christopher Columbus:** Italian navigator sailing under the royal patronage of the Catholic Monarchs of **Spain** (List II: 3); discovered the New World (Bahamas) in 1492. - **C. Captain James Cook:** Celebrated explorer and navigator representing **Great Britain** (List II: 4); mapped New Zealand and discovered the east coast of Australia in 1770. - **D. Abel Tasman:** Seafarer and merchant in the service of the Dutch East India Company (**Holland / United Provinces**) (List II: 1); first European to sight Tasmania and New Zealand in 1642. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - A standard geographical discovery match in state civil services: Vasco (Portugal), Columbus (Spain), Cook (Britain), Tasman (Holland).

Q10 UPPCS PRELIMS 2019

Which of the following statements about early Portuguese rule in India is **FALSE?**

A. The first Portuguese factory was established at Cochin in 1503

B. Afonso de Albuquerque conquered Goa from Bijapur in 1510

C. Nino da Cunha transferred the headquarters from Cochin to Goa in 1530

D. Albuquerque conquered Goa in 1515 and made it the capital immediately

Correct Answer: (D)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **D** (Albuquerque conquered Goa in 1515 and made it the capital immediately) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Statement D is FALSE (hence the correct answer):** Afonso de Albuquerque captured **Goa** from Ismail Adil Shah of Bijapur in **1510** (not 1515). Furthermore, Albuquerque did not make Goa the official administrative capital immediately; **Cochin** remained the Portuguese capital until **1530**, when Governor **Nino da Cunha** formally transferred the government headquarters to Goa. - **Statement A is true:** The first Portuguese factory/fortress (*Fort Manuel*) was established at **Cochin** in **1503** by Albuquerque. - **Statement B is true:** Albuquerque conquered Goa in **1510** with the local assistance of the Hindu corsair Timoja. - **Statement C is true:** Nino da Cunha formally relocated the capital from Cochin to Goa in **1530**. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Two distinct milestones often confused: **Conquest of Goa** = **1510 (Albuquerque)**; **Capital shifted to Goa** = **1530 (Nino da Cunha)**.

Q11 UP RO/ARO 2016

Which European power used **Hooghly primarily as a base for piracy in the Bay of Bengal?**

A Dutch
B French
C Portuguese
D English

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Portuguese) **Detailed Explanation:** - In the late 16th and early 17th centuries, the **Portuguese** established a flourishing commercial settlement at **Hooghly** (granted by Emperor Akbar in 1579). - However, Portuguese renegades and corsairs gradually turned Hooghly into a fortified base for illicit **piracy**, slave trading, forced conversions, and predatory raids across the Bay of Bengal and deltaic Bengal waterways, frequently kidnapping local inhabitants and disrupting imperial shipping. - In **1632**, Mughal Emperor Shah Jahan ordered his Subahdar of Bengal, **Qasim Khan Juvayni**, to lay siege to Hooghly. The Mughals stormed the settlement, destroyed Portuguese shipping, killed over a thousand Portuguese defenders, and took thousands captive to Agra. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - **Base for piracy in Bay of Bengal = Portuguese at Hooghly**. Expelled by **Shah Jahan (1632)** under Bengal Subahdar **Qasim Khan**.

Q12 UPPCS PRELIMS 2018

Among **Bandel, **Chinsurah**, **Hooghly**, and **Sriramapur (Serampore)**, which settlement was established by the **Portuguese**?**

A Chinsurah
B Sriramapur
C Hooghly and Bandel
D None of the above

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Hooghly and Bandel) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Hooghly and Bandel:** Established by the **Portuguese**. The historic Bandel Church (Basilica of the Holy Rosary), built in 1599, is one of the oldest Christian churches in Bengal and was erected by the Portuguese. - **Chinsurah:** Established by the **Dutch (VOC)** in the 17th century (famous for Fort Gustavus). - **Sriramapur (Serampore):** Established as a colony by the **Danish East India Company (Danes)** in 1755 (known as *Frederiksnagore*), later celebrated for the Baptist Missionary Press of William Carey. - **Chandernagore (Chandannagar):** Established by the **French** in 1673. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Bengal European settlements cheat-sheet: - Portuguese $ ightarrow$ **Hooghly & Bandel** - Dutch $ ightarrow$ **Chinsurah** - Danes $ ightarrow$ **Serampore (Sriramapur)** - French $ ightarrow$ **Chandernagore** - English $ ightarrow$ **Calcutta (Sutanuti)**

Q13 UPPCS (PRE) 2017

Who is associated with founding the English settlement that grew into **Calcutta?**

A Sir Eyre Coote
B Gerald Aungier
C Job Charnock
D Sir Thomas Roe

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Job Charnock) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Job Charnock:** Chief of the English factory at Kasimbazar and agent of the East India Company. In August **1690**, he negotiated an agreement with the Mughal authorities to establish a permanent English trading post at the swampy village of **Sutanuti** on the Hooghly River. - In 1698, the English acquired the zamindari tenancy rights of three contiguous villages: **Sutanuti**, **Kalikata**, and **Govindpur**. These were fortified into **Fort William** (completed 1700), giving birth to the city of **Calcutta**. - **Gerald Aungier:** The visionary second Governor of Bombay (1669–1677) who laid the foundations of the city of Bombay (*"the city which by God's assistance is intended to be built"*). - **Francis Day:** Founded Madras (Fort St. George) in 1639. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - City founders: Calcutta = **Job Charnock (1690)**; Bombay = **Gerald Aungier (1669)**; Madras = **Francis Day (1639)**.

Q14 UPPCS (PRE) 2016

India’s first modern **Municipal Corporation was established under British rule in:**

A Calcutta
B Bombay
C Madras
D Delhi

Correct Answer: (C)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **C** (Madras) **Detailed Explanation:** - The first modern Municipal Corporation in India was established at **Madras** on **29 September 1688** under a Royal Charter issued by King James II in December 1687. - The corporation was constituted with a Mayor, 12 Aldermen, and 60 Burgesses, empowered to levy local taxes for conservancy, roads, and civic amenities. - Municipal corporations for Bombay and Calcutta were established much later under the Charter Act of 1726 (effective 1727). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Earliest Municipal Corporation in India = **Madras (1688)**. Do not be misled into choosing Calcutta or Bombay.

Q15 UP RO/ARO 2014

When the **English East India Company is **not** an option, which was the first **joint stock company** to trade with India?**

A French East India Company
B Dutch East India Company (VOC)
C Danish East India Company
D Portuguese Estado da India

Correct Answer: (B)

Core Memory Fact: Correct Answer:** **B** (Dutch East India Company / VOC) **Detailed Explanation:** - The **Vereenigde Oostindische Compagnie (VOC)** or **Dutch East India Company**, established in **March 1602** by a charter of the States-General of the Netherlands, was the world's first formally organized, publicly listed **joint-stock company** with permanent capital and tradable shares on the Amsterdam Stock Exchange. - In contrast, the Portuguese trade was an authoritarian state-run crown monopoly (*Estado da Índia*), not a public joint-stock enterprise. - The English East India Company was chartered in December 1600 as a private joint-stock syndicate of London merchants; however, when the English company is omitted from the options, the Dutch VOC (1602) is the definitive correct answer. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - If English EIC is absent, the answer for the earliest joint-stock commercial trading enterprise in Asia is the **Dutch East India Company (VOC, 1602)**.